

The Affiliation of the Three Zhōngshān Mǐn Varieties: A Review & Some Additional Notes*

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In the Pearl River Delta, three enclave Mǐn Chinese varieties can be found in Zhōngshān: Longdu 隆都 (Lóngdū), Namlong 南萌 (Nánlǎng), and Samheung 三鄉 (Sānxiāng). They are often said to be closely related Southern Mǐn varieties. In this article, we review the existing arguments on the affiliation of these three Zhōngshān Mǐn varieties, and provide some extra perspectives. Based on shared innovations, the genealogical affiliation of Longdu and Namlong lies not with Southern Mǐn, but with Eastern Mǐn, and more specifically, the Northern subgroup of Eastern Mǐn. Samheung, on the other hand, is indeed Southern Mǐn. Samheung is primarily a Southern Mǐn variety of the Zhāngzhōu-type, and it also has a few traits of the Cháo–Shàn (Teochew–Swatow) type. In addition to the large superstratum from the dominant Yuè varieties (Shekki and Cantonese), the Zhōngshān Mǐn varieties also have their own retentions and innovations which make them typologically less typical of their respective Mǐn sub-group. This is especially the case with Longdu and Namlong; they are typologically rather different from the better-known Eastern Mǐn varieties like Fúzhōu (Hokchew) and Fúqīng (Hokchia). This has caused their Eastern Mǐn affiliation to be overlooked by many people.

Keywords: *Sinitic, Zhongshan Min, dialect island, comparative method, Proto-Min*

1. Introduction

Many languages (Sinitic, Kra-Dai, and Hmong-Mien) are traditionally spoken in Guǎngdōng Province in Far Southern China. Most people speak a speech variety belonging to one of these three Sinitic dialect groups: Yuè 粵 (which includes Cantonese), Hakka 客家 (Kèjiā), and Mǐn 閩. Mǐn originated in neighbour-

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ing Fújiàn Province to the northeast, and in Guǎngdōng about a quarter of the population speaks a Mǐn variety (Wu & Zhan 2012:160–161). The Guǎngdōng Mǐn varieties are primarily found in two coastal flanks: Teochew–Swatow 潮州汕頭 (Cháo zhōu–Shàn tóu) and Hai–Lok Hong 海陸豐 (Hǎi fēng–Lù fēng, “Haklau”) in the eastern flank, and Luichew 雷州 (Léi zhōu) in the western flank. Less well known are the many little Mǐn enclaves elsewhere in Guǎngdōng (e.g. Zhuang 2002). Amongst the Guǎngdōng Mǐn enclaves, the most populous, and also the most linguistically divergent, are found in Zhōngshān 中山 (Chungshan) in the Pearl River Delta in central Guǎngdōng. The Zhōngshān Mǐn [ZSM] varieties are the main foci of this article. The three ZSM varieties—Longdu 隆都 (Lóng dū), Namlong 南朗 (Nán lǎng), and Samheung 三鄉 (Sān xiāng)—are often assumed to be closely-related Southern Mǐn varieties. However, this is only partially true. Firstly, it is debatable how closely related they are to each other; even Longdu and Namlong, the closest pair out of the three, are mutually unintelligible without prior exposure. Secondly, as we shall see in this article, while Samheung is indeed Southern Mǐn, Longdu and Namlong are Eastern Mǐn genealogically.

In section 1, various introductory remarks are made. Section 2 is primarily a review of Akitani (2022a)’s arguments that Longdu is a member of Eastern Mǐn, and more specifically, the Northern subgroup of Eastern Mǐn. We also present some additional data which support this view. Also discussed in our article are a few counterexamples, e.g. likely borrowings from Southern Mǐn, as well as how Longdu is typologically different from the typical Eastern Mǐn varieties. These typological traits have led many people to think that Longdu is Southern Mǐn. Section 3 on Namlong has exactly the same structure as section 2 on Longdu. Namlong is largely similar to Longdu in terms of its historical phonological developments, and is hence also a variety of Eastern Mǐn. In section 4, we compare Samheung with the innovations that have occurred in the various branches of Coastal Mǐn. The conclusion is that Samheung is primarily a Zhāngzhōu-type Southern Mǐn variety, and it also has some traits which resemble Guǎngdōng–Hǎinán-type Southern Mǐn.

In section 5, we discuss some traits which are common to the three ZSM varieties, including two lexical items which link ZSM with far northeastern Fújiàn: the word for “yesterday”, and 翁 *ɛŋ¹ / ɔŋ¹ / aŋ¹* ‘grandfather’. A conclusion is made in section 6.

1.1 Zhōngshān and the Zhōngshān languages

Zhōngshān 中山 (Chungshan, ‘middle mountain’)¹ is located in the Pearl River Delta, on the western side of the Pearl River Estuary. Going clockwise, to the south are Zhūhǎi 珠海 and Macau 澳門. To the west is Kongmoon 江門 (Jiāng mén), i.e. the Szeyap 四邑 (Siyi) area (a.k.a. Ngyap 五邑 [Wǔyì]). To the north are Fatshan 佛山 (Fóshān) and Canton 廣州 (Guǎngzhōu). East of Canton is Tungkun 東莞 (Dōngguǎn). To the east of Zhōngshān, across the Pearl River Estuary are Shēnzhèn 深圳 and Hong Kong 香港. (See Map 1.)

Zhōngshān 中山 was previously known as Heungshan 香山 (Xiāngshān, ‘fragrant mountain’). The traditional Heungshan County included Macau and most of Zhūhǎi to the south. Heungshan was historically one big island, surrounded by smaller islands.² Mǐn was the majority in the Heungshan Islands, and Yuè – Heungshan Yuè – was a strong minority. Most Mǐn-speaking villages in Heungshan were established during the Southern Sòng Dynasty (1127–1279) (Gao 2018:5). That Samheung Mǐn speakers call Yuè speakers 客

1 Zhōngshān City is a prefectural-level city (one level below the provincial level). After Zhūhǎi was carved out, the ex-Zhōngshān County was upgraded to become a prefecture on its own. In other words, Zhōngshān is a prefecture, but its geographical size is that of an average county.

2 For instance, Shekki, Namlong, and Samheung were on the main Heungshan Island, whereas Longdu was a separate island. This explains the stronger influence that Shekki Yuè has on Namlong Mǐn than it has on Longdu Mǐn, despite Longdu being geographically closer to Shekki. Shekki’s influence on Samheung Mǐn is also not very strong, due to there being mountains in between, mountains that are primarily populated by Hakka speakers (Gao 2002:120–121).

儂 *k^hei²⁷ naŋ²* (guest person) (and, e.g., 講客 *keu³⁻⁶ k^hei²⁷* [speak guest] ‘speak Yuè’; Gao 2018:330)³ is a testament that Mǐn speakers settled in the Heungshan Islands on average earlier than Yuè speakers. There are other minorities in the Heungshan Islands. The majority of Hakka speakers arrived in Heungshan during the Qīng Dynasty (1616–1911) (Gao 2018:7), primarily settling in mountainous areas. In the 1550s, the Portuguese settled in Macau Peninsula, a tip of Heungshan Island.⁴

During the Míng Dynasty (1368–1644), the number of Yuè speakers grew rapidly. The number of Heungshan Yuè villages surpassed the number of Mǐn villages (Gao 2018:4). Sedimentation gradually joined Heungshan Island and many of the surrounding small islands to the Pearl River Delta. The newly formed sandy lowlands were primarily settled by people from elsewhere. Most of these new migrants spoke the Shuntak 順德 (Shùndé) type of Yuet Hoi 粵海 (Yuèhǎi) Yuè from the immediate north. Many Boat People, who spoke similar types of Yuet Hoi Yuè, also settled in the new lands. Also amongst the new immigrants were smaller numbers of speakers of Kun–Pou 莞寶 (Guǎn–Bǎo) Yuè from the northeast, and Szeyap 四邑 (Siyi) Yuè from the west.⁵

Zhōngshān has a population of around 4.4 million (2020 census). (Further rounding has been applied here.) Gao (2018:9) estimates that in 2015, about 1.16 million people in Zhōngshān spoke a traditional Zhōngshān speech variety: 185,000 spoke Heungshan Yuè (Shekki 石岐 [Shíqí] / Northern Heungshan Yuè, and Hafong 下方 [Xiàfāng] / Southern Heungshan Yuè), 796,000 spoke other types of Yuè that are native to Zhōngshān (the 沙田 ‘sandy land’ Yuè varieties: Shuntak/Boat-type Yuet Hoi Yuè, Kun–Pou Yuè, Szeyap Yuè), 153,500 spoke ZSM (Longdu 87,500, Namlong 54,500, Samheung 23,000), and 25,500 spoke Zhōngshān Hakka [ZSH].⁶

The traditional lingua franca in Zhōngshān is the Yuè dialect of Shekki 石岐 ([siak¹ k^hiŋ], Shíqí; e.g. Chao 1948; Chan 1980; Lin 1987) in central Zhōngshān, the traditional county seat. In this article, “Zhōngshān Yuè” [ZSY] is by default the Yuè dialect of Shekki. Another lingua franca that is universally known is Cantonese, i.e. Yuè dialect of Canton, the provincial capital.⁷ Everyone in Zhōngshān understands Cantonese, and most can speak it fluently. The three ZSM varieties are spoken in non-contiguous areas in Zhōngshān: Longdu 隆都 primarily to the west of Shekki, Namlong 南萌 to the east of Shekki, and Samheung 三鄉 to the south, across the Wǔguishān 五桂山 Mountains where ZSH (e.g. Gan 2003, Gao 2018:351–385) is spoken. (In this article, “Longdu”, “Namlong”, and “Samheung” are by default Longdu Mǐn, Namlong Mǐn,

3 On the other hand, Hakka 客家, the even newer “guest”, is called 僑子 *gei²⁻⁶ tsu³* (Gao 2018:10) in Samheung Mǐn, based on the first-person pronoun *gai²* in the local variety of Hakka (2018:370).

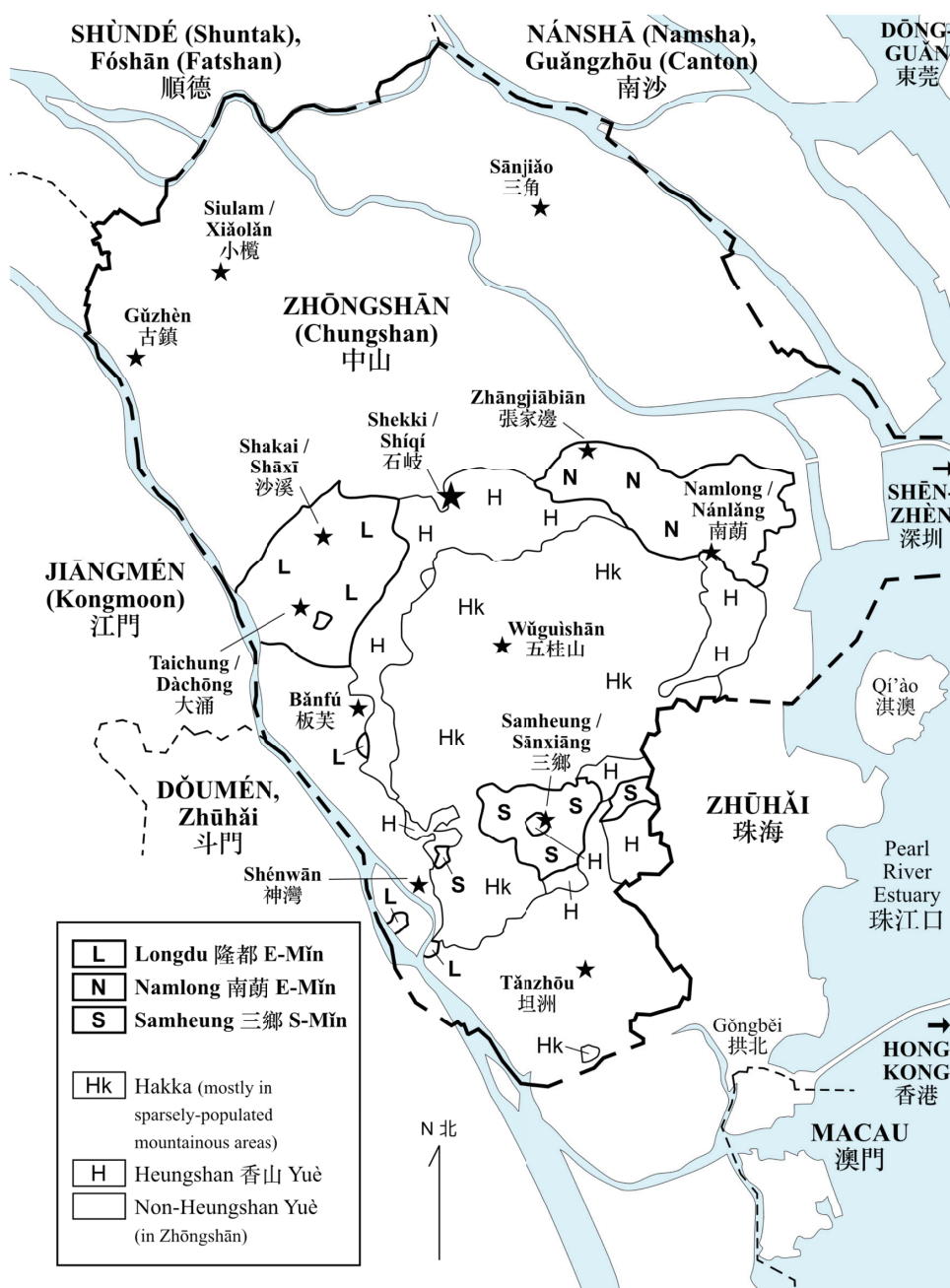
4 Macau and Zhōngshān are important to each other in multiple ways. Traditionally, Macau was the main international port, and Shekki was the county seat, midway between Macau and Canton. One interesting linguistic fact is that many Heungshan languages have borrowed the Portuguese word *tomate* ‘tomato’ (/to¹ mati/ in Macanese Creole): Older Macau Cantonese *ta⁵ ma¹ ti²* [t¹ 1 4J] ~ *tai⁶ ma¹ ti⁶* [t¹ 1 4J], Samheung SM [ta^{4J} ma¹ ti^{4J}] GR, Shekki Yuè *tai⁵ ma¹ ti³* [t¹ 1 4J] GR, Longdu EM [tu¹ ba¹ tat^{4J}] GR. In contrast, most of Sinitic Guǎngdōng, eastern Guǎngxī, and eastern Hǎinán use a cognate of the Cantonese word 番茄 *fan¹ k^he²⁻³* (‘foreign eggplant’) (Cao 2008: Lexicon map 022).

5 Here, Zhan et al. (2002)’s classification of the Pearl River Delta Yuè dialects is followed. Zhan et al.’s Yuet Hoi 粵海 (Yuèhǎi; which includes Cantonese), Kun–Pou 莞寶 (Guǎn–Bǎo), and Heungshan 香山 (Xiāngshān) groups correspond with the Guǎngfǔ 廣府 group in the Language Atlas of China (Wurm et al. 1987; Xiong et al. 2012).

6 Like the rest of the old Heungshan County, Zhūhǎi and Macau also have a mixture of Yuè, Mǐn, and Hakka populations traditionally. This article only deals with the Sinitic varieties within the modern boundaries of Zhōngshān City.

7 A rather narrow definition of Cantonese is adopted here (de Sousa 2022): Cantonese is the Yuè dialect of Canton (Guǎngzhōu), and the derivatives of Canton Yuè spoken in a great number of enclaves elsewhere (the “Cantonese enclaves”), e.g. Hong Kong, Macau, some parts of Diànbái, Zhànjiāng (Fort Bayard), and Nánning city centre. Cantonese also dominates many Chinatowns overseas, e.g. Saigon, Kuala Lumpur.

and Samheung Mǐn respectively; varieties of Yuè are also spoken natively in those areas, and also Hakka in the case of Namlong and Samheung.) See Map 1 for the distribution of Mǐn, Hakka, and Yuè varieties in Zhōngshān.



Map 1. Distribution of Mǐn, Hakka, and Yuè varieties in Zhōngshān (based on Gao 2018:xi)

1.2 Mǐn and the ZSM varieties

Mǐn Chinese originated in Fújiàn Province in southeastern China, but the Coastal Mǐn varieties have a long history of spreading to other provinces and overseas. The Mǐn group is often divided into two branches: Inland Mǐn [InM] and Coastal Mǐn [CsM].⁸ There are three subgroups within CsM: Eastern Mǐn [EM], Pú–Xiān Mǐn [PXM], and Southern Mǐn [SM]. As we shall see later, Longdu (§2) and Namlong (§3) are EM varieties, while Samheung (§4) is a SM variety. Figure 1 shows a combination of some common views on the internal structure of the Mǐn group.

Inland Mǐn [InM]:	NM+WM:	Northern Mǐn [NM] Western Mǐn [WM] (a.k.a. Shào–Jiāng)
	Central Mǐn [CnM]	
Coastal Mǐn [CsM]:	Eastern Mǐn [EM]:	North [NEM] (a.k.a. Fú–Níng) South [SEM] (a.k.a. Hòuguān)
	SM+PXM:	Pú–Xiān Mǐn [PXM] Southern Mǐn [SM]: Quánzhōu-type [QzSM] Zhāngzhōu-type [ZzSM] Guǎngdōng–Hǎinán [GHSM]

Figure 1. One view of the internal structure of the Mǐn group

Reconstructions exist for Proto-Mǐn (Norman 1969, 1973, 1974, 1981, 1986, 1991a), Proto-CsM (Norman 1969; Bodman 1985; Kwok 2023, 2024; Shen 2023), Proto-EM (Akitani 2018:709–712; 2020:851–858; 2022b), Proto-SM+PXM (Bodman 1985), Proto-SM (Zhang 2013, 2022; Kwok 2018). In this article, unless otherwise indicated, Norman’s Proto-Mǐn, and reconstructions of the lower nodes by Akitani and Kwok are used. As for Proto-PXM, Pútíán 莆田 and Xiānyóu 仙遊 Mǐn are linguistically very close to each other (with Xiānyóu being slightly more conservative; see, e.g., Cai 2016, Li et al. 2019). PXM has a mixture of SM and EM features; the majority opinion is that PXM is genealogically closer to SM, and the EM features are later influences (e.g. Bodman [1985], Kwok [2024]; also cf. Shen [2023:527]’s “temporary assumption” of a “Proto-Puxian-Southern-Min” node). When we talk about a “SM feature” in ZSM, it can be a feature of SM+PXM, or just SM. When we talk about an “EM feature” in ZSM, it can be a feature that has also been diffused from EM to PXM. We have not found PXM-specific innovations in the ZSM varieties, despite the fact that many ZSM speakers claim that their ancestors came from the Pútíán area (see, e.g., §4.1.6 for Samheung).

8 See also, e.g., Coblin (2018), Shen (2022), and Shen & Sheng (2024) on their opinions on the relationship between InM and CsM. For instance, Shen & Sheng (2024)’s viewpoint is that CsM is genealogically more closely related to Wú than to InM. (However, the Wú varieties, except the southwestern / inland subgroups of Wùzhōu 婺州 and Chǔ-Qú 處衢, have been strongly impacted by Northern Chinese later on.) Proto-CsM and Proto-Wú are descendents of the documented “Southern Dynasties Wú” or “Jiāngdōng 江東 dialect” (specifically the fourth-century CE Wú dialect spoken around Sūzhōu). Southern Dynasties Wú and Proto-InM are descendents of “Proto (Wu) Min”. The Proto-Mǐn reconstructed by e.g. Norman would then be this “Proto (Wu) Min”, originally spoken outside Fújiàn.

The diversity amongst the three ZSM varieties is often understated. This has contributed towards the often-encountered characterisation that the three ZSM varieties are very close to each other. The degree of mutual intelligibility – without prior exposure – amongst the three ZSM varieties is “quite minimal” (e.g. Bodman 1982:2–3, Gao 2000:250). Traditionally, speakers of different ZSM varieties use ZSY (or Cantonese) as their *lingua franca*.

Another characterisation commonly found in Chinese literature is that the ZSM varieties are all Southern Mǐn, as they are clearly Mǐn, typologically like Southern Mǐn, and all the other Mǐn varieties in Guǎngdōng are Fújiàn Southern Mǐn or derivatives thereof (see e.g. §2.5). These opinions have been noted by Western linguistic circles as well. For instance, Glottolog 5.1 (Hammarström et al. 2024) lumps all three ZSM varieties under a single ZSM node under Southern Mǐn (Mǐn Nán): Sino-Tibetan > Sinitic > Mǐn > Coastal Mǐn > Min Nan Chinese > Zhongshan Mǐn > Longdu / Nanlang / Sanxiang.⁹

There has been research discussing the EM vs. PXM vs. SM features in the ZSM varieties, e.g. Gao (2000), Lin & Chen (1996:181–187), and Chen (2007a). Nonetheless, retentions, shared innovations, and parallel developments are not distinguished in many of these discussions. In addition, the historical phonological characteristics of the ZSM varieties are often discussed only in relation to Middle Chinese categories, when a significant portion of the material came from Proto-Mǐn and not from Middle Chinese. There are relatively few discussions on the relationship that the ZSM varieties have with Proto-Mǐn and its daughter nodes as reconstructed through the comparative method.

The aim of this article is to gather in one place the arguments on the linguistic affiliation of the three ZSM varieties found in the literature. Many of these arguments are made in Chinese publications; we aim to bring (our take on) these arguments to the Anglophone audience. We review some of these arguments, and we also contribute some extra data which further support the conclusions that Longdu and Namlong are EM and Samheung is SM. We also show some borrowed features.

The ZSM data are from various published sources. An abbreviation in small caps follows a ZSM form indicating its source if the source is not clear from the main text. See the beginning of each section (Longdu §2, Namlong §3, Samheung §4) or the “data sources” section at the end of this article for these abbreviations.

For research on an individual ZSM variety, see their respective section. General research on ZSM, or wider research which includes discussions on ZSM, include Lin & Chen (1996), Chen (1995, 1996, 2007b), Lin (1997), He (2008), and Gao (1997, 2000, 2018).

1.3 Other background issues

There are two background issues which are not discussed in detail in this article. The first is the givenness that the ZSM varieties are members of Mǐn, and more specifically CsM. The Mǐn affiliation of the ZSM varieties is obvious. They have typical Mǐn vocabulary (e.g. Norman 1991; Li 2001b) like 厝¹⁰ ‘house’ (Longdu *ts^hiə⁵* GR, Namlong *ts^hiə⁵* GR, Samheung *ts^hu⁵* GR) and 厝¹¹ ‘son’ (Longdu *kien³* GR, Namlong *kien³* GR, Samheung *kia³* GR). (Contrasting with ZSY / Cantonese 屋 *ok⁷* ‘house’, ZSH 屋 *vuk⁷* ‘house’; ZSY / Cantonese 仔 *tsi³* ‘son’, ZSH - 仔 *-tse³* DIM, 賴子 *lai⁵ tsz²* ‘son’.) The forms in the colloquial stratum trace to Pro-

9 Glottolog 5.3 (Hammarström et al. 2026) now reflects a position which aligns with the position in this article: “Longdu” and “Nanlang” under “Min Dong Chinese”, and “Sanxiang” under “Min Nan Chinese”. However, under Min Nan Chinese, there is still a node called “Zhongshan Mǐn”, which should have been made obsolete.

10 The Mǐn morpheme for “house” (e.g. Taiwanese SM *ts^hu⁵*, Fúzhōu EM */ts^huo⁵/* [ts^huo⁵ɿɿ]) is commonly written 厝. Zeng et al. (2024) show that 厝 is a newer rendition; this morpheme was written 舍 (‘lodge’) in earlier documents, and Zēng et al. argue that 舍 (Old Chinese *[ɿ]Ak-s) is the etymon of this morpheme. There is also Norman (1988:232)’s theory that the etymon of this morpheme is 戍 (‘barracks’, Old Chinese *[ɿ]o-s).

to-Mǐn and not Middle Chinese, e.g. 樹 ‘tree’ Proto-Mǐn **džh- > Longdu *ts^hiu⁵* ZL, *ts^hiu⁶* GR, Namlong *ts^hiu⁵* GR, Samheung *ts^hiu⁶* GR/LC, cf. Teochew (Cháozhōu) SM *ts^hiu⁶*, Fúqīng EM /*ts^hiu⁵*/ [t^hieuŋ]. (Contrasting with 樹 ‘tree’ Middle Chinese ʒ- > ZSY *sy⁵*, Cantonese *sy⁶*, ZSH *su⁵*, Mandarin *su⁵*.) Another example is 蟲 ‘insect’ Proto-Mǐn **dh- > Longdu *t^hɛŋ²* ZL, Namlong *t^hɔŋ²* GR, Samheung *t^haŋ²* LC, cf. Teochew SM *t^haŋ²*, Fúqīng EM *t^huŋ²*. (Contrasting with 蟲 ‘insect’ Middle Chinese ʈ- > ZSY / Cantonese *ts^hoŋ²*, ZSH *ts^huŋ²*, Mandarin *t^ʂoŋ²*.) ZSM has not developed labiodentals (in the colloquial stratum), like most other Mǐn varieties, e.g. 飛 ‘fly’ Proto-Mǐn **p- > Longdu [pʊɔɪŋ] KS, *pɔi¹* GR, Namlong *pɔi¹* GR, Samheung *pɔi¹* GR, cf. Teochew SM *pue¹*, Fúqīng EM *puoi¹*. This is unlike most Sinitic languages, where Middle Chinese bilabial oral initials¹¹ have turned into labiodentals when followed by roundedness (e.g. 飛 ‘fly’ Middle Chinese p- > ZSY *fi¹*, Cantonese *fei¹*, ZSH *fui¹*, Mandarin *fei¹*).¹² The ZSM varieties also have rich systems of right-headed tone sandhi, which is typical of CsM. This contrasts strongly with Yuè and Hakka, which are on average poor in tone sandhi (but see also the comment below on some Hafong varieties).

That the ZSM varieties are Coastal Mǐn [CsM] and not Inland Mǐn [InM] is also obvious. The ZSM varieties follow the CsM development of Proto-Mǐn **lh- > *l- ~ *n- (e.g. 聾 ‘deaf’ **lh- > Longdu *leŋ²* ZL, *leŋ²* LC, Namlong *lɔŋ²* GR, Samheung *laŋ²* LC, cf. Teochew SM *laŋ²*, Fúqīng EM *lɔŋ²*), whereas InM has *lh- > *s- (e.g. 聾 ‘deaf’ **lh- > Jiàn’ōu 建甌 Northern Mǐn [NM] *soŋ⁵*, Shàowǔ 邵武 Western Mǐn [WM] *suŋ⁷*, Yǒng’ān 永安 Central Mǐn [CnM] *saŋ²*). Also like other CsM varieties, a distinction between the Proto-Mǐn plain and “softened” initials (e.g., Norman 1986; Handel 2003; Baxter 2014; Kwok 2018:176) is absent in ZSM. The Mǐn lexical items in the ZSM varieties align with those in CsM and not InM. For instance, for the third person singular pronoun, ZSM uses the CsM 伊 (Longdu *i¹* GR, Namlong *i³* GR, Samheung *i¹* GR, cf. Teochew SM *i¹*, Fúqīng EM *i¹*), whereas InM tends to use 渠/佢 (e.g. Jiàn’ōu NM 佢 *k^hy⁸*, Yǒng’ān CnM 佢 *gy¹*),¹³ same source as Yuè (e.g. ZSY 渠 *k^hy²*, Cantonese 佢 *k^hɔy⁴*) and Hakka (e.g. ZSH 其 *ki²*).¹⁴ For “pig”, the ZSM varieties use the generic Sinitic morpheme 豬 (Longdu *ti¹* GR/ZL/LC, Namlong *ti¹* GR, Samheung *tu¹* GR/LC), similar to other CsM varieties (e.g. Teochew SM *tu¹*, Fúqīng EM *ty⁴*), and not InM 豨 (e.g. Jiàn’ōu NM *k^hy³*, Yǒng’ān CnM *k^hyi³*). That the ZSM varieties are CsM and not InM is given; this article is about the affiliation of the three ZSM varieties within CsM.

The second background matter that is not discussed in detail in this article is the language contact situation between ZSM, ZSY, and ZSH. As small minorities in Zhōngshān, and the wider Pearl River Delta, the ZSM varieties have been very strongly influenced by the dominant Yuè. This makes them very distinct from other Mǐn varieties. (It is common for the Guǎngdōng Mǐn varieties to have some Yuè influence, but the level of Yuè influence in ZSM is of a different magnitude.) The composition of the Yuè influence is different in the three ZSM varieties. The Yuè influence in Longdu is a mix of Cantonese and Shekki. The Yuè influence in Namlong is primarily Shekki. The Yuè influence in Samheung is a mix of Cantonese and Hafong (Gao 2018:16).

11 Chinese linguistics traditionally uses the “initial–final” model of syllabification. For instance, Mandarin 關 [kuanŋ] ‘barrier’ has a /k-/ initial and a /-uan/ final; 員 [qɛnŋ] ‘personnel’ has a zero initial and a /-yan/ final. On the other hand, Cantonese and many other Yuè and Southern Pínghuà dialects are often described using the “onset–rime” model of syllabification. For instance, Cantonese 關 [kuanŋ] ‘barrier’ has a /k-/ onset and an /-an/ rime; 員 [qɛnŋ] ‘personnel’ has a /j-/ onset (or a zero onset with an inserted phonetic [ɥ-]) and an /-yn/ rime. Usually “initial” and “final” are used in this article, and “onset” and “rime” are used when appropriate.

12 Many Hakka dialects and some Yuè dialects have kept a bilabial pronunciation for this initial in some instances, e.g. Moiye (Méixiàn) Hakka 飛 ‘fly’ colloquial *pi¹* (literary *fi¹*), Nánhǎi Shātóu Yuè 飛 *p^hei¹*.

13 Shàowǔ WM has totally different pronouns; see Ngai (2021:51–55).

14 More specifically, there are two forms of the third person singular pronoun 渠: the unrounded “渠 1” and the rounded “渠 2” (Mei 2013:167–173). InM shares the rounded “渠 2” with Yuè and Hakka (the rounded vowel is maintained in some Yuè dialects and a few peripheral Hakka dialects). The unrounded “渠 1” can be seen in Gàn and Wú (see also Shen & Sheng 2024:228–229).

The large amount of phonological, lexical, and grammatical influences from Yuè can be easily seen in the three ZSM varieties. For Longdu, see Egerod (1956:76–82) for the Yuè influence on Longdu in general. The CsM varieties are famous for having many doublets; they have a “colloquial stratum”, which is usually pronunciations inherited from Proto-Mǐn, and a “literary stratum”, which is usually pronunciations borrowed from Middle Chinese. The ZSM varieties, on the other hand, have borrowed yet another entire literary stratum from Yuè, with additional Yuè segments and tones. (The Yuè segments and tones have also “infected” some of the native Mǐn morphemes.) For instance, the ZSM varieties have all borrowed /f-/ from Yuè.¹⁵ The Mǐn languages are famous for not having developed labiodentals; the very few Mǐn varieties that have labiodentals are all strongly impacted by other languages, e.g. Shàowǔ WM (e.g. Ngai 2021) with its Gàn and Hakka influences, many Zhèjiāng EM varieties (e.g. Akitani 2005) with their Wú influences, and the ZSM varieties with their Yuè influences. Another typical-Yuè trait that the ZSM varieties have is their /a/ vs. /ə/ contrast. (This contrast is sometimes described as long versus short /a/ in Yuè studies.) See, e.g., Gao (2002) on the native Mǐn versus borrowed Yuè tones in ZSM, Chen (2007b) on the Yuè phonological influences in Longdu EM, and Chen & Xu (2012) on the three phonological strata in Namlong EM.

The lexical influence is also obvious. Words depicting “modern” concepts are all calqued or phonetically loaned from Yuè. Even some basic words have been Yuè-ised. For instance, they all use a local Yuè word 肴／饀 (“meat dish” in literary Chinese) for “meat” (Chen 1996:44): Longdu EM 瘠肴 *sen³⁻⁷ gau²* GR (thin meat) ‘lean meat’, Namlong EM 豬肴 *ti¹⁻² gau²* GR (swine meat) ‘pork’, Samheung SM 豬肴 *tu¹ gau²* GR ‘pork’, 瘠肴 *san³⁻⁶ gau²* GR ‘lean meat’, cf. older ZSY 肴 *ɲau²* GR ‘meat’, Zhōngshān Gǔzhèn Yuè (Szeyap) 肴 [ɲau⁴] GR ‘meat dish’. Mǐn varieties usually use 肉 (Proto-Mǐn **nh-) for “meat”, e.g. Fúzhōu EM *ny²⁸*, Proto-SM *nhuk⁸ > Quánzhōu SM *hiak⁸*, Teochew SM *nek⁸*; or another form *ba²⁷ in SM, e.g. Xiàmén SM *ba²⁷* (see Zeng [2021] for words for “meat / flesh” in SM). For the word “egg”, Longdu EM and Namlong EM use an obviously Yuè (and Hakka) word 春 ‘spring (season)’ (Chen 1996:44): Longdu EM 雞春 *kie¹⁻² ts^hun¹* (fowl egg) GR, Namlong EM 雞春 *kia¹⁻³ ts^hon¹* GR, cf. ZSY 雞春 *kvi¹ ts^hon¹* GR, Hafong 雞春 *kvi¹⁻² ts^hen¹* GR, ZSH 雞春 *kai¹ ts^hun¹* GJ. (Samheung SM, on the other hand, uses a typical Mǐn word 卵 [Proto-SM *nuĩ⁴], e.g. 雞卵 *ke¹ nui¹* GR ‘chicken egg’, 鴨卵 *a²⁷ nui¹* GR ‘duck egg’.)

As for grammatical influences, one sees, e.g., Yuè particles like Cantonese 緊 *kən³* for progressive aspect in all three ZSM varieties (Longdu and Namlong EM *kin³*, Samheung SM *kin³⁻⁶*). Fújiàn Mǐn varieties usually do not allow bare [CLF + N] phrases in isolation (e.g. Wang 2015, Chappell 2019). On the other hand, ZSM and many other Guǎngdōng Mǐn varieties allow them, under the influence of Yuè. See, e.g., Chen & Chen (2003) on the Yuè grammatical influences in ZSM in general, and Sio (2024) on Longdu noun phrase semantics.

In the other direction, Mǐn has also influenced Heungshan Yuè. In earlier times, ZSM was the majority, and Heungshan Yuè was the minority in the Heungshan Islands. One feature that sets Heungshan Yuè apart from the other Yuè groups is its Mǐn traits. For instance, ZSY has many cases of *h-* corresponding with *f-* in Cantonese and other Yuè dialects, e.g. 風 ‘wind’ ZSY *hoŋ¹* vs. Cantonese *foŋ¹* (also Mandarin *fēng¹*). This is an influence from ZSM, cf. Longdu EM *hoŋ¹* ZL/LC, Namlong EM *hɔŋ¹* GR, Samheung SM *hoŋ¹* LC. (For this initial, Mǐn languages usually have *p-/p^h-* in the colloquial stratum, and *h-* in the literary stratum, e.g. Fúqīng

15 Usually in words directly borrowed from Yuè with *f-*. The cognates in other Mǐn dialects are usually *p-*, *p^h-*, or *h-*. There are also the interesting cases of Longdu hypercorrecting the Mǐn initial *h-* to *f-*. For instance, 雨 ‘rain’ Proto-Mǐn **ɣ- > Samheung SM *hɔ¹* LC (normal *h-* reflex), but Longdu EM *fuo⁶* LC (*h- > f-). The Namlong cognate is *φo⁶* GR (Namlong [φ-] can be /f-/ or /h-/). (In contrast, 雨 ‘rain’ Late Middle Chinese *j-*, Yuè and Southern Pínghuà dialects have a *j-*, *θ-*, *z-*, *h-*, or *v-* onset, but not *f-*, e.g. ZSY *j³*, Cantonese *j³*, Nánning Pínghuà *həi⁴*. Also cf. ZSH *i³*, Mandarin *jy³*.) Another case is 園 ‘garden’: Longdu EM *fuoŋ²* LC, cf. Namlong EM *hon²* GR, Samheung SM *hui²* LC, Teochew SM *hŋ²*, Fúzhōu EM *huoŋ²*. (ZSY *yn²*, Cantonese *jyn²*, Nánning Pínghuà *win²*.)

EM 風 ‘wind’ colloquial *p^hui¹*, literary *hui¹*.) The surnames 馮 (Cantonese *foŋ²*, Mandarin *fēŋ²*) and 洪 (Cantonese *hoŋ²*, Mandarin *hōŋ²*) are both *hoŋ²* in ZSY. There is also 回 *hui²* ‘return’ in ZSY; in Yuè and Southern Pínghuà this onset is usually *w-*, e.g. Cantonese *wui²*, Nánning Pínghuà *wəi²*. Zhan et al. (2002:200) argue that in ZSY, the onset in *wui²* was first Hakka-ised to *f-* (cf. ZSH *fui²*), and then *f-* was Mǐn-ised to *h-* in ZSY *hui²*. Heungshan Yuè also has some Mǐn vocabulary. For instance, from Mǐn 風颶 ‘typhoon’ (e.g. Fúzhōu EM *hui¹ nai¹*, Taiwanese SM *hoŋ¹ t^hai¹*, Teochew SM *huan¹ t^hai¹*, Longdu EM *foŋ¹⁻² t^hai¹* GR, Namlong EM *hoŋ¹⁻³ t^hai¹* GR, Samheung SM *hōŋ¹ t^hai¹* GR) comes Heungshan Yuè 風颶 ‘typhoon’ (ZSY *hoŋ¹ t^hai¹*, Hafong *hoŋ¹⁻² t^hai¹* GR). This form is inherited by Older Macau Cantonese as 風颶 *foŋ¹ t^hai¹*, e.g. 打風颶 *ta³ foŋ¹ t^hai¹* (hit typhoon) ‘to be hit by typhoon’. (Modern Cantonese has 颶風 *t^hɔi² foŋ¹* ‘typhoon’, calqued from Modern Mandarin *t^hai² fēŋ¹*, with a different morpheme order, and 颶 having a different vowel and tone.)¹⁶

Unlike CSM, which is famous for its complex tone sandhi, Yuè and Hakka varieties are on average poor with tone sandhi. Nonetheless, some varieties of Hafong Yuè have right-headed tone sandhi (Gao 2018:73–74), similar to SM. Even the tone values are somewhat similar to Samheung SM. (See Table A1 in the appendix for the tone categories and values in the Zhōngshān languages.)

ZSH is small and does not have an overall influence on ZSM. However, there are some localised interactions. For instance, Hakka might have a minor role in Samheung SM having some Middle Chinese “tone 4” syllables pronounced in tone 1 (§4.3). Samheung SM also has some Hakka words which are not shared by nearby Yuè and Mǐn varieties (Gao 2018:326). See also Gan (2003:262–274) on the language contact situation in Zhōngshān from a ZSH point of view.¹⁷

2. Longdu Eastern Mǐn

Longdu 隆都 EM (Lóngdū, Lungtu, [loŋ¹ tu¹], [loŋ¹ tu¹ wa¹] [Longdu language] JS p.c., [loŋ¹ tu¹] EG), spoken to the west of Shekki, is the largest of the three ZSM varieties. Longdu is also the most researched out of the three. Research that focuses on Longdu includes Egerod (1956), Huang (1985, 1988), Chen (2007a, b), Kratochvíl & Sio (2018), and Sio (2024). The following are the sources of the Longdu data used in this article:

AE: Akitani (2022a), uses data from Egerod (1956), with changes in transcription

AE2: Akitani (2022b), uses data from Egerod (1956), with changes in transcription

CSH: Chang (2005)

16 The traditional word for “typhoon” in Standard Cantonese is 風颶 *foŋ¹ kɛu⁶*. See Kwok (2004:591–592) on the pronunciation of 颶 *kɛu⁶* in 風颶 *foŋ¹ kɛu⁶*. See, e.g., Li (1990, 1991a, 1991b) and Wu (2020) on Cantonese *foŋ¹ kɛu⁶* and other Sinitic terms for “typhoon”.

17 The following are some presentational issues. Proto-Mǐn forms are indicated by two stars, whereas reconstructions at the lower levels carry one star. (Early) Middle Chinese forms are transcriptions of the *Qiyùn* phonology system (i.e. they are not reconstructions), and they carry no star. The Middle Chinese transcriptions used in this article take Baxter & Sagart (2014) and Hill (2023) into account. The Old Chinese reconstructions are those of Baxter & Sagart (2014). Tone categories are indicated by superscript numbers: tones 1, 3, 5, and 7 for Proto-Mǐn and Middle Chinese tones A, B, C, and D, and tone 2, 4, 6, and 8 for the “Lower” tones if tones A, B, C, and/or D have developed two tonal reflexes. Mǐn studies and Yuè studies often use tone numbering systems that are different from the Pan-Sinitic tone numbering system used here. Phonetic tone values are indicated using Chao tone letters, e.g. [41] is a high rising tone. Post-sandhi tones (and suprafixes) in phonemic form are preceded by a hyphen, e.g. -3, and in phonetic form the tone letters face the other direction, e.g. [-]. (Post-sandhi tones are not always indicated.) The rendition of forms may be slightly altered from the published sources for consistency in this article. The vernacular forms in *italic type* are in broad phonetic transcription, i.e. phonemes with their “main” allophones, following the norm in Chinese linguistics. Akitani (2022a, b)’s rendition of Longdu <u> has been changed to uo in this article; see §2.3.5 and footnote 38 therein.

CX2: Chen (1995)

EG: Egerod (1956), data from Shan Ming T'ing 申明亭 (Shēnmíngtíng) in Sha-K'ai 沙溪 (Shāxī)

GR: Gao (2018:246–282), data from Shakai 沙溪

GR2: Gao (2000), data from Lóngtóuhuán 龍頭環 in Shakai 沙溪

JS: Sio (2024), data from Taichung 大涌 (Dàchōng)

KS: Kratochvíl & Sio (2018), data from Taichung 大涌

LC: Lin & Chen (1996)

ZL: Zhan & Cheung (1987); the Longdu data therein were compiled by Patrick Lin Bǎisōng 林柏松

Longdu is often said to be SM (see §2.5). On the other hand, Norman (e.g. 1973, 1974) groups Longdu with the EM varieties of Fúzhōu and Fú'ān in his reconstruction of Proto-Mǐn. Bodman (1982) agrees and argues that both Namlong (§3) and Longdu are EM (which he calls “Northeastern Mǐn”). Gao (2018:15) notices that the phonology and lexicon of Longdu show stronger ties with EM and PXM, and not so much with SM. Akitani (2022a) demonstrates that the genealogical affiliation of Longdu lies firmly with EM, and more specifically the Northern subgroup of EM. Akitani (2022a), written in Chinese, is carefully crafted, clearly distinguishing innovative and retentive features. Sections 2.1, 2.2, 2.3, and 2.4 in this article are structured around the Longdu features discussed in Akitani's §2, §3, and §4. Akitani discusses the features which link Longdu with EM in his §2. However, the innovative and retentive features are intersplined in his §2; here we review the innovative features and one EM-specific lexical form in our §2.1, and the retentive features in our §2.2. At the end of our §2.1, in §2.1.6 we provide an additional set of innovative features which is not discussed in Akitani (2022a). Akitani discusses the features which link Longdu with the Northern subgroup of EM in his §3. Our §2.3 discusses these Northern EM features. Akitani's §4 and our §2.4 discuss two Longdu-specific sound changes.

In our §2.5, we discuss some traits in Longdu which might cause people to mistake Longdu for SM. In §2.5.1, the typical EM typological features which Longdu lacks are discussed. In §2.5.2, some SM-looking morphemes in Longdu are demonstrated.

A big part of our §2 is based on Akitani (2022a). Firstly, it is our aim to bring snapshots of Akitani (2022a), an excellent article written in Chinese, to the Anglophone audience. Secondly, the presentation of our §2 comes from a different viewpoint. Akitani (2022a) comes from the viewpoint of Mǐn: how the historical phonology of Longdu fits in with that of the various subgroups of CsM. Understandably, as an article on historical phonology, he uses the conservative Longdu data from Egerod (1956), which are decades older than the data found in the other sources. On the other hand, we come from the viewpoint of the Zhōngshān languages. We supplement the Akitani–Egerod data with data from a number of modern sources. We agree with Akitani's viewpoint that Longdu is a member of Northern EM, but we are also interested in the counterexamples, e.g. modern data which do not align with Akitani's arguments, traits which Longdu might have acquired from other branches of Mǐn (§2.5.2), and how Longdu compares with Namlong, Samheung, and the other Zhōngshān languages.¹⁸

¹⁸ The difference in viewpoints also comes from our different backgrounds. Amongst Akitani's main areas of expertise are EM, NM, and Wú; we deeply appreciate Akitani's expertise. (Egerod [1956] is also not the easiest to deal with in terms of its presentation; we are fortunate that Akitani, with his expertise on EM, did all the work sorting out Egerod [1956]'s data.) We, on the other hand, have more experience working with, e.g., SM, Yuè, and Pínghuà. Our backgrounds complement each other's well for the study of Longdu EM.

2.1 EM innovations and EM-specific forms in Longdu

2.1.1 Proto-Mǐn ****N-** and ****ŋ-** > Proto-EM ***N-**

Akitani's feature (2-1) is about the Proto-Mǐn voiceless sonorant initials having merged into the voiced sonorant initials in EM, whereas the distinction is often somehow kept in SM and PXM. Longdu aligns with EM. The following pair of examples is given by Akitani (2022a:4):

麥 'wheat' Proto-Mǐn ****m-** > Longdu EM *maʔ*⁷, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *maʔ*⁸, vs. Xiàmén SM *beʔ*⁸, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *bia*⁶, Xiānyóu PXM *pa*⁶

脈 'pulse' Proto-Mǐn ****mh-** > Longdu EM *maʔ*⁷, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *maʔ*⁸, vs. Xiàmén SM *mēʔ*⁸, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *miā*⁶, Xiānyóu PXM *maʔ*⁸

While we think that this is correct, the following are two other possible scenarios. One possible scenario is that Longdu has this trait due to the strong impact of Yuè, of which the ancestor, Middle Chinese, only has voiced sonorants: 麥 'wheat' and 脈 'pulse' Middle Chinese *m-* > ZSY / Cantonese *mbk*⁸. Another possible scenario is that the merger is a parallel development in Fújiàn EM and Longdu (without the involvement of Yuè). If Proto-Mǐn ****mh-** (and ****ŋh-** etc.) were indeed voiceless,¹⁹ then it is not surprising that ****m-** and ****mh-** merged into one initial: voiceless sonorants are cross-linguistically rare, and are prone to being re-voiced (e.g. Blevins 2018).

2.1.2 Proto-Mǐn ****dz-** is fricativised in EM

Akitani's feature (2-2) is about Proto-Mǐn ****dz-** becoming fricative in EM and PXM. In contrast, ****dz-** remains an affricate in SM (2022a:5; see also, e.g., Norman 1991a:351, Branner 1999:40–44, Li 2002:218).²⁰ Proto-Mǐn ****dz-** often has fricative reflexes in Longdu in the colloquial stratum, same as EM and PXM. Akitani gives the following Mǐn examples (2022a:5), here we also include Longdu forms from other publications, and some non-Mǐn examples for comparison:

坐 'sit' Proto-Mǐn ****dz-** > Longdu EM *ʃɔi*⁶ AE [*ʃɔi*⁶ ZL, *soi*⁶ LC], Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *soi*⁶, Xiānyóu PXM *tə*⁶, vs. Xiàmén SM *tse*⁶, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *tsie*⁶
[Middle Chinese *dz-* > ZSY *tsʰɔ*³, Cantonese *tsʰɔ*⁴, ZSH *tsʰɔ*¹]

前 'front' Proto-Mǐn ****dz-** > Longdu EM *ʃæn*² AE [*sen*² ZL, *sen*² LC], Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *seiŋ*², Xiānyóu PXM *li*², vs. Xiàmén SM *tsiŋ*², Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *tseŋ*²
[Middle Chinese *dz-* > ZSY / Cantonese *tsʰin*², ZSH *tsʰen*²]

Here we include one more example.

19 While it is clear that there were two series of nasal and liquid initials in Proto-Mǐn, Norman (1991b) expresses uncertainty that ****mh-**, ****nh-**, ****ŋh-**, and ****lh-** were indeed voiceless in Proto-Mǐn. One anomaly is that Proto-Mǐn tone ****A**, ****B**, and ****D** syllables with a "voiceless" nasal / liquid initial are often in a Lower tone in the modern CsM varieties (Shen 2023:520–524), and Lower tones are associated with voiced initials. Nonetheless, there are also traits which suggest that these were indeed voiceless. For instance, in SM varieties, ****nh-** and ****ŋh-** often have *h-* reflexes (e.g. Kwok 2018:36–37,43; Shen 2023:527–528). Outside CsM, there is Shàowǔ WM where the Proto-Mǐn voiceless nasals are indeed in Upper tones (Norman 1974:31–32). Baxter & Sagart (2014) reconstruct the ancestors of these in Old Chinese as ***C.m(ʰ)-**, ***C.n(ʰ)-**, ***C.ŋ(ʰ)-**, and ***C.r(ʰ)-** respectively, with **"*C."** being a "tightly attached" unidentified preinitial consonant. Loans of these in Proto-Hmong–Mien are usually voiceless, and in the earliest Chinese loadwords in Vietnamese, these are in Upper tones (Baxter & Sagart 2014:171–173).

20 Akitani (2022a:5) also talks about Proto-Mǐn ****dž-** having the same development, but here we ignore Proto-Mǐn ****dž-**. Proto-Mǐn ****dž-** indeed has fricative reflexes in Longdu, but their cognates are usually also fricatives in Yuè and Hakka, so Proto-Mǐn ****dž-** > Longdu *f-/s-* does not distinguish between inheritance from EM (or PXM) and borrowing from Yuè (or Hakka). For instance, 石 'stone' Proto-Mǐn ****dž-** > Longdu EM *ʃue*² AE [*ʃue*² LC], Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *syə*⁸, Xiānyóu PXM *liu*², vs. Xiàmén SM *tsio*⁸; 石 'stone' Middle Chinese *z-* > ZSY *siak*⁸, Cantonese *sek*⁸, ZSH *sak*⁸.

槽 ‘trough’ Proto-Mǐn **dz- > Longdu EM $sɔ^2$ ZL/LC, Gǔtián EM so^2 , Xiānyóu PXM $lɔ^2$, vs. Samheung SM $tsau^2$ LC, Xiàmén SM tso^2
[Middle Chinese dz- > ZSY / Cantonese $ts^{h}ou^2$, ZSH $ts^{h}au^2$]

Probably also related is the Mǐn morpheme for ‘many’ (written 穡 / 侈 / 多 / 儕 etc.).²¹ Many branches of Mǐn have a *ts*- initial for this morpheme, e.g. Jiàn’ōu NM $tsai^6$, Yǒng’ān CnM tse^5 , Proto-SM $*tsoi^6$ > Teochew SM $tsoi^6$, Zhāngzhōu SM tse^6 , Samheung SM tse^1 GR. On the other hand, Longdu is like other EM varieties in having a fricative initial: Longdu EM se^6 GR, Fúzhōu EM $/se^6/$ [saʔ], Zhōuníng Xiāncūn EM $θe^6$. (Also Xiānyóu PXM le^5 .)

2.1.3 Proto-Mǐn ***-o* conditioned by labial vs. non-labial initials in Fújiàn EM

Akitani’s feature (2-9) is about the innovation in Fújiàn EM (i.e. not including the small EM area in Zhèjiāng) that Proto-Mǐn ***-o* has different reflexes depending on whether the initial is labial or not. This has not occurred in PXM and SM. Longdu aligns with Fújiàn EM. The following are examples of Proto-Mǐn ***-o* with different initials (Akitani 2022a:9):

布 ‘cloth’ Proto-Mǐn **labial-: Longdu EM puo^5 ,²² Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM puo^5 , vs. Xiàmén SM $pɔ^5$, Xiānyóu PXM $pɔu^5$
醋 ‘vinegar’ Proto-Mǐn **coronal-: Longdu EM $t^{h}u^5$, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM $ts^{h}u^5$, Xiàmén SM $ts^{h}ɔ^5$, Xiānyóu PXM $ts^{h}ɔu^5$
苦 ‘bitter’ Proto-Mǐn **velar-: Longdu EM $k^{h}u^3$, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM $k^{h}u^3$, Xiàmén SM $k^{h}ɔ^3$, Xiānyóu PXM $k^{h}ɔu^3$

2.1.4 Some Tone C syllables unexpectedly in tone 5 instead of tone 6 in EM

Akitani’s feature (2-11) is about how tone C syllables in EM are frequently in Upper tone C (tone 5) instead of the expected Lower tone C (tone 6) when the Proto-Mǐn initial is voiced and aspirated (obstruent or sonorant) (see also Norman 1991a:351, 1991b; Branner 1999:47–51). This is not necessarily an innovation that started in the EM region; this trait is a rather widespread areal trait that covers EM, PXM, some inland SM varieties, Inland Mǐn, and even some neighbouring Hakka and Gàn varieties. Coastal SM varieties do not have this trait. Kwok considers this an influence from an unknown substrate language (2018:119–121). Longdu often also has this trait; this strongly suggests that Longdu is not a coastal variety of SM, the type of Mǐn that is geographically closest to Longdu (other than Namlong). Sometimes we see a tone 5/6 variation amongst Longdu varieties; the tone 6 can be an influence from Cantonese, or perhaps SM. (ZSY and ZSH do not have a tone 5/6 distinction.) The following is an example given by Akitani (2022a:10):

面 ‘face’ Proto-Mǐn **mh- tone C > Longdu EM min^5 AE, [min^5 LC, but min^6 ZL], Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM $miŋ^5$, Xiānyóu PXM $miŋ^5$, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú inland-SM bin^5 , vs. Xiàmén coastal-SM bin^6
[Also cf. Middle Chinese *m*- tone C > Cantonese min^6]

Here we provide two other examples.

樹 ‘tree’ Proto-Mǐn **džh- tone C > Longdu EM ts^{hiu^5} ZL, (but ts^{hiu^6} GR/LC,) Gǔtián EM ts^{hiu^5} , Fúqīng EM $/ts^{hiu^5}/$ [ts^{hiu}], Xiānyóu PXM ts^{hiu^5} , vs. Samheung coastal-SM ts^{hiu^6} GR/LC, Teochew coastal-SM ts^{hiu^6} , Xiàmén coastal-SM ts^{hiu^6}

21 Probably a cognate of 穡 Middle Chinese $dzey^C$ ‘sheaf / bundle’. On the other hand, Shàowǔ WM has an unrelated form vai^3 ‘many’, perhaps a reflex of 夥 Old Chinese $*[g^{wʰ}]ajʔ$ ‘many’. Nearby Shùncāng 順昌 WM and Tàining 泰寧 Gàn also use 夥 for ‘many’, while Shāxiàn 沙縣 and Sānmíng 三明 CnM further to the south use a combined form 夥穡 for ‘many’ (Cao 2008: Lexicon map 159).

22 Akitani (2022a, b) renders this final as <uæ>. This is problematic; see §2.3.5 and footnote 38 therein.

[Also cf. Middle Chinese *z*- tone C > Cantonese *sy*⁶]

鼻 ‘nose’ Proto-Mǐn **bh- tone C > Longdu EM *p^{hi}z* ZL/LC/CSH, [p^{hi}:.] (tone 5) KS, (but *p^{hi}z* GR,) Gǔtián EM *p^{hi}z*, Fúqīng EM /p^hɛ⁵/ [p^hæ:], Xiānyóu PXM *p^{hi}z*, vs. Teochew coastal-SM *p^{hi}z*, Xiàmén coastal-SM *p^{hi}z*

[Also cf. Middle Chinese *b*- tone C²³ > Cantonese *pei*⁶]

See also discussions on Samheung SM 鼻 ‘nose’ *pei*⁵ LC in §5.

2.1.5 EM 兩 ‘two’ < Proto-Mǐn **-aŋ

Akitani’s feature (2-12) does not fit well with the innovation–retention dichotomy; it is nonetheless still useful for determining phylogeny. Akitani’s feature (2-12) is about the numeral 兩 ‘two’: in EM, the final traces to Proto-Mǐn **-aŋ, whereas in SM and PXM, it traces to Proto-Mǐn **-oŋ.²⁴ Longdu aligns with EM (2022a:11):

兩 ‘two’ Proto-Mǐn **-aŋ > Longdu EM *laŋ*⁵ AE,²⁵ [*laŋ*⁶ GR, [lʊaŋʔ] (sandhi tone?) JS,] Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *laŋ*⁶

兩 ‘two’ Proto-Mǐn **-oŋ > Xiānyóu PXM *nŋ*⁶, Xiàmén SM *nŋ*⁶, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfǔ SM *lŋ*⁶, [Samheung SM *neu*⁶ GR]

Compare:

23 In the *Qièyùn* (Early Middle Chinese), 鼻 is *byi*⁶. Many Yuè and Hakka dialects have this tone C version of 鼻 ‘nose’. However, most descendants of Middle Chinese have instead a tone D version of 鼻 ‘nose’. Mandarin *pi*² is an example (Middle Chinese tone D with voiced obstruent initial > Standard Mandarin Lower Tone A / tone 2). Pínghuà and western Yuè dialects also have 鼻 ‘nose’ in tone D, e.g. Náníng Pínghuà *pet*⁶. Cantonese also has fossilised instances of this, e.g. *tsæŋ*⁶ *pet*⁶ *p^hŋ*⁴ (elephant nose clamp) ‘geoduck’.

24 One reviewer kindly reminded us that, beyond Akitani (2022a)’s account presented here, we should reference two other accounts of the development of 兩 ‘two’ in Mǐn: Wu (2022) and Yang (2020). (They do not affect the analysis here that Longdu aligns with EM and not with SM.)

Wu (2022) argues that Norman (1981)’s reconstruction of Proto-Mǐn **-oŋ and **-ioŋ should be reconstructed as **-oŋ and **-jaŋ respectively instead ([ɔ] [a] are allophones of a single /ɔ/). As for the numeral **lɔŋ 兩 ‘two’ (2022: 219), EM experienced the irregular sound change of **lɔŋ > *lɔŋ. As for SM, the changes involved are **lɔŋ > *lɔ > *lɔ. The form *lɔ is commonly seen in Guǎngdōng, e.g. Cháozhōu / Teochew SM *nɔ*⁴ ([n-] and [l-] are not contrastive), and the form *lɔ is commonly seen in Fújiàn, e.g. Xiàmén / Amoy SM *nŋ*⁶. (In Wu [2022:222], we see that he reconstructs 兩 ‘two’ as **lɔŋ4, and 兩 ‘tael’ as **lian3 in Proto-Mǐn.) Yang (2020) is an article on sub-syllabic derivations amongst Sinitic varieties. These lexical differences found in the modern Sinitic varieties may or may not be documented in historical Chinese texts. Yang (2020) is not an article giving reconstructions, but e.g. discusses the chronology of the various forms involved. As for 兩 (2020:17–28), the meanings of ‘two’ and ‘tael’ are homophonous in all historical texts consulted. Looking at the modern Sinitic varieties, within every Sinitic dialect group, while it is common to find dialects where ‘two’ and ‘tael’ have remained homophonous (e.g. Běijīng Mandarin *liǎng*), many dialects have the two pronounced differently. Yang argues that all of these dialects have used pronunciations from literary vs. colloquial layers, or sometimes newer vs. older colloquial layers, to distinguish between these two meanings. Due to these developments being relatively recent and localised, the formal differentiations are quite diverse amongst different Sinitic varieties, and there is variation in whether an older or a newer pronunciation is associated with which meanings. Mǐn has the more common pattern of using an older pronunciation for “two”, and a newer pronunciation for “tael”, e.g. Xiàmén SM *nŋ*⁶ ‘two’ from an older colloquial layer, and *nii*³ from a newer colloquial layer (Yang 2020:25). (However, we disagree with Yang’s characterisation [2020:24–25] that Yuè dialects with this distinction, e.g. Cantonese *laŋ*⁶ ‘two’ vs. *laŋ*³ ‘tael’, are also manifesting a literary vs. colloquial phenomenon. The phenomenon here is a high-rising tone lexical suprafix having been applied to *laŋ*³ ‘tael’, a suprafix that is often described as diminutive. See, e.g., Kwok [2016], de Sousa [2024]. The minority of Yuè dialects where the high-rising suprafix is not used, or not as commonly used, borrowed *laŋ*³ ‘tael’ from nearby Yuè dialects. Lexical suprafixation is perpendicular to the literary-vs.-colloquial dimension; a lexical suprafix can be applied to both literary and colloquial pronunciations.)

25 Akitani (2022a:11) raises a question over the tone 5 in the form 兩 *laŋ*⁵ recorded by Egerod. Looking at other publications, in Longdu tone 5 is not a possible sandhi tone of tone 6. (兩 is meant to be in tone 4, and in many Mǐn varieties tone 4 has merged into tone 6.). The tone 5 in 兩 *laŋ*⁵ is an influence from ZSY: Egerod’s Longdu tone 5 [ɿ] ~ [ɿ] is the phonetic equivalent of ZSY tone 3 [ɿɿ], or [ɿɿ] in sandhi situations, e.g. ZSY 兩個 /liɔŋ³ kɔ⁵/ [liɔŋɿɿ kɔ⁵] (two CLF). (ZSY does not have a tone-3/4 distinction.)

- 病 ‘sick’ Proto-Mǐn *-aŋ > Longdu EM *paŋ*⁶ AE, [[pɑ:ŋ]] KS, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *paŋ*⁶, (Xiānyóu PXM *pã*⁶, Xiàmén SM *pĩ*⁶, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *pĩ*², [Samheung SM *pai*⁶ LC, *pvi*¹ GR])
- 長 ‘long’ Proto-Mǐn *-oŋ > Xiānyóu PXM *tj*², Xiàmén SM *tj*², Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *tj*², [Samheung SM *teu*² GR, *tou*² LC,] (Longdu EM *tɔŋ*² AE, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *touŋ*²)

2.1.6 Reflexes of Proto-CsM *-ə finals in Proto-EM

Here we provide a small set of Proto-EM innovations that are not mentioned in Akitani (2022a). We shall have a look at the finals containing the vowel *ə in Proto-Coastal Mǐn [Proto-CsM]. With Proto-CsM finals containing other vowels, the Proto-EM reflexes tend to be conservative, or change only a little, in contrast to the often-drastic changes in Proto-SM. An example is Proto-CsM *-ian > Proto-EM *-ian, vs. Proto-SM *-iuã ~ *-uã. On the other hand, with the *ə-series of finals in Proto-CsM, the magnitude of change is similar for both Proto-EM and Proto-SM, and the differences are obvious, thus making it extra clear that a Proto-EM innovation is unquestionably an innovation in Proto-EM, in no way possible a retention from Proto-CsM.²⁶ The Longdu forms consistently align with the Proto-EM innovations; these are clearly innovations shared between Longdu and the other EM varieties. (See also §3.1.6 for the cognates in Namlong EM, Yuè, and Hakka. The Longdu and Namlong forms are, in most cases, clearly not loans from Yuè or Hakka.)

來 ‘come’ Proto-CsM *-əi:

Proto-EM *-i > Longdu EM *li*² LC/ZL, [liʔ] KS, Fúzhōu EM *li*², Fú’ān EM *lei*², Zhōuníng Xiāncūn EM *lei*²
PXM *li*²

Proto-SM *-ai > Samheung SM *lai*² GR, Teochew SM *lai*², Xiàmén SM *lai*²

雷 ‘thunder’ Proto-CsM *-uəi(?):

Proto-EM *-ai > Longdu EM *lai*² ZL, [la:ɪ] (tone 3) KS, Fúzhōu EM *lai*², Fú’ān EM *lai*², Zhōuníng Xiāncūn EM *lai*²

Proto-SM *-ui > Samheung SM *lui*² GR, Teochew SM *lui*², Xiàmén SM *lui*²
PXM *lui*²

腿 ‘thigh’ Proto-CsM *-uəi(?):

Proto-EM *-ai > Longdu EM *tʰai*³ ZL, *tʰvi*³ LC,²⁷ Zhōuníng Xiāncūn EM *-lai*³ (very few EM varieties have kept this colloquial pronunciation)

Proto-SM *-ui > Samheung SM *tʰui*³ LC, Teochew SM *tʰui*³, Xiàmén SM *tʰui*³
PXM *tʰui*³

鱗 ‘fish scale’ Proto-CsM *-ən:

Proto-EM *-in > Longdu EM *lin*² LC/ZL, Fúzhōu EM *liŋ*², Fú’ān EM *leiŋ*², Zhōuníng Xiāncūn EM *len*²

PXM: Pútían PXM *liŋ*², Xiānyóu PXM *leŋ*²

Proto-SM *-an > Samheung SM *lan*² LC, Teochew SM *laŋ*², Xiàmén SM *lan*²

陳 surname *Chén* Proto-CsM *-ən:

Proto-EM *-in > Longdu EM *ten*² LC, *ten*² ZL, Fúzhōu EM *tiŋ*², Fú’ān EM *teiŋ*², Zhōuníng Xiāncūn

26 Norman (1981) has a different treatment for some of these cases; these are considered “mixed” cases, with different branches of Mǐn tracing to different forms in Proto-Mǐn. The mixed cases relevant here are 來 ‘come’ **li ~ **lɛi (:42), 鱗 ‘fish scale’ **lin ~ **lən (:58–59), 力 ‘strength’ **lit ~ **lɛt (:58–59).

27 Longdu colloquial 腿 *tʰai*³ LC / *tʰvi*³ ZL is not borrowed from Yuè, cf. 腿 ‘thigh’ ZHY *tʰui*³, Cantonese *tʰɔy*³. (On the other hand, Longdu literary 腿 *tʰui*³ LC/ZL is probably from Yuè, or at least Yuè influenced.)

EM *ten*²

PXM *teŋ*²

Proto-SM *-an > Samheung SM *tan*² LC, Teochew SM *taŋ*², Xiàmén SM *tan*²

力 ‘strength’ Proto-CsM *-ət:

Proto-EM *-it > Longdu EM *li*⁸ LC/ZL, Fúzhōu EM *li*²⁸, Fú’ān EM *leik*⁸, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM *let*⁸

PXM: Xiānyóu PXM *li*²⁸ (Li 2001a), Pútián PXM *li*²⁸

Proto-SM *-at > Samheung SM *lak*⁸ LC,²⁸ Teochew SM *lak*⁸, Xiàmén SM *lat*⁸

PXM: Xiānyóu PXM *la*²⁸ (Li et al. 2019)

With Proto-CsM *-ək, there is no change to Proto-EM *-ək. Nonetheless, the difference between EM and SM with this is still interesting. In Longdu, at least 北 ‘north’ aligns with the other EM varieties. (However, see §2.5.2 on 墨 ‘ink’ (also from Proto-CsM *-ək); Longdu 墨 ‘ink’ is perhaps from Proto-SM *-ak.)

北 ‘north’ Proto-CsM *-ək:

Proto-EM *-ək > Longdu EM *pok*⁷ LC/ZL, Fúzhōu EM /pøyʔ⁷/ [pøyʔ⁷], Fú’ān EM *pæk*⁷, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM *pek*⁷

Proto-SM *-ak > Samheung SM *pak*⁷ LC, Teochew SM *pak*⁷, Xiàmén SM *pak*⁷

PXM *pa*²⁷

2.2 EM retentions in Longdu

Akitani (2022a) also discusses some features in Longdu which align with some retentive features in EM. Retentions cannot be used for arguing genealogical relationships (which Akitani acknowledges). That Longdu and the EM varieties in Fújiàn and Zhèjiāng share certain retentive features does not infer that Longdu is a member of EM; amongst possibilities is that Longdu and EM are sister nodes. Nonetheless, one purpose of showing these retentions is to demonstrate that Longdu has not participated in the SM or SM+PXM innovations.

We shall begin by talking about two of Akitani’s features which he considers innovations; from our perspective, these show retentions.

2.2.1 Proto-Mǐn *-a > Proto-EM *-a

Akitani’s feature (2-6) is about EM and PXM having merged the Proto-Mǐn finals of *-a and *-au. SM has kept these separate. The following pair of examples is given by Akitani (2022a:8):²⁹

架 ‘shelf’ Proto-Mǐn *-a > Longdu EM *ka*⁵, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *ka*⁵, Xiānyóu PXM *kɔ*⁵, vs. Xiàmén SM *ke*⁵, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfǔ SM *kia*⁵

教 ‘teach’ Proto-Mǐn *-au > Longdu EM *ka*⁵, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *ka*⁵, Xiānyóu PXM *kɔ*⁵, Xiàmén SM *ka*⁵, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfǔ SM *ka*⁵

Akitani considers the merger an innovation in EM and PXM. Nonetheless, there is an alternative way

28 This -k coda in Samheung SM is an influence from Yuè: ZSY / Cantonese 力 *lek*⁸ ‘strength’. As for Teochew SM, there was a (somewhat recent) shift from *-n *-t to -ŋ -k.

29 Kwok (2024) reconstructs from the intermediate step of Proto-CsM:

架 ‘shelf’ Proto-CsM *-a > Proto-EM *-a, Proto-SM *-e

教 ‘teach’ Proto-CsM *-a > Proto-EM *-a, Proto-SM *-a

Kwok’s reconstruction has a separate *-au > *-au, e.g. 包 ‘wrap’ (Xiàmén SM *pau*¹, Longdu EM *pau*¹ ZL).

of looking at this. Whatever intermediate sound changes are involved in $**\text{-au} [> \dots] > *\text{-a}$, and whatever order they have, the end result is that both Proto-EM and Proto-SM have $*\text{-a}$ as the reflex of Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-au}$. That Longdu has $-a$ reflexes for Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-au}$ does not tell us whether Longdu acquired this trait through Proto-EM or Proto-SM.

This leaves Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-a} > \text{Longdu } -a$ as the useful trait. This trait is a retentive trait. The bundle of traits in Akitani's feature (2-6) only tells us that Longdu is not SM.

2.2.2 Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-ak } **\text{-ok} > \text{Proto-CsM } *\text{-a? } *\text{-o?} > \text{Proto-EM } *\text{-a? } *\text{-o?}$

Akitani's feature (2-4) concerns the lenition of plosive codas. In SM and PXM, after Proto-Mǐn $**\text{a}$, $**\text{a}$, or $**\text{o}$, all cases of $**\text{-p}$, $**\text{-t}$, and $**\text{-k}$ have lenited (i.e. at least debuccalised). On the other hand, in EM, only $**\text{-k}$ has lenited after $**\text{-a}$ or $**\text{-o}$ ($**\text{-ak}$ does not exist in Proto-Mǐn). These look like separate sets of innovations in SM+PXM vs. EM. However, Akitani compares EM, PXM, and SM directly with Proto-Mǐn; if one takes the intermediate step of Proto-CsM into account (Kwok 2024), $**\text{-ak } **\text{-ok} > *\text{-a? } *\text{-o?}$ are in fact innovations of Proto-CsM,³⁰ and not of the daughter node Proto-EM. Both Proto-EM and Proto-SM+PXM show $**\text{-ak } **\text{-ok} > *\text{-a? } *\text{-o?}$. Longdu $-\text{?}$ is a retention from Proto-CsM. The bundle of traits in Akitani's feature (2-4) only tells us that Longdu has not participated in the extra innovations in SM and PXM (the lenition of $**\text{-p}$ and $**\text{-t}$). Akitani gives the following examples (2022a:6–7):³¹

接 'connect' Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-iap} > \text{Longdu EM } t\text{fiep}^7$, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM $teiek^7$, vs. Xiàmén SM tsi^7 , Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM tsi^7 , Xiānyóu PXM tei^6

八 'eight' Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-at} > \text{Longdu EM } p\text{æt}^7$, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM $peik^7$, vs. Xiàmén SM pue^7 , Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM pei^7 , Xiānyóu PXM pe^6

百 'hundred' Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-ak} > \text{Longdu EM } pa^7$, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM pa^7 , Xiàmén SM pa^7 , Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM pia^7 , Xiānyóu PXM pa^6

Compare how $**\text{-k}$ does not lenite (or not as lenited in PXM) when the Proto-Mǐn vowel is not $**\text{a}$, $**\text{a}$, or $**\text{o}$:

六 'six' Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-ək} > \text{Longdu EM } l\text{æk}^8$, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM $l\text{øk}^8$, Xiàmén SM lak^8 , Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM lak^8 , Xiānyóu PXM la^8

See also §2.3.1 on the dropping of $*\text{-?}$ in Longdu.

2.2.3 Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-m } **\text{-n } **\text{-ŋ} > \text{Proto-EM } *\text{-m } *\text{-n } *\text{-ŋ}$

As for the rest of the retentions, we shall demonstrate them only very briefly here. Akitani's feature (2-3) is about Longdu having retained $**\text{-m } **\text{-n } **\text{-ŋ}$, whereas SM and PXM have lenited them after Proto-Mǐn $**\text{a}$, $**\text{a}$, or $**\text{o}$, e.g. (2022a:5–6):³²

三 'three' Proto-Mǐn $**\text{-am} > \text{Longdu EM } fa\text{m}^1$, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM $sa\text{ŋ}^1$, vs. Xiàmén SM $s\text{ã}^1$, Xiānyóu PXM $l\text{ə}^1$

Contrast this with:

30 One reviewer's comment was that $*\text{-k}$ and $*\text{-?}$ would be in complementary distribution in Proto-CsM, and hence do not need to be reconstructed separately. In Kwok's reconstruction of Proto-CsM (Kwok 2024), there are contrasts like $*\text{-ok}$ versus $*\text{-o?}$, and EM has faithfully retained these contrasts, e.g. 博 'broad' $*\text{-ok} > \text{Proto-EM } *\text{-ok}$; 薄 'thin' $*\text{-o?} > \text{Proto-EM } *\text{-o?}$. There is already a rudimentary literary–colloquial distinction at the Proto-CM stage, with, e.g., $*\text{-ok}$ being a literary final, and $*\text{-o?}$ being a colloquial final.

31 In Kwok (2024)'s reconstruction of Proto-CsM, the finals $*\text{-(i)a? } *\text{-(i)o?}$ already exist in Proto-CsM. The plosive coda in the finals $*\text{-(i)ap } *\text{-at } *\text{-(u)ot } *\text{-ok } *\text{-(i)ep } *\text{-(i)et}$ lenites in Proto-SM+PXM, but the coda in the finals $*\text{-(i)ap } *\text{-at}$ does not lenite.

32 In Kwok (2024)'s reconstruction of Proto-CsM, the nasal coda in the finals $*\text{-(i/u)aŋ } *\text{-(i/u)am } *\text{-(i/u)y}\text{an}$ lenites in Proto-SM ($*\text{-aŋ}$ does not exist), but the nasal coda in the finals $*\text{-(i)am } *\text{-(i/u)an}$ does not lenite.

心 ‘heart’ Proto-Mǐn ****-im** > Longdu EM *ʃim*¹, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *siŋ*¹, Xiàmén SM *sim*¹, Xiānyóu PXM *liŋ*¹

2.2.4 Proto-Mǐn ****-an** ****-at** > Proto-EM ***-an** ***-at**

Akitani’s feature (2-5) is about Longdu lacking the SM+PXM innovation of breaking Proto-Mǐn ****-a** into ***-ua** in front of ****-n** or ****-t**. This applies together with the coda lenition discussed in §2.2.2–3. For instance (2022a:7–8):

寒 ‘cold’ Proto-Mǐn ****-an** > Longdu EM *kan*², Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *kaŋ*², vs. Xiàmén SM *kũã*², Xiānyóu PXM *kuã*²

割 ‘sever’ Proto-Mǐn ****-at** > Longdu EM *kat*⁷, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *kak*⁷, vs. Xiàmén SM *kua*⁷, Xiānyóu PXM *kua*⁶

2.2.5 Proto-Mǐn ****-i** ****ie** > Proto-EM ***-i** ***ie**

Akitani’s feature (2-7) is about Longdu lacking the SM+PXM innovation of merging Proto-Mǐn ****ie** into ****i**, e.g. (2022a:8):

四 ‘four’ Proto-Mǐn ****i** > Longdu EM *ʃi*⁵, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *si*⁵, Xiàmén SM *si*⁵, Xiānyóu PXM *hi*⁵

匙 ‘key’ Proto-Mǐn ****ie** > Longdu EM *ʃie*², Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM [-lietʃ], vs. Xiàmén SM *si*², Xiānyóu PXM [-liʔ]

2.2.6 Proto-Mǐn ****eu** > Proto-EM ***eu**

Akitani’s feature (2-8) is about Longdu lacking the SM+PXM innovation of Proto-Mǐn ****eu** acquiring an ***-i** onglide, e.g. (2022a:8–9):

鳥 ‘bird’ Proto-Mǐn ****eu** > Longdu EM *tʃæu*³, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *tseu*³, vs. Xiàmén SM *tsiau*³, Xiānyóu PXM *teieu*³

Nonetheless, looking at data elsewhere, “bird” with an **-i** onglide can be found amongst EM varieties, e.g. Matsu 馬祖 EM *tsiau*³, Ningdé 寧德 EM *tsieu*³. Three descriptions of Longdu have an **-i** onglide in the morpheme 鳥 ‘bird’: *tsieu*³ GR/ZL, *tsieu*³ LC. More investigations are needed on this (see also §3.2.6 on Namlong).³³

2.2.7 EM 曝 ‘to sun’ Proto-Mǐn ****yok**

Akitani’s features (2-10) is about the verb 曝 ‘to sun’. Norman (1981:71) reconstructs this Proto-Mǐn final as ****yok**. EM and PXM have retained ****yok** for this verb, but SM has a form which seemingly traces to ****ək**. Longdu aligns with EM and PXM (2022a:9–10).

曝 ‘to sun’ Proto-Mǐn ****yok** > Longdu EM *pʰuə*⁷, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *pʰuo*⁸, Xiānyóu PXM *pʰɔ*⁸ (see §2.4 on Longdu tone 7)

曝 ‘to sun’ Proto-Mǐn ****ək** (?) > Xiàmén SM *pʰak*⁸, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *pʰak*⁸, [also Samheung SM *pʰak*⁷ GR]

Compare:

粟 ‘grain’ Proto-Mǐn ****yok** > Longdu *tʃʰuə*⁷, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *tsʰuo*⁷, Xiānyóu PXM *tsʰɔ*⁷, (Xiàmén SM *tsʰik*⁷, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *tsʰok*⁷)

覆 ‘lie down’ Proto-Mǐn ****ək** > Xiàmén SM *pʰak*⁷, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *pʰak*⁷, (Longdu EM ?, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM *pʰuk*⁷, Xiānyóu PXM *pʰa*⁷)

³³ Like many other Sinitic languages, words for “penis” in Mǐn dialects are often derived from the word for “bird”. The irregular sound change may result from the word’s taboo nature. See Akitani (2022c) for more on the EM case.

2.3 Longdu as a member of Northern EM [NEM]

Akitani (2022a)'s §3 presents arguments that Longdu is a member of the Northern subgroup of EM [NEM]. EM is divided into the genealogical subgroups of NEM and Southern EM [SEM] by Akitani (2010b).³⁴ The SEM subgroup includes the better-known EM varieties of Fúzhōu 福州 (Hokchew) and Fúqīng 福清 (Hokchia). Akitani argues that Longdu is a NEM variety.

The following is a small introduction to the linguistic geography of the NEM area (following Akitani [2010b]'s definition of the NEM subgroup). Some of the following place names and concepts come up repeatedly in this article. The NEM area is roughly the Níngdé 寧德 Prefecture in the northeastern corner of Fújiàn, minus Gǔtián 古田 County which primarily speaks SEM. Píngnán 屏南 County shows a mixture of SEM and NEM features (Akitani 2020). The modern political and economic centre of this region is Níngdé (i.e. Níngdé-proper, or Jiāochéng 蕉城 District). Traditionally, the NEM variety spoken in neighbouring Fú'ān 福安 City had the most linguistic influence over the region. Inland from Níngdé(-proper) and Fú'ān is Zhōuníng 周寧 County. Most of the Mǐn features in Longdu and Namlong EM can be traced to these three county-level entities in northeastern Fújiàn. (The other county-level entities in the prefecture are Fúdǐng 福鼎 City, and Shòuníng 壽寧, Zhèróng 柘榮, and Xiápǔ 霞浦 Counties.) NEM is also spoken in some parts of Cāngnán 蒼南, Tàishùn 泰順, and Qíngyuán 慶元 Counties in neighbouring Zhèjiāng Province to the north (there they are strongly influenced by Wú, the dominant Sinitic dialect group in Zhèjiāng). On the coast in northeastern Fújiàn and southeastern tip of Zhèjiāng are large migrant communities of SM speakers (speaking Quánzhōu-type SM), and also some PXM speakers. In the area there are also many enclaves of Shē 畬, a Hakka-like language spoken by people of the Shē nationality, a Hmong–Mien ethnic group (You 2002).

In our §2.3.1 to §2.3.6, we discuss Akitani (2022a)'s features (3-1) to (3-6) respectively. The arguments in Akitani's §3 are on average somewhat weak. Nonetheless, the bundle of NEM-like features in Longdu discussed in his §3 does suggest that Longdu has a closer affinity with NEM than with SEM. In our §2.3.7, we extend the discussion by comparing Longdu with some sound changes discussed in another publication, Akitani (2022b). The results strengthen the argument that Longdu is a member of NEM.

See also §5 on two lexical features that link Longdu (and Namlong) with NEM.

2.3.1 NEM more conservative with Proto-EM *-m *-n *-ŋ *-p *-t *-k *-ʔ

Akitani's feature (3-1) is a retention (and hence does not help with genealogical classification). Longdu has preserved the Proto-EM consonantal codas of *-m *-n *-ŋ *-p *-t *-k *-ʔ. The NEM varieties are on average more conservative by somehow keeping at least a few of these distinctions apart (but this is quickly changing due to the influence from SEM), whereas the SEM varieties typically only have -ŋ -k or -ŋ -ʔ left. Longdu has not participated in these SEM-centred innovations.

Akitani (2022a)'s data are from Egerod (1956), which is conservative with the codas. Many modern

34 This division of EM into northern vs. southern subgroups is common. For instance, the Language Atlas of China (Wurm & Li 1987; Xiong et al. 2012) has a Fú-Níng 福寧 subgroup (i.e. NEM) and a Hòuguān 侯官 subgroup (i.e. SEM). (Wurm & Li 1987 classify the Zhèjiāng EM dialects into a third subgroup: Mánhuà 蠻話 subgroup, but this has been subsumed into the Fú-Níng [NEM] subgroup in Xiong et al. 2012.) Nonetheless, opinions vary slightly on where the boundary lies, and the features that are used to define them. The most prominent difference is the treatment of Níngdé-proper (Jiāochéng District). Akitani (2010b) and Lin (2002) consider Níngdé as part of the northern subgroup. The first edition of the Atlas (Wurm & Li 1987) considers Níngdé as part of the southern subgroup. The second edition (Xiong et al. 2012) considers the city centre as southern, and the rest of Níngdé northern. The speech of Níngdé city centre has now been strongly influenced by Fúzhōu SEM, but we follow Akitani in classifying the whole of Níngdé as NEM.

Longdu varieties have dropped *-ʔ to at least some degree. Compare the following data from three modern Longdu varieties: 學 ‘learn’ *hɔʔ* GR, *hɔʔʔ* ZL, *hoʔʔ* LC; 石 ‘stone’ *siəʔ* GR, *səʔ* ZL, *səʔʔ* LC. The Longdu variety documented by GR has no -ʔ left. It is interesting to see a change in progress in the variety documented by JS: the word 好吃 (good eat) ‘tasty’ alternates between [hɔl hieːŋ] and [hɔl hieːŋʔ] in her Longdu examples (cf. 喫 *hieʔ* GR, 吃 *hieʔʔ* ZL).

See also §2.4 for discussions on how Longdu *-ʔ syllables can only be in tone 7.

2.3.2 The vowel in Proto-EM *-yŋ *-yk is commonly backed in NEM

Akitani’s feature (3-2) is about the backing of the vowel in at least one of the Proto-EM finals *-yŋ *-yk in many NEM varieties. SEM has the vowel quality intact. For instance (2022a:15–16):

腫 ‘swell’ Proto-EM *-yŋ > Longdu NEM *tʃoŋʔ*³, Fúding Báilín NEM *tsuŋʔ*³, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *tʃoŋʔ*³, vs. Fúzhōu SEM *tsyŋʔ*³, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *tɛyŋʔ*³

肉 ‘meat’ Proto-EM *-yk > Longdu NEM *nokʔ*⁸, Fúding Báilín NEM *nuʔʔ*⁸, vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *nokʔ*⁸, vs. Fúzhōu SEM *nyʔʔ*⁸, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *nykʔ*⁸

While we think that Akitani is correct that Longdu shares this innovation with the NEM varieties in Fújiàn and Zhèjiāng, it is not easy to discount the alternative hypothesis: ZSY and Cantonese also have /-uŋ/ [-oŋ] /-uk/ [-ok] for these finals (腫 *tsuŋʔ*³, 肉 *jokʔ*⁸); Longdu could easily have the vowel in these finals influenced by Yuè, if Longdu had another vowel in these finals previously.

2.3.3 Proto-EM *-uŋ *-uk > Proto-Fújiàn-NEM *-æŋ *-æk, and unrounding of rounded front vowels

Akitani’s feature (3-3) is a combination of two traits. The first trait is Proto-EM *-uŋ *-uk > Proto-Fújiàn-NEM *-æŋ *-æk (i.e. not including Zhèjiāng NEM), whereas in SEM the vowel tends to be not as low in tongue height, e.g. -øyŋ -øyʔ in Fúzhōu SEM, -øyŋ -øyk in Gǔtián SEM, -øŋ -øʔ in Fúqīng SEM. The second trait is how in Longdu, and also in a small area in northeastern Fújiàn, e.g. Fúding 福鼎, these two finals have lost their roundedness (2022a:16–17).³⁵

蟲 ‘insect’ Proto-EM *-uŋ > Longdu NEM *tʰæŋʔ*², Fúding Báilín NEM *tʰæŋʔ*², vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *tʰæŋʔ*², Shòuníng Nányáng NEM *tʰæŋʔ*², vs. Fúzhōu SEM *tʰøyŋʔ*², Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *tʰøyŋʔ*², [Fúqīng SEM *tʰøŋʔ*²]

六 ‘six’ Proto-EM *-uk > Longdu NEM *lækʔ*⁸, Fúding Báilín NEM *leʔʔ*⁸, vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *lækʔ*⁸, Shòuníng Nányáng NEM *læʔʔ*⁸, vs. Fúzhōu SEM *løyʔʔ*⁸, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *løykʔ*⁸, [Fúqīng SEM *løʔʔ*⁸]

These changes in Longdu and Fújiàn NEM are said to be “一脈相承” [inherited through one continuous vein] (2022a:17). The first trait is most probably indeed an innovation shared between Longdu and Fújiàn NEM. (Namlong, on the other hand, has -ɔŋ -ɔk for these finals; see §3.3.3.) The second trait, on the other hand, is debatable. It is indeed the case that there is an area in northeastern Fújiàn where all or most rounded front vowels have been unrounded, when the wider region (i.e. most EM varieties and Wú) is rich in rounded front vowels. Within this “unrounded enclave” in northeastern Fújiàn are NEM varieties like Fúding 福鼎 and Fú’ān 福安. Nonetheless, the unrounding of front vowels in this part of northeastern Fújiàn is very recent: within the last two to three hundred years for Fúding (Dai 2011), and within the last one hundred years for Fú’ān (Dai 2007a). Ibáñez (1941)’s dictionary of Fú’ān EM still has rounded front vowels. On the

35 Akitani also exemplifies this unrounding with the Proto-EM finals *-y *-yn (2022a:16). Here only examples of *-uŋ *-uk > *-æŋ *-æk are shown.

other hand, Mǐn people have a much longer history in Zhōngshān than this; the majority of Mǐn-speaking villages in Heungshan (for all three ZSM varieties) can be traced to the Southern Sòng Dynasty (1127–1279) (Gao 2018:5).

In the case of Fúdǐng EM, Dai (2011:560–561) considers both internal and external factors, and concludes that the unrounding of rounded front vowels in Fúdǐng EM is primarily caused by the pressure from the migrant SM varieties. SM is spoken by 30% of the population in Fúdǐng, and the SM population in the neighbouring counties in Zhèjiāng is four times the population of Fúdǐng EM. Amongst the EM varieties in Fúdǐng, the varieties furthest away from the SM-speaking area in the north still have rounded front vowels.

The unrounding of the rounded front vowels in Longdu is not directly related to that in northeastern Fújiàn. Nonetheless, one commonality is the SM influence. One trait that sets Heungshan Yuè and Yuet Hoi / Kun–Pou Yuè apart is that Heungshan Yuè varieties usually do not have rounded front vowels. (Shekki-proper has rounded front vowels, but this is a later development [Gao 2018:32].) That Heungshan Yuè usually does not have rounded front vowels was caused by Mǐn influence, and the branch of CsM that is notable for not having rounded front vowels is SM. The entire coast of Guǎngdōng has a continuous history of visits by SM-speaking fisherfolk (e.g. Egerod 1956:6), and some SM speakers have settled in Heungshan for quite some time (Samheung SM; see §4). Under the influence of probably both SM and the “unrounded” varieties of Heungshan Yuè, Longdu and Namlong EM also do not have rounded front vowels.³⁶

2.3.4 [mb] [ŋg]

Akitani’s feature (3-4) is about how /m/ /n/ /ŋ/ in Longdu are pronounced [mb] [nd] [ŋg]. Akitani mentions that this is also the case in northeastern Fújiàn, primarily around Níngdé 寧德 and Fú’ān 福安 (2022a:17–18). (We shall ignore /n/, as its realisations in Longdu and many Mǐn dialects have other complications.) The realisation of /m/ in Longdu is variously described as [m], [m^b], [m^ɸ], or [b] by different authors, and similarly with /ŋ/ as [ŋ], [ŋ^ɸ], [ŋ^ɸg], or [g]. Some authors render these phonemes as /b/ /g/ instead. All these reflect the variations between and within speakers of Longdu.³⁷ (See Kratochvíl & Sio [2018] on the phonetics of these initials in Taichung / Dàchōng 大涌 Longdu, and Chan & Ren [1987] on these in ZSY.)

This oral–nasal variation is somewhat similar to the situation in Fújiàn SM: there is no phonemic contrast between [m] [b] and [ŋ] [g], and the [b] [g] allophones are described variously as pure-oral plosives, pre-nasalised plosives, or post-oralised nasals (see, e.g., Pan 1994, Hu 2005, Zhu 2010:201–202, Ding 2011).

Akitani’s feature (3-4) does little in distinguishing between the scenario of Longdu and Níngdé / Fú’ān NEM having shared this innovation, and the scenario of Longdu and Níngdé / Fú’ān NEM having developed this innovation in parallel. We think that the latter is correct. The likely commonality is again the SM influence.

2.3.5 *The raising of the nucleus in *-ia *-iaŋ *-iaʔ *-ua*

Akitani’s feature (3-5) is about the vowel *a in earlier *-ia *-iaŋ *-iaʔ *-ua having raised in tongue height in Longdu: -iē -iēŋ -iēʔ -uō (2022a:19). (Akitani’s renditions of <uō> and <uōʔ> are problematic;

³⁶ Although there are no rounded front vowels in Longdu and Namlong EM, in nearly all descriptions there is a rounded close-mid central vowel /ø/. This is the reflex of various earlier vowels.

³⁷ Heungshan Yuè also has this trait, and has had it for a long time. For instance, Early Macau Yuè borrowed Portuguese *bacalhau* ‘cod’ as 馬介休, inherited by modern Macau Cantonese as [ma⁴¹ kɛ¹ jɛu¹], i.e. 馬 *ma* was once [ba] in Macau. Macau originally spoke Heungshan Yuè (e.g. Ball 1897), but was Cantonised in the 1940s (Zhan et al. 2002:201–202).

these finals are rendered *-uə* and *-uəʔ* respectively in this article.)³⁸ Similar raising of *a has also occurred in NEM, but not in SEM. Akitani admits that this raising of *a in NEM may lack time-depth by looking at Early Fú’ān NEM as shown in Ibáñez (1941). Akitani discusses in depth the sound changes related to this raising of *a amongst NEM varieties.

Looking at the phonological systems of Longdu and some other Fújiàn NEM varieties, one sees slight differences in the wider situation. In northeastern Fújiàn, e.g., Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM, *-iaŋ becomes *-ieŋ* (e.g. 行 *kienʔ* ‘walk’, 命 *mieŋ* ‘life’), except that *-iaŋ remains *-iaŋ* in tone *B (e.g. 餅 *pianʔ* ‘cake’, 鼎 *tianʔ* ‘pot’) (-i is dropped in some cases; Akitani 2018:618–622). Similarly, *-ian becomes *-ien* (e.g. 鱔 *ien* ‘eel’), except that, in most cases, *-ian remains *-ian* in tone *B (e.g. 閤 *kian* ‘son’) (2018:571–573). With one exception, all cases of *-ia did change to *-ie* (e.g. 野 *ie* ‘wild’, 車 *ie* ‘vehicle’).³⁹ The situation in Longdu is different: all cases of *-iaŋ have changed to *-ieŋ* (e.g. 鼎 *tienʔ* GR ‘pot’, 行 *kienʔ* GR ‘walk’), all cases of *-ian have changed to *-ien* (e.g. 閤 *kien* GR ‘son’), while *-ia alternates randomly between *-ia* (e.g. 野 *ia* ZL ‘wild’) and *-ie* (e.g. 車 *tsie* ZL, *tsie* GR ‘vehicle’).

The narrowing of phonetic targets in a diphthong like *ia* (and *ua*) is an unsurprising sound change, and *ia* > *ie* could easily be a parallel development in Longdu and Fújiàn / Zhèjiāng NEM. Nonetheless, it is noticeable how this raising has happened in both Longdu and Fújiàn / Zhèjiāng NEM, but not in SEM.

See also discussions in §2.3.7 for related developments in Longdu, and also §3.3.5 and §3.3.7 on how this raising has rarely occurred in Namlong.

2.3.6 The pronunciation of 目 ‘eye’

Akitani’s feature (3-6) concerns the Longdu morpheme for “eye” 目 *mi*⁵- AE (*mi*⁵ *tʃiu*² EG ‘eye’, 目矚 *bi*² *tsiu*¹ GR ‘eye’). In another publication, Akitani (2020:812–816) studies the form of 目 ‘eye’ amongst EM varieties. A few types of this 目 ‘eye’ morpheme can be distinguished, and Longdu 目 *mi*⁵- belongs to his type “d”. Other examples of type “d” include Shòuníng Nányáng 壽寧南陽 NEM 目珠 [*mi*ʔ *tsiu*ʔ] ‘eye’, and Fú’ān Mùyáng 福安穆陽 NEM 目珠 [*mi*ʔ *jeu*ʔ] ~ [*mi*ʔ *jeu*ʔ] ‘eye’. The main point is that type “d” is only found in NEM including Longdu, but not in SEM.

2.3.7 Proto-EM *-yai *-uai > Proto-NEM *-ya *-ua

Now we discuss the sound changes from Proto-EM *-yai and *-uai as discussed in another publication, Akitani (2022b) [AE2].⁴⁰ Longdu participated in the Proto-NEM innovations mentioned there. In a way that is not as “neat” as we would like, for the sound changes discussed below, while the behaviour of the Fúzhōu subgroup of SEM is clearly different from that of NEM, the behaviour of the Fúqīng subgroup of SEM is less distinct from that of NEM. Nonetheless, as can be glimpsed from the rest of this §2, Longdu NEM does not show strong affinities with Fúqīng SEM beyond the fact that they are both EM. The sound changes discussed

38 This final is rendered /ua/ [oʊ] in Egerod (1956:45). The “vowel cluster” of [oʊ] is described as “[o] + non-syllabic [ɤ̥], which differs only in length from [ɔ̃]” (1956:30). On the same page, [ɔ̃] is described as “lower-mid, central or back-central, rounded, short”, i.e. something like [e] or [ɛ] in IPA. (The “dot above” diacritic indicates centralisation in Americanist phonetic notation.) In other words, [oʊ] is [o] with a mid-central off-glide. The offglide is not as fronted as Akitani’s <ue> suggests.

39 The final *-ia* exists in one morpheme, *ia*⁶ ‘mother’, said to be from *ia³ in tone *B (Akitani 2018:482). In the nearby NEM dialects of Hūpèi 虎汭 and Jiūdū 九都, they show the more common pattern of *-ia becoming *-ie*, except in tone *B, where *-ia remains *-ia*, or becomes *-a* (2018:482).

40 Unlike Akitani (2022a), Longdu is not the focus of (2022b), and hence Longdu data are not always provided in (2022b). Only Akitani’s Longdu and Cāngnán NEM data are used in this §2.3.7.

here, together with stronger arguments like Proto-EM *-uŋ > *-uk > Proto-Fújiàn-NEM *-œŋ > *-œk (§2.3.3), strongly demonstrate Longdu's link with NEM. (See also §3.3.7 on Namlong, which behaves slightly differently from Longdu with these rules.)

Before we display the data, the development of Proto-EM *-yai, *-uai, and *-ua in Longdu can be summarised as follows.

- | | | | | |
|-----|------------------|------------------|--------|---------------|
| a1. | Proto-EM *-yai > | Proto-NEM *-ya > | *-ia > | *-ie (/ *K _) |
| a2. | | | *-ua > | *-uo (/ *T _) |
| b. | Proto-EM *-uai > | Proto-NEM *-ua > | *-ua > | *-uo |
| c. | Proto-EM *-ua > | Proto-NEM *-ua > | *-ua > | *-uo |

(See §2.3.5 on the raising of *-ia > *-ie and *-ua > *-uo, and on Akitani's rendition of <uœ>, which we have changed to uœ.) The reflexes of what we reconstruct as Longdu *-ie > *-uo are as follow:

Longdu *-ie: -ie AE/AE2, -ie -e ZL, -ie LC, -ie -e GR, [-ie -ieh] KS

Longdu *-uo: -uo AE/AE2 ([œ] EG), -uo -œ ZL, -uo -œ LC, -œ GR, [-œ -œh -œ] KS

The following are the data.

Proto-Min **-iai > Proto-EM *-yai⁴¹ >

Proto-NEM *-ya

(The geographically peripheral Longdu in Guǎngdōng and Cāngnán in Zhèjiāng make a distinction based on velar vs. coronal initials. On the other hand, in mainstream NEM, Proto-NEM *-ya > *-ia in all cases.)

Velar initial:

倚／企⁴² 'stand' (*k^h-): Longdu NEM k^hi³ ZL, k^hie³ GR,⁴³ k^hie⁶ LC, [k^hiɛɿ] (tone 6) KS, Cāngnán Yántíng NEM dzio⁶, Níngdé NEM k^hie⁶, Fú'ān NEM k^he⁶, Zhèróng NEM k^hia⁶

蟻 'ant' (*ŋ-): Longdu NEM ŋie⁶ AE2/ZL, ŋie⁶ LC, g⁶ GR, [ŋiɛɿ] (tone 6?) KS, Cāngnán Yántíng NEM nio⁶, Níngdé NEM ŋie⁶, Fú'ān NEM ŋe⁶, Zhèróng NEM ŋia⁶ or ŋie⁶

外 'outside' (*ŋ-): Longdu NEM ŋie⁶ AE2, ŋe⁶ ZL, ŋie⁶ LC, g⁶ GR, [ŋiɛɿ] (sandhi tone?) KS, Cāngnán Yántíng NEM nio⁶, Níngdé NEM ŋie⁶, Zhèróng NEM ŋia⁶

Coronal initial:

紙 'paper' (*tʃ-): Longdu NEM tʃuə³ AE2, tsuə³ ZL, tsə³ LC/GR vs. Níngdé NEM tsa³ (irregular), Fú'ān NEM tse³, Zhèróng NEM tsia³

蛇 'snake' (*θ-): Longdu NEM fuə² AE2, sə² ZL/LC/GR, Cāngnán Yántíng NEM zo², vs. Níngdé NEM sie², Fú'ān NEM se², Zhèróng NEM sia²

Proto-SEM *-iai > Fúqīng-type SEM *-ia

倚 'stand': Fúqīng SEM /k^hia⁶/ [k^hiaɿ]

蟻 'ant': Fúqīng SEM /ŋia⁶/ [ŋiaɿ] or /ŋie⁶/ [ŋieɿ] (<Fúzhōu influence?)

外 'outside': Fúqīng SEM /ŋia⁶/ [ŋiaɿ]

紙 'paper': Fúqīng SEM tsia³

41 Akitani (2022b:84) argues that the Proto-EM *-iai reconstructed elsewhere, namely Bodman's unpublished reconstructions shown in Walton (1986:474–477), Wu (2007:271–273), and Akitani (2018:701; 2020:856), should be changed to *-yai instead.

42 The character 倚 ("stepping stone" or "stand" in Classical Chinese) is used more in Mǐn studies. The character 企 ("tiptoe" in Classical Chinese) is used more in Yuè studies, but 企 is also used in some publications on ZSM, e.g. GR.

43 Tone 3 is an influence from ZSY: 企 k^hi³ 'stand' (Cantonese 企 k^hei⁴ 'stand'). The vowel in k^hi³ ZL is most probably an influence from ZSY.

蛇 ‘snake’: Fúqīng SEM *sia*²

Proto-SEM *-iai > Fúzhōu -type SEM *-iai

倚 ‘stand’: Fúzhōu SEM /k^hie⁶/ [k^hie⁶]

蟻 ‘ant’: Fúzhōu SEM /ŋie⁶/ [ŋie⁶]

外 ‘outside’: Fúzhōu SEM /ŋie⁶/ [ŋie⁶]

紙 ‘paper’: Fúzhōu SEM *tsai*³ (irregular)

蛇 ‘snake’: Fúzhōu SEM *sie*²

Proto-Mǐn **-(u)ai⁴⁴ > Proto-EM *-uai >

Proto-NEM *-ua

沙 ‘sand’: Longdu NEM *sə*¹ ZL/LC/GR, Níngdé NEM *suo*¹, Fú’ān NEM *so*¹, Zhèróng NEM *sua*¹

籬 ‘basket’: Longdu NEM *luo*² ZL, *luo*² LC, Níngdé NEM *luo*³, Zhèróng NEM *lua*²

大 ‘big’: Longdu NEM /tua⁶/ [toe⁶] EG, *tuo*⁶ ZL, *tuo*⁶ LC, *tə*⁶ GR, [tə⁶] (tone 6) KS, Níngdé NEM *tuo*⁶, Fú’ān NEM *to*⁶, Zhèróng NEM *tua*⁶

破 ‘damage(d)’: Longdu NEM *p^hə*⁵ ZL/GR, *p^huo*⁵ LC, Níngdé NEM *p^huo*⁵, Fú’ān NEM *p^ho*⁵, Zhèróng NEM *p^hua*⁵

磨 ‘grind’: Longdu NEM *muo*² ZL, *muo*² LC, *bə*² GR, [m(b)ə²] (tone 3) KS, Níngdé NEM *muo*², Fú’ān NEM *mo*², Zhèróng NEM *mua*²

However, 我 ‘I’ (Proto-NEM *ua³) is different in Longdu and Níngdé.⁴⁵

我 ‘I’: Longdu NEM *ua*³ ZL/LC/GR, [wa(:)ɿ] (tone 3) JS, Níngdé NEM *ua*³ vs. Fú’ān NEM *ŋo*³, Zhèróng NEM *ŋua*³

Proto-SEM *-uai > Fúqīng-type SEM *-ua

沙 ‘sand’: Fúqīng SEM *sua*¹

籬 ‘basket’: Fúqīng SEM *lai*² (< Fúzhōu influence?)

大 ‘big’: Fúqīng SEM /tua⁶/ [tua⁶]

破 ‘damage(d)’: Fúqīng SEM /p^hua⁵/ [p^hua⁵]

磨 ‘grind’: Fúqīng SEM *mua*²

我 ‘I’: Fúqīng SEM *ŋua*³

Proto-SEM *-uai > Fúzhōu-type SEM *-ai, *-uai

沙 ‘sand’: Fúzhōu SEM *sai*¹

籬 ‘basket’: Fúzhōu SEM *lai*²

大 ‘big’: Fúzhōu SEM /tuai⁶/ [tuai⁶]

破 ‘damage(d)’: Fúzhōu SEM /p^huai⁵/ [p^huai⁵]

磨 ‘grind’: Fúzhōu SEM *muai*²

我 ‘I’: Fúzhōu SEM *ŋuai*³

44 Akitani (2022b:82–84) argues that Norman (1981)’s Proto-Mǐn finals **-ai and **-uai (:44–45, 50–51) are “大致上” [basically / largely] in complementary distribution, and “有可能可以” [can possibly] be combined into one proto-final.

45 It is not surprising that the pronoun ‘I’ has a conservative pronunciation. For instance, in Píngguà as spoken in the western suburbs of Nánning, the Middle Chinese 歌 -a rime mostly has -ɔ reflexes, like Nánning Cantonese, e.g. 歌 *kɔ*¹ ‘song’, 蛾 *ŋɔ*² ‘moth’. However, some morphemes with a more “personal” meaning have retained an -a pronunciation, e.g. 歌 *ka*¹ ‘love song’, 我 *ŋa*¹ ‘I’.

For NEM and Fúqīng-type SEM, the reflexes of Proto-EM *-uai are the same as those of Proto-EM *-ua.

- 瓜 ‘melon’ *-ua: Longdu NEM *kuoʷ* ZL, *kuoʷ* LC, *kəʷ* GR, [kəʷ^h1] (tone 1) KS, /kua/ [koɐ] EG, Níngdé NEM *kuoʷ*, Fú’ān NEM *koʷ*, Zhèróng NEM *kuaʷ*, Fúqīng SEM *kuaʷ*, (Fúzhōu SEM *kuaʷ*)
花 ‘flower’ *-ua: Longdu NEM *fəʷ* ZL, *fuoʷ* LC, *fəʷ* ~ *həʷ* GR, /fua/ [foɐ] EG, Níngdé NEM *xuoʷ*, Fú’ān NEM *hoʷ*, Zhèróng NEM *xuaʷ*, Fúqīng SEM *huaʷ*, (Fúzhōu SEM *huaʷ*)
瓦 ‘tile’ *-ua: Longdu NEM *ŋəʷ* ZL, *ŋuoʷ* LC, *gəʷ* GR, Níngdé NEM *ŋuoʷ*, Fú’ān NEM *woʷ*, Zhèróng NEM *uaʷ*, Fúqīng SEM /muaʷ/ [muaʷ], (Fúzhōu SEM /ŋuaʷ/ [ŋuaʷ])

For Fúzhōu-type SEM, the reflexes of Proto-EM *-uai are the same as those of Proto-EM *-ai / *-uai.

- 雷 ‘thunder’ *-ai: Fúzhōu SEM *laiʷ*, (Longdu NEM *laiʷ* ZL, [la:1ʷ] (tone 3) KS, Níngdé NEM *laiʷ*, Fú’ān NEM *laiʷ*, Zhèróng NEM *laiʷ*, Fúqīng SEM *laiʷ*)
怪 ‘blame’ *-uai: Fúzhōu SEM /kuaiʷ/ [kuaiʷ], (Longdu NEM *kaiʷ* ZL, *kuaiʷ* LC, Fú’ān NEM *kuaiʷ*, Zhèróng NEM *kuaiʷ*, Fúqīng SEM /kuoiʷ/ [kuoiʷ])

2.4 Longdu-specific sound changes

Akitani (2022a)’s §4 is a small section talking about two Longdu-specific sound changes. The first shows development parallel with Zhèjiāng NEM. (It is also interesting to compare Namlong with these Longdu sound changes; see §3.4.)

The first Longdu-specific sound change is Proto-EM *-æ > Longdu -i, for instance (2022a:21–22):

- 梳 ‘comb’ *-æ: Longdu NEM *ʃiʷ* AE, [siʷ ZL/LC/GR,] vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *θæʷ*, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *sæʷ*
初 ‘beginning’ *-æ: Longdu NEM *tʃiʷ* AE, [tsʰiʷ ZL,] vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *tʃiʷ*, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *tsʰæʷ*

Proto-EM *-æ has the same reflexes as *-i and *-y in Longdu.

- 四 ‘four’ *-i: Longdu NEM *ʃiʷ* AE, [siʷ ZL/LC/GR,] Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *θiʷ*, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *siʷ*
鼠 ‘rat’ *-y: Longdu NEM *tʃiʷ* AE, [tsʰiʷ ZL/LC/GR,] vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *ɛyʷ*, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *tsʰyʷ*

Akitani proposes that the sequence of sound changes was *-æ > *-æy > *-y > -i. The *-æy stage is manifested by the other peripheral NEM subgroup: Zhèjiāng NEM. Akitani gives the examples of Tàishùn Sānkúí NEM 梳 *seyʷ* ‘comb’ and 初 *tsʰeyʷ* ‘beginning’. Cāngnán Yántíng NEM 梳 ‘comb’ has an -ai final, which is an unrounded version of *-æy.

The second Longdu-specific sound change concerns tone **D syllables. While Proto-EM *-p *-t *-k syllables in Longdu have tone 7 or 8 as expected, all *-ʔ syllables have tone 7 in Longdu. The following are some examples (2022a:22–23).

Proto-EM *-ʔ:

- 百 ‘hundred’ *paʔʷ: Longdu NEM *paʔʷ* AE, [paʔʷ ZL, pəʔʷ LC, paʔʷ GR,] Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *paʔʷ*, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *paʔʷ*
白 ‘white’ *paʔʷ: Longdu NEM *paʔʷ* AE, [paʔʷ ZL, pəʔʷ LC,] vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *paʔʷ*, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *paʔʷ*

Proto-EM other plosive coda:

- 八 ‘eight’ *petʷ: Longdu NEM *pæʔʷ* AE, [petʷ ZL, petʷ LC,] Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *pæʔʷ*, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *peikʷ*
十 ‘ten’ *θepʷ: Longdu NEM *ʃæpʷ* AE, [siepʷ ZL, sepʷ LC,] Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM *θepʷ*, Gǔtián Dàqiáo SEM *seikʷ*

The following are some other examples.

- 索 ‘string’ *θɔʔ⁷: Longdu NEM sɔʔ⁷ ZL, soʔ⁷ LC, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM θɔʔ⁷, Gǔtián SEM soʔ⁷
 糴 ‘purchase grain’ *tiaʔ⁸: Longdu NEM tieʔ⁷ ZL, tieʔ⁷ LC, vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM tieʔ⁸, Gǔtián SEM tiak⁸
 學 ‘learn’ *ɔʔ⁸: Longdu NEM hɔʔ⁷ ZL, hoʔ⁷ LC, hɔʔ⁷ GR,⁴⁶ vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM ɔʔ⁸, Gǔtián SEM oʔ⁸
 箬 ‘leaf’ *nioʔ⁸: Longdu NEM nioʔ⁷ GR, vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM nyʔ⁸, Gǔtián SEM nyøk⁸
 曝 ‘to sun’ *p^huoʔ⁸: Longdu NEM p^huoʔ⁷ AE, p^hoʔ⁷ GR, vs. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM p^huʔ⁸, Gǔtián Dàqiáo EM p^huoʔ⁸

2.5 Traits in Longdu that look like other branches of Mǐn

2.5.1 EM vs. SM typological traits

The three ZSM varieties are often said to be SM varieties. This opinion is often found in popular literature. This conclusion can easily be made, as the Mǐn varieties that most people have come across in Guǎngdōng are obviously Fújiàn SM or derivatives of Fújiàn SM. The opinion that all three ZSM varieties are SM is also found in linguistic research, e.g. Lin (1997:1386), Chen (1995:249), and Lin & Chen (1996:183). Chen (1995) and Lin & Chen (1996)’s arguments are that (with rephrasing here): 1. ZSM has the consonantal codas of *-m -n -ŋ -p -t -k*, similar to SM but different from EM and PXM (they typically only have one nasal coda and one plosive coda); 2. ZSM has no rounded front vowels, similar to SM; ZSM has not developed rounded front vowels even under the strong influence of Yuè (Shekki-proper and Cantonese have rounded front vowels); 3. ZSM does not have the EM and PXM type of onset lenition; and 4. ZSM does not have the EM type of tone-conditioned rime allophony.⁴⁷

The four aforementioned traits are typological traits. Using typological traits is one valid way of classifying speech varieties. Nonetheless, this classification cannot be understood as a genealogical classification. Each of these is unsuitable as an argument for genealogical relationship in its own way.

Trait 1 (having *-m -n -ŋ -p -t -k*) is a retention, which already makes this inadmissible as an evidence for genealogical relationship. Having kept the Proto-Mǐn codas of *-m -n -ŋ -p -t -k -ʔ* is indeed typical of the SM varieties in Fújiàn, but it is not universal amongst the Fújiàn SM varieties. In addition, as discussed in §2.3.1, having only *-ŋ -k or -ŋ -ʔ* is not a trait of EM as a whole: it is a trait common in SEM. Some NEM varieties, e.g. Níngdé NEM as spoken by the oldest speakers (Ningde 1995:932), still have a complete set of *-m -n -ŋ -p -t -k -ʔ* inherited from Proto-EM. Longdu (and Namlong) are simply EM varieties that are conservative with their codas (except with **-ʔ*, see §2.3.1 and §3.3.1); they are supported by Heungshan Yuè and Cantonese, which are conservative with Middle Chinese *-m -n -ŋ -p -t -k*. (ZSH is also mostly conservative with these.)

Trait 2 (no rounded front vowels) is an innovation from the point of view of Proto-Mǐn. However, it

46 Longdu EM has copied a Yuè initial *h-*, cf. ZSY / Cantonese 學 *hɔk⁸* ‘learn’. Namlong EM has not done this: 學 *ɔ⁸* GR/CX ‘learn’.

47 The last two traits can be demonstrated using the Fúzhōu EM word 輕重心 [*k^hiŋ¹l nøyŋ⁶ niŋ¹*] (light heavy heart) ‘bias’. The morphemes are pronounced 輕 [*k^hiŋ¹*] 重 [*tøyŋ⁴14*] 心 [*siŋ¹*] individually. When put together: a) onset lenition refers to the changing of the second and third onsets from [t-] [s-] to [n-] [n-] due to the preceding nasal codas; b) tone sandhi rules cause the first and second tones to change from [1] [44] to [14] [7]; c) tone-conditioned rime allophony in EM refers to the nucleus vowel phonemes having two allophones which are used with different tones in non-tone-sandhi settings; after tone-sandhi, all vowels in sandhi-tone syllables revert back to the “basic” allophone. The vowel in the first syllable /*k^hiŋ¹*/ [*k^hiŋ¹*] (underlying tone 1) is already in its basic allophone, but the vowel in the second syllable /*tøyŋ⁶*/ [*tøyŋ⁶*] (underlying tone 6) has to revert back to [øy] after tone sandhi. See, e.g., Chen (1998), Hirayama (2010), and Donohue (2013) on these rules in Fúzhōu EM. The rules in the other EM varieties are often different from the ones in Fúzhōu EM, sometimes considerably more complex. See, e.g., Dai (2007b).

does not follow that ZSM and SM have to have inherited this trait from a common ancestor. Not having rounded front vowels is a widespread areal trait in Far Southern China, and in the wider Mainland Southeast Asia (e.g. de Sousa 2015:383–385). In Zhōngshān, ZSM, ZSH, and most Heungshan Yuè varieties do not have rounded front vowels. (That Shekki-proper and Standard Cantonese have rounded front vowels cannot be viewed as the norm in Far Southern China.)

Trait 3 (onset lenition) is indeed near universal amongst the PXM and EM varieties in Fújiàn and Zhèjiāng.⁴⁸ However, that Longdu (and Namlong) do not have this trait stems simply from the fact that this trait is a rather-recent innovation in Fújiàn. Looking at the most influential dialect in this region, Fúzhōu EM, while opinions vary as to when this innovation started, the earliest estimate is merely two to three hundred years ago (see, e.g., Chen 2010, Dai 2016). Longdu (and Namlong) EM have splintered off Fújiàn EM much earlier than this, and hence it is not surprising that they do not have the EM type of onset lenition.

Trait 4 (tone-conditioned rime allophony) is not a trait that defines EM as a whole. Many SEM varieties and some NEM varieties have this trait. One has to note that this trait is not even universal in SEM where this is most famous for, e.g. Gǔtián SEM does not have this trait. Longdu (and Namlong) have splintered off before this innovation developed in mainstream EM. (See also, e.g., Tu 2022 on traits 3 and 4.)

Longdu is typologically rather different from the better-known EM varieties like Fúzhōu (Hokchew) and Fúqīng (Hokchia). Nevertheless, as we have seen in §2.2 and §2.3, Longdu is genealogically an EM variety, and more specifically a NEM variety, as evidenced by many shared innovations.

Lastly, we must mention one typological trait of Longdu (and Namlong) which aligns more with EM (and PXM) than with SM. All of these branches of CsM have complex tone sandhi, but SM is comparatively not as complex. In SM varieties, each isolate tone (non-sandhi tone, citation tone) is usually linked to only one, or sometimes two, sandhi tones. In other words, when tone sandhi rules are applied, often no “guess-work” is needed as to which tone a tone would be transformed into. This is the case with Samheung SM. On the other hand, things are less predictable in EM and PXM: an isolate tone is often linked to more than one sandhi tone. The regular rules are also on average more complex, e.g. more conditioning by the tone of the following syllable, and sometimes even the tone of the final syllable in a tone-sandhi domain has to change. Longdu (and Namlong) align more with EM; their sandhi rules are slightly less complex than an average EM variety, but are still noticeably more complex than a typical SM variety. (See Gao 2002 on ZSM tones.)

2.5.2 *SM-like lexical items*

Longdu EM has some morphemes which look like they were borrowed from SM. (Or PXM; it is not necessarily easy to tell SM and PXM lexical items apart.) It is not surprising that Longdu has some SM influences. Firstly, Longdu people claim that their ancestors came from various locations along the Fújiàn coast, including coastal locations in the PXM and SM regions. Secondly, historically Zhōngshān had frequent visits by SM-speaking fisherfolk (Egerod 1956:6), and there is still the SM variety of Samheung (§4) spoken in Zhōngshān. The following are a few SM-like morphemes in Longdu noticed by us.

The first is the morpheme “know”. Longdu 知 *tsai^l* ZL/LC ‘know’ looks very SM and PXM. So far we have not found forms like *tsai^l* for “know” in the EM varieties in Fújiàn and Zhèjiāng.

知 ‘know’ Longdu EM *tsai^l* ZL/LC, PXM *tsai^l*, Proto-SM **tsai^l* > Samheung SM *tsai^l* GR, *tsvi^l* LC, Zhāngzhōu SM *tsai^l*, Teochew SM *tsai^l*

⁴⁸ Onset lenition is not present in some geographically peripheral EM varieties: Shòuning 壽寧 and Fúding 福鼎 in far northeastern Fújiàn, and Pingtán 平潭 off the coast of Fúqīng (Yuan & Wang 2013:52). In the Yóuxī 尤溪 dialect, which has a mixture of features from the nearby N, S, E, Cn, and PX Min groups, onset lenition only exists in some common words (Li 2021). Onset lenition in PXM is commonly thought of as an influence from EM (e.g. Li 2001a:138; Dai 2016:44).

知 ‘know’ Fúzhōu EM *ti^l*, Fúqīng EM *ti^l*, Fú’ān EM *tei^l*
 (SM varieties often also have *ti^l* as a literary pronunciation of 知 ‘know’.)
 Also cf. 知 ‘know’ Middle Chinese *t-* > ZSY / Cantonese *tsi^l*, Longdu literary *tsi^l*, ZSH *ti^l*.
 The Longdu morpheme 佇 *ti⁵* GR/EG ‘(be) at’ looks like it was borrowed from a Fújiàn SM variety:
 佇 ‘(be) at’ Longdu EM *ti⁵* [J] GR/EG
 cf. Samheung SM *tu^l* [ɿ] GR, Hui’ān SM *ti⁴* ~ *tu⁴* [ɿ], Taiwanese SM *ti⁶* ~ *tu⁶* ~ *tu⁶* [ɿ]

This is unlike:

著 ‘(be) at’ Pútán PXM *to²* [ɿ], Fúzhōu EM *tu^{o28}* [ɿ], Fúding EM *tie²⁸* [ɿ], Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM *ti²⁸* (~ *te²⁸*) [ɿ]
 ? ‘(be) at’ Teochew SM *to⁴* [ɿ]
 洽 ‘(be) at’ Fúzhōu EM *ka²⁸* [ɿ]
 在 ‘(be) at’ ZSY *ts^hɔi³* GR [ɿ], Hafong *ts^hui³* GR [ɿ], ZSH *ts^hɔi^l* [ɿ]
 喺 ~ 响 ‘(be) at’ Cantonese *hɛi³* ~ *hæŋ³* [ɿ]

There is a question of whether Longdu *ti⁵* [J] is from the EM form 著 **ti^{o28}* or not. The form *ti⁵* [J] is found in Egerod (1956:53), which is conservative with the codas and not known to drop **-ʔ*. Nonetheless, we have seen the very similar looking form *ti²⁸* in Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM. In Longdu, all **-ʔ* syllables are in tone 7 (see §2.4); a possible scenario would be that Longdu had **ti²⁷*, and then for some irregular reason **ti²⁷* [J] became *ti⁵* [J]. Either way, it remains most likely that either Longdu *ti⁵* was directly borrowed from SM, or Longdu **ti²⁷* [J] became *ti⁵* [J] irregularly under the influence of a similar-sounding form in SM.

In §2.1.6, we mentioned that for the Proto-CsM **ə* series of finals, Longdu consistently sides with the developments in Proto-EM. This includes 北 ‘north’ (< Proto-CsM **-ək*). However, 墨 ‘ink’ (also < Proto-CsM **-ək*) is different. The morpheme 墨 ‘ink’ *mak⁸* LC⁴⁹ in Longdu is perhaps borrowed from SM (or PXM).

墨 ‘ink’ Proto-CsM **-ək*:
 Proto-SM **-ək* > Samheung SM *mak⁸* [ɿ], Zhāngzhōu SM *bak⁸*, Teochew SM *bak⁸*
 Longdu EM *mak⁸* [ɿ] LC, PXM *pa²⁸*
 Proto-EM **-ək* > Fúzhōu EM *məy²⁸*, Fúqīng EM *mø²⁸*, Fú’ān EM *mæk⁸*

The Longdu form 墨 *mak⁸* [ɿ] LC is not borrowed from ZSY / Cantonese 墨 *mək⁸* [ɿ]; Longdu keeps /-ək/ /-ɛk/ clearly apart (unlike Namlong and Samheung), and ZSY / Cantonese morphemes with *-ɛk* are usually borrowed as *-ɛk* in Longdu.⁵⁰ The tone values also do not match. Longdu *mak⁸* [ɿ] LC is also not borrowed from ZSH 墨 *met⁸* [ɿ]. Longdu 墨 ‘ink’ *mak⁸* LC looks like it was borrowed from SM.

In a form recorded by ZL, the initial in 艾 *hai⁶* ‘artemisia’ looks like it was borrowed from SM or PXM:
 艾 ‘artemisia’ Proto-Mǐn **ɳh-* > Longdu EM *hai⁶* [ɿ] ZL, Samheung SM *hia⁵* LC, Xiàmén SM *hĩā⁶*,
 Teochew SM *hĩā⁶*, Xiānyóu PXM *hya⁵*, vs. Fúqīng EM /ɳia⁵/ [ɳiaɿ], Fú’ān EM *ɳe⁵*, (Longdu EM *ɳie⁵* LC)

49 GR records a form 墨 *bək⁸* [ɿ], with a Yuè-influenced vowel. ZL records only a literary form 墨 [mɛkɿ], with Yuè vowel, and a tone that does not occur in native morphemes. (ZSY 墨 *mək⁸* [ɿ].)

50 Slightly further afield, Shuntak 順德 (Shùndé) Yuè and Zhōngshān Gǔzhèn 古鎮 Yuè (Szeyap) to the north experienced **-ɛk* > *-ək* (while *-ɳɳ* is intact): Shuntak 墨 *mak⁸* [ɿ], Gǔzhèn 墨 *mak⁸* [ɿ]. To the west, most Szeyap dialects do not have an /a/ /ɛ/ distinction, e.g. Taishanese 台山 *mbak⁸* [ɿ]. We currently assume that Longdu 墨 *mak⁸* [ɿ] LC ‘ink’ is unrelated to these cases; Longdu is not known to have particularly strong interactions with these Yuè varieties.

(Also cf. 艾 ‘artemisia’ Middle Chinese η - > Cantonese ηai^6 [ɿ], ZSY ηai^5 [ɿ], Longdu literary ηai^2 [ɿ] ZL, ZSH $\eta i \partial i^5$ [ɿ].)

The Longdu form 艾 $\eta i \partial i^5$ LC is regular (for EM), with the expected initial η - and tone 5. On the other hand, the Longdu form 艾 hai^6 ZL has the initial h - and tone 6; h - is from SM or PXM, and tone 6 is what one would expect from a coastal SM variety (§2.1.4). (The final $-ai$ is from Yuè.) Interestingly, the tone 5 in Samheung SM 艾 hia^5 is what we would expect from EM; see discussions in §5.

3. Namlong Eastern Mǐn

Namlong 南 朗 EM (Nánlǎng, $nem^{2-3} l\eta^3$, $nem^{2-3} l\eta^3 \beta a^6$ (Namlong language) GR; also written 南朗 or 南望, a.k.a. 得都 Dédū, 得能都 Dénéngdū) is the second largest ZSM variety, spoken to the east of Shekki in Namlong 南朗 and Zhāngjiābiān 張家邊 Towns. Bodman conducted an intelligibility test between speakers of Longdu (§2) and Namlong in Honolulu (1982:3).⁵¹ The level of mutual intelligibility “was quite minimal”. Their lexicons “differ considerably”, and their tone values are very different (see Table A1 in the appendix). Nonetheless, their historical phonological developments are largely the same, and Bodman concludes that Longdu and Namlong are closely related EM varieties. (Bodman [1982] calls EM “Northeastern Mǐn”.) Gao (2018:284) also notices that Namlong is linguistically closer to EM and PXM, and not so close to SM.

Unlike Longdu EM, of which the Yuè influence is a mix of Cantonese and Shekki, the Yuè influence in Namlong EM is more solidly Shekki, more specifically the “unrounded” type of Shekki (i.e. no rounded front vowels) that is spoken in the Namlong area (Gao [2018:16]; see Ruan [1983] on Namlong Shekki). Amongst the Namlong Mǐn-speaking villages, some are shared with Yuè speakers, but none are shared with Hakka speakers (Gao 2018:283).⁵²

In contrast to Longdu, very few data are available on Namlong EM. The following are the sources of the Namlong data used in this article:

- BMN: Bodman (1982), data from Namlong
- CX2: Chen (1995), data from Namlong
- CX: Chen & Xu (2012), data from Namlong (data slightly different from the other Chen data)
- GR: Gao (2018:283–317), data from Lǎnbīān 欖邊 in Namlong
- GR2: Gao (2000), data from Lǎnbīān 欖邊 in Namlong
- LC: Lin & Chen (1996:158–164)

Despite the paucity of data, one could already tell that Namlong and Longdu are very closely related to each other in terms of their historical phonology. From the conclusion that Longdu is EM (§2), it follows that Namlong is also EM. The amount of innovations shared between Namlong and Longdu are numerous enough, and some of them unique enough (e.g. §3.3.7, and $*-\epsilon > -i$ in §3.4), that they must share a common

51 Honolulu (檀香山 $t^h an^2 hioŋ^1 san^1$ ‘sandalwood mountain’) has a large Heungshan 香山 community. All the Chinese schools in Honolulu at Bodman’s time used Shekki as the primary medium of instruction. The cities of Honolulu and Zhōngshān are twinned due to the strong historical links.

52 However, there are Hakka-speaking villages in the area. For instance, Sun Yat-Sen 孫逸仙, the founding father of the Chinese republic, came from Cuihēng 翠亨 in Namlong, which is a Shekki Yuè-speaking village. To the east, south, and west are numerous Hakka-speaking villages (Qiu 2006:75–76). Slightly further away is the Namlong Mǐn-speaking village of Zuǒbù 左部, which is where the Sun family ancestral shrine is located, and where most of the extended Sun family members were based (Gao 2018:386).

ancestor that is more recent than Proto-NEM (§2.3, §3.3). We call this Proto-Heungshan-EM preliminarily. However, there are two scenarios between which we are currently unable to discern: a) Proto-Heungshan-EM was spoken in Heungshan, i.e. Namlong and Longdu diverged after their common ancestor group arrived in Heungshan; and b) “Proto-Heungshan-EM” was spoken in northeastern Fújiàn, meaning that they diverged in northeastern Fújiàn, but the two groups both ended up in Heungshan (not an unusual occurrence in a mass migration event). See discussions in §3.3.3.

The rest of this §3 on Namlong is structured exactly the same as §2 on Longdu: the numbering and titles of the subsections are basically the same in both §2 and §3. Under each subheading, when Namlong data are available, we show how Namlong behaves the same as Longdu, and in very few cases different from Longdu. (Samheung SM data are also often given as a reference.) When Namlong and Longdu behave the same, the arguments that support the view that Longdu is EM in §2 also apply to Namlong, and we usually do not repeat these arguments here in §3. Thus, when the reader reads, e.g., §3.1.6, discussions that are relevant are also found in §2.1.6. Due to the paucity of Namlong data, sometimes we have to provide alternative sets of examples which are less “neat” than the ones given for Longdu in §2.

In Namlong EM, /a/ is often reduced to /ɐ/ (GR/CX’s notation) or /ə/ (BMN/LC/CX2’s notation) in what is described as an unstressed environment by Bodman (1982:12–13). These two vowels (/a/ and /ɐ/~ə/) are separate phonemes, e.g. 南 *nam*² ‘south’ vs. 脰 *nəm*² ‘soft’ BMN (< Yuè *nəm*² ‘malleably soft’). An example of this vowel reduction is 南 *nam*² ‘south’ becoming *nəm*² in 南朗墟 *nəm*² *loŋ*³ *hi*¹ ‘Namlong Market’ (BMN:12). In GR one sees alternations like 兩儂 *laŋ*³⁻² *nɔŋ*² ‘two people’ (GR:305) and 兩斤 *leŋ*³⁻⁶ *kin*¹ ‘two catty’ (GR:303). When the reader sees an *ɐ* ~ *ə* in the Namlong data, it is possible that it is underlyingly an /a/. This phonemic reduction from /a/ to /ɐ/~ə/ also occurs in Samheung SM (§4), but not in Longdu EM (§2), ZSH, ZSY, and Cantonese.⁵³

3.1 EM innovations and EM-specific forms in Namlong

3.1.1 Proto-Mǐn **N- and **N̥- > Proto-EM *N-

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu. Here we provide a different set of examples.

尾 ‘tail’, Proto-Mǐn **m-⁵⁴ > Namlong EM *bəi*³ GR, Longdu EM *bəi*³ GR, Fúzhōu EM *muoi*³, Teochew SM *bue*³, Xiàmén SM *be*³, Xiānyóu PXM *puoi*³

毛 ‘hair’, Proto-Mǐn **mh- > Namlong EM *bɔ*² GR, Longdu EM *bɔ*² GR, Fúzhōu EM *mo*², vs. Teochew SM *mō*², Xiàmén SM *mŋ*², Xiānyóu PXM *mŋ*²

(These Mǐn varieties do not have a *b- m-* phonemic distinction except Teochew SM (but see also §3.3.4 on Namlong). In PXM, *b- > p-. The SM and PXM varieties have managed to keep the Proto-Mǐn **m- **mh- distinction by adding nasality to the final in the case of **mh-. Both 尾 ‘tail’ and 毛 ‘hair’ have oral finals in Proto-Mǐn, cf. the EM forms. The Samheung SM forms 尾 *moi*³ LC, *bɔi*³ GR ‘tail’ and 毛 *mou*² LC ‘hair’ do not help, as Samheung SM has denasalised all its nasalised vowels, and there is no *b- m-* phonemic distinction.)

3.1.2 Proto-Mǐn **dz- is fricativised in EM

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu.

坐 ‘sit’ Proto-Mǐn **dz- > Namlong EM *sɔi*⁶ GR, Longdu EM *sɔi*⁶ ZL, Fúzhōu EM /søy⁶/ [sɔy⁶],

⁵³ The phonetic reduction that occurs in Cantonese sentence final particles is non-phonemic.

⁵⁴ Coastal Mǐn varieties have experienced a “flip-flop” with tone **B: **N- syllables have Upper tone B (tone 3), and **N̥- syllables have Lower tone B (tone 4) (Shen 2023:521–522), opposite of what one would expect. Amongst these Mǐn varieties, Teochew SM still has a separate category of tone 4 (which is not merged into tone 3 or 6). See also footnote 19.

Xiānyóu PXM *lɔ̃⁶*, vs. Samheung SM *tsai⁶* LC, Teochew SM *tso⁴*, Zhāngzhōu SM *tse⁶*
前 ‘front’ Proto-Mǐn **dz- > Namlong EM *sen²* GR, Longdu EM *sen²* ZL, Fúzhōu EM *seij²*, Xiānyóu
PXM *li²*, vs. Samheung SM *tsai²* LC, Teochew SM *tsōi²*, Zhāngzhōu SM *tsij²*
Also, the word for ‘many’: Namlong EM *sɛ⁶* GR, Longdu EM *sɛ⁶* GR, Fúzhōu EM /sɛ⁶/ [sa⁴], Xiānyóu PXM
le⁵, vs. Samheung SM *tse¹* GR, Teochew SM *tsoi⁶*, Zhāngzhōu SM *tse⁶*.

3.1.3 Proto-Mǐn ***-o* conditioned by labial vs. non-labial initials in Fújiàn EM

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu. Here we provide a slightly different set of examples.

布 ‘cloth’ Proto-Mǐn **labial-: Namlong EM *pθ⁵* GR, Longdu EM *puɔ⁵* LC, Fúzhōu EM /puo⁵/ [puo⁴],
vs. Samheung SM *p^hɔ⁵* LC/GR, Teochew SM *pou⁵*, Taiwanese SM *pɔ⁵*, PXM *pɔu⁵*
粗 ‘thick’ Proto-Mǐn **coronal-: Namlong EM *ts^hu¹* GR, Longdu EM *ts^hu¹* LC, Fúzhōu EM *ts^hu¹*, Sam-
heung SM *ts^hɔ¹* GR, Teochew SM *ts^hou¹*, Taiwanese SM *ts^hɔ¹*, PXM *ts^hɔu¹*
褲 ‘pants’ Proto-Mǐn **velar-: Namlong EM *k^hu⁵* GR, Longdu EM *k^hu⁵* LC, Fúzhōu EM /k^hu⁵/ [k^hou⁴],
Samheung SM *k^hɔ⁵* GR, Teochew SM *k^hou⁵*, Taiwanese SM *k^hɔ⁵*, PXM *k^hɔu⁵*

3.1.4 Some tone C syllables unexpectedly in tone 5 instead of tone 6 in EM

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu.

面 ‘face’ Proto-Mǐn **mh- tone C > Namlong EM *bin⁵* GR, Longdu EM *min⁵* LC, Fúzhōu EM /miŋ⁵/
[meiŋ⁴], Xiānyóu PXM *miŋ⁵*, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú inland-SM *bin⁵*, vs. Samheung coastal-SM *bin⁶*
LC, Xiàmén coastal-SM *bin⁶*, Teochew coastal-SM *miŋ⁶*
鼻 ‘nose’ Proto-Mǐn **bh- tone C > Namlong EM *p^hi⁵* GR, Longdu EM *p^hi⁵* ZL/CSH, (but *p^hi⁶* GR,) Gǔtián
EM *p^hi⁵*, Fúqīng EM /p^he⁵/ [p^hæ⁴], Xiānyóu PXM *p^hi⁵*, vs. Samheung coastal-SM *pi¹* GR (< tone *6),
(but *pɛi⁵* LC,) Xiàmén coastal-SM *p^hi⁶*, Teochew coastal-SM *p^hi⁶*
樹 ‘tree’ Proto-Mǐn **džh- tone C > Namlong EM *ts^hiu⁵* GR/LC, Longdu EM *ts^hiu⁵* ZL, Fúqīng EM /
ts^hiu⁵/ [ts^hieu⁴], Xiānyóu PXM *ts^hiu⁵*, vs. Samheung coastal-SM *ts^hiu⁶* GR/LC, Xiàmén coastal-SM
ts^hiu⁶, Teochew coastal-SM *ts^hiu⁶*

3.1.5 EM 兩 ‘two’ Proto-Mǐn ***-aŋ*

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu.

兩 ‘two’ Proto-Mǐn ***-aŋ* > Namlong EM *laŋ³* GR (< ZSY tone category), Longdu EM *laŋ⁵* AE (< ZSY
tone value), *laŋ⁶* GR, Fúqīng EM /laŋ⁶/ [laŋ⁴]
兩 ‘two’ Proto-Mǐn ***-oŋ* > Samheung SM *neu⁶* GR, Xiàmén SM *nŋ⁶*, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *lŋ⁶*,
Xiānyóu PXM *nŋ⁶*

Compare:

平 ‘flat’ Proto-Mǐn ***-aŋ* > Namlong EM *paŋ²* GR, Longdu EM *paŋ²* LC, Fúqīng EM *paŋ²*, (Samheung
SM *pɛi²* GR, Xiàmén SM *pɿ²*, Xiānyóu PXM *pā²*)
床 / 牀 ‘bed’ Proto-Mǐn ***-oŋ* > Samheung SM *ts^hɛu²* GR ‘table’, Xiàmén SM *ts^hŋ²*, Xiānyóu PXM
ts^hŋ² ‘table’, (Namlong EM *ts^hɔŋ²* GR, Longdu EM *ts^hɔŋ²* GR/ZL/LC, Fúqīng EM *ts^hoŋ²*)

3.1.6 Reflexes of Proto-CsM *-ə finals in EM

Namlong mostly aligns with Longdu, based on available data.

來 ‘come’ Proto-CsM *-əi:

Proto-EM *-i > Namlong EM *li²* BMN, Longdu EM *li²* LC/ZL, [li²4] KS

Proto-SM *-ai > Samheung SM *lai²* GR

(ZSY *loi²*, Cantonese *lei²*, ZSH *loi²*)

雷 ‘thunder’ Proto-CsM *-uəi(?):⁵⁵
 Proto-EM *-ai > Namlong EM *lei*² GR, Longdu EM *lai*² ZL, [la:ɪɪ] (tone 3) KS
 Proto-SM *-ui > Samheung SM *lui*² GR
 (ZSY *lui*², Cantonese *ləy*², ZSH *lui*²)

腿 ‘thigh’ Proto-CsM *-uəi(?):
 Proto-EM *-ai > Namlong EM *tʰei*³ GR, Longdu EM *tʰai*³ ZL, *tʰei*³ LC
 Proto-SM *-ui > Samheung SM *tʰui*³ LC
 (ZSY *tʰui*³, Cantonese *tʰəy*³, ZSH *tʰui*³)

鱗 ‘fish scale’ Proto-CsM *-ən:
 Proto-EM *-in > Namlong EM *lin*² [ɿ] BMN, Longdu EM *lin*² [ɿ] ZL/LC
 Proto-SM *-an > Samheung SM *lan*² LC
 (ZSY *lən*², Cantonese *lən*². The Namlong and Longdu forms are similar to ZSH *lin*¹ [ɿ], but this is perhaps just a coincidence.)

陳 surname *Chén* Proto-CsM *-ən:
 Proto-EM *-in > Namlong EM *ten*² CX, Longdu EM *ten*² LC
 Proto-SM *-an > Samheung SM *tan*² LC
 (ZSY / Cantonese *tsʰən*², ZSH *tsʰin*²)

力 ‘strength’ Proto-CsM *-ət:
 Proto-EM *-it > Namlong EM *lit*⁷ [ɿ] GR, Longdu EM *lit*⁸ [ɿ] ZL/LC/GR
 Proto-SM *-at > Samheung SM *lak*⁸ LC (<Yuè coda)
 (ZSY / Cantonese *lek*⁸. The Namlong and Longdu forms are similar to ZSH *lit*⁸ [ɿ], but this is perhaps just a coincidence.)

Proto-CsM *-ək > Proto-EM *-ək is not an innovation, but the reflexes in EM versus SM are nonetheless still interesting (see also §2.1.6). Namlong seems to align with EM on this.

北 ‘north’ Proto-CsM *-ək:
 Proto-EM *-ək > Namlong EM -ək GR/CX (only found in GR and CX’s examples of Namlong finals),
 Longdu EM *pok*⁷ LC/ZL
 Proto-SM *-ak > Samheung SM *pak*⁷ LC
 (ZSY / Cantonese *pək*⁷, ZSH *pet*⁷)

A Namlong colloquial stratum pronunciation of 墨 ‘ink’ (Proto-CsM *-ək) has not been found. (There is a Yuè-like pronunciation [bəkɿ] GR, with a non-native-tone, cf. ZSY / Cantonese *mək*⁸ [ɿ].)

⁵⁵ In fact, Namlong EM has both 雷翁 *lei*²⁻³ ɔŋ¹ and *lui*²⁻³ ɔŋ¹ ‘thunder deity’, 雷拍 *lei*² pʰa⁷ and *lui*² pʰa⁷ ‘thunder strike’ (all GR). The *lui*² pronunciation presents some questions. Turning first to Longdu, the literary pronunciation of *lui*⁶ [ɿɿ] ZL in Longdu is clearly a borrowing, as it has a Yuè-like tone (ZSY *lui*² [ɿɿ], Cantonese *ləy*² [ɿɿ]). On the other hand, the *lui*² form in Namlong has the same tone as the colloquial pronunciation *lei*² [ɿ]. The literary forms of 雷 ‘thunder’ in EM varieties usually have a more-open vowel, e.g. Ningdé EM *loi*², Fúqīng EM *loi*², Fúzhōu EM *ləy*². (The colloquial pronunciation is *lai*² in these three EM varieties.) The *lui*² pronunciation in Namlong EM is perhaps an EM literary pronunciation that has been overlaid by a vowel from Yuè, Hakka, and/or SM.

3.2 EM retentions in Namlong

3.2.1 Proto-Mǐn *-a > Proto-EM *-a

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu. Namlong did not participate in Proto-Mǐn *-a > Proto-SM *-e. Here we provide a different set of examples.

茶 ‘tea’ Proto-Mǐn *-a > Namlong EM *ta*² GR, Longdu EM *ta*² GR, Fúzhōu EM *ta*², vs. Samheung SM *tɛ*² LC, Xiàmén SM *tɛ*², Teochew SM *tɛ*²

炒 ‘fry’ Proto-Mǐn *-au > Namlong EM *tsʰa*³ GR, Longdu EM *tsʰa*³ GR, Fúzhōu EM *tsʰa*³, Samheung SM *tsʰa*³ LC, Xiàmén SM *tsʰa*³, Teochew SM *tsʰa*³

3.2.2 Proto-Mǐn *-ak **ok > Proto-CsM *-a? *-o? > Proto-EM *-a? *-o?

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu (but see §3.3.1 on the dropping of *-ʔ). Namlong did not participate in the lenition of *-p and *-t in Proto-SM+PXM.

接 ‘connect’ Proto-Mǐn *-iap > Namlong EM *tsip*⁷ GR, Longdu EM *tʃiep*⁷ AE, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM *teip*⁷, vs. Samheung SM *tsi*⁷ LC, Xiàmén SM *tsi*⁷

八 ‘eight’ Proto-Mǐn *-at > Namlong EM *pɛt*⁷ GR/CX2, Longdu EM *pæt*⁷ AE, *pɛt*⁷ ZL, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM *pɛt*⁷, vs. Samheung SM *pai*⁷ LC, Xiàmén SM *pue*⁷

百 ‘hundred’ Proto-Mǐn *-ak > Namlong EM *pa*⁷ GR, Longdu EM *pa*⁷ GR, *pa*⁷ AE/ZL, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM *pa*⁷, Samheung SM *pai*⁷ LC, Xiàmén SM *pa*⁷

Compare how *-k does not lenite when the Proto-Mǐn vowel is not **a, **a, or **o:

毒 ‘poison’ Proto-Mǐn *-uk > Namlong EM *tɔk*⁸ GR, Longdu EM *tek*⁸ LC, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM *tok*⁸, Samheung SM *tak*⁸, Xiàmén SM *tak*⁸

3.2.3 Proto-Mǐn *-m *-n *-ŋ > Proto-EM *-m *-n *-ŋ

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu. Namlong did not participate in the lenition of *-m, *-n, and *-ŋ after **a, **a, or **o in Proto-SM+PXM.

三 ‘three’ Proto-Mǐn *-am > Namlong EM *sam*¹ GR, Longdu EM *sam*¹ LC/ZL, vs. Samheung SM *sa*¹ LC, Xiàmén SM *sã*¹

生 ‘give birth’ Proto-Mǐn *-aŋ > Namlong EM *sɛŋ*¹ GR, Longdu EM *saŋ*¹ GR/ZL, vs. Samheung SM *sai*¹ LC, Xiàmén SM *sĩ*¹

Contrasting with:

心 ‘heart’ Proto-Mǐn *-im > Namlong EM *sim*¹ GR, Longdu EM *sim*¹ LC/ZL, Samheung SM *sim*¹ LC, Xiàmén SM *sim*¹

3.2.4 Proto-Mǐn *-an *-at > Proto-EM *-an *-at

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu. Namlong did not participate in the breaking of Proto-Mǐn *-a into *-ua (in front of *-n or *-t) in Proto-SM+PXM.

寒 ‘cold’ Proto-Mǐn *-an > Namlong EM *kan*² GR, Longdu EM *kan*² AE, vs.⁵⁶ Xiàmén SM *kũã*²

割 ‘sever’ Proto-Mǐn *-at > Namlong EM *kat*⁷ ~ *kɛt*⁷ GR, Longdu EM *kat*⁷ AE/ZL/LC, vs. Samheung SM *kua*⁷ LC, Xiàmén SM *kua*⁷

56 In Samheung SM, we could only find a Cantonese pronunciation for 寒 ‘cold’: *hɔn*⁶ [ɿ] LC (cf. Cantonese 寒 *hɔn*² [ɿ]). There are other words for “cold”, like *tsʰin*⁵ GR (cf. Taiwanese SM 清 *tsʰin*⁵).

3.2.5 *Proto-Mǐn **-i **-ie > Proto-EM *-i *-ie*

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu. Namlong did not participate in the merger of ***-ie* into ***-i* in Proto-SM+PXM.

四 ‘four’ Proto-Mǐn ***-i* > Namlong EM *si^s* GR, Longdu EM *ʃi^s* AE, Samheung SM *si^s* GR, (*si^l* LC < Yuè tone value), Xiàmén SM *si^s*

匙 ‘key’ Proto-Mǐn ***-ie* > Namlong EM *sia²* GR, Longdu EM *ʃie²* AE, vs. Samheung SM *si²* GR, Xiàmén SM *si²*

3.2.6 *Proto-Mǐn **-eu > Proto-EM *-eu*

Namlong’s behaviour in terms of Akitani (2022a:8–9)’s feature (2-8) requires more investigations. The point of Akitani’s feature (2-8) is that EM varieties should not have participated in the Proto-SM+PXM innovation of ***-eu > *-ieu* (see §2.2.6). Akitani’s Longdu form (from Egerod 1956) 鳥 *tʃeu³* AE ‘bird’ conforms to this rule. So does the Namlong final 鳥 *-eu* recorded by CX (different from 笑 *-ieu* ‘laugh’; both belong to the colloquial stratum). However, the Namlong form 鳥 *tsieu³* ‘bird’ recorded by GR, and the Longdu forms *tsieu³* GR/ZL and *tsieu³* LC, do not conform to this rule. (Samheung SM has 鳥 *tsiu³* GR/LC. See also §2.2.6 on Longdu.)

3.2.7 *EM 曝 ‘to sun’ Proto-Mǐn **-yok*

Namlong seems to behave the same as Longdu. Norman (1981:71) reconstructs 曝 ‘to sun’ as ***-yok*. Namlong and Longdu align with EM and PXM in having a retentive ***-yok* form. SM, on the other hand, has a form which seems to have descended from ***-ək*.

曝 ‘to sun’ Proto-Mǐn ***-yok* > Namlong EM *p^{huo}⁸* BMN, *p^hθ⁸* GR, Longdu EM *p^{huo}θ⁷* AE, *p^hθ⁷* GR, Fúzhōu EM *p^{huo}θ⁸*, Xiānyóu PXM *p^hɔ²⁸*

曝 ‘to sun’ Proto-Mǐn ***-ək* (?) > Samheung SM *p^{hak}7* GR, Xiàmén SM *p^{hak}8*, Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú SM *p^{hak}8*

Compare (perfect comparisons cannot be found):

粟 ‘grain’ Proto-Mǐn ***-yok* > Namlong EM *ts^{hi}io⁸* BMN, *ts^{hi}θ⁷* GR, Longdu EM *tʃ^{huo}θ⁷* AE, *ts^{hi}θ⁷* GR, Fúzhōu EM /ts^{huo}θ⁷/ [ts^{huo}θ⁴], Xiānyóu PXM *ts^hp²⁷*, (Samheung SM *ts^{hi}io²⁷* LC, *ts^{hi}ɔk⁷* GR, Xiàmén SM *ts^hrk⁷*)

剥 ‘to peel’ Proto-Mǐn ***-yok* > Namlong EM *bɔ⁵* GR, Longdu EM *mo²⁷* LC, Fúzhōu EM /puo²⁷/ [p^{huo}θ⁴], Xiānyóu PXM *pv²⁷*

剥 ‘to peel’ Proto-Mǐn ***-ək* (?) > Samheung SM *pak⁷* LC, Xiàmén SM *pak⁷*

腹 ‘belly’ Proto-Mǐn ***-ək* > Xiàmén SM *pak⁷*, (Longdu EM *p^{hek}8* GR, Fúzhōu EM /pu²⁷/ [pou²⁴], Xiānyóu PXM *pa²⁸*)

3.3 Namlong as a member of Northern EM [NEM]

3.3.1 *NEM more conservative with Proto-EM *-m *-n *-ŋ *-p *-t *-k *-ʔ*

Both Namlong and Longdu have most usually kept Proto-EM **-m *-n *-ŋ *-p *-t *-k* intact. The following are Namlong examples with these codas from cx2: 藍 *lam²* ‘indigo’, 天 *t^{hi}en¹* ‘sky’, 窮 *kɔŋ²* ‘poverty’, 十 *sep⁸* ‘ten’, 襪 *mɛt⁸* ‘sock’, 福 *hɔk⁷* ‘bliss’. ZSY and Cantonese, which are similarly conservative with these codas, have helped with this conservatism in Namlong.

As for **-ʔ*, Chen (1995:238) [cx2] and Lin & Chen (1996:161) [LC] mention that in Namlong EM as spoken in Namlong, there is one final with *-ʔ* left: *-ɔʔ* (e.g. 膜 ‘membrane’). Otherwise all cases of **-ʔ* have been dropped, including 落 *lɔ³* [V] ‘descend’. However, *-ʔ* is intact in Namlong EM spoken in neighbouring Zhāngjiābiān (e.g. 落 *lɔ²⁷* [ʔ] LC).

In a later publication, the Namlong variety documented by Chen & Xu (2012) [CX] does not have [-ʔ] (but this variety is different from that in LC and CX2, based on other features, e.g. tone values). Bodman (1982:6) specifically mentions that all cases of *-ʔ have been dropped in Namlong EM. Gao makes the same claim (2018:288), and this can be seen in his data from both Namlong-proper and Zhāngjiābiān. Some examples are Namlong 學 ‘learn’ ɔ̃⁸ GR/CX; 石 ‘stone’ siə⁸ GR, siə³ LC.

Contrast these with Longdu, which has often kept *-ʔ to some degree, depending on the variety: Longdu 學 ‘learn’ hɔ̃⁷ GR, hɔ̃⁷ ZL, hõ⁷ LC; 石 ‘stone’ siə⁷ GR, sə⁷ ZL, sə̃⁷ LC. (The main point of Akitani’s feature (3-1) is that Longdu NEM is unlike the SEM varieties, which have collapsed most, if not all, of the place-of-articulation contrasts of the codas. However, given that the keeping of codas in Longdu is a retention, this does not prove that Longdu is NEM.)

See also §3.4 and §2.4 on the tone assignment in *-ʔ syllables in Namlong and Longdu respectively.

3.3.2 The vowel in Proto-EM *-yŋ *-yk is commonly backed in NEM

Namlong behaves the same as Longdu with this innovation. Here we provide a slightly different pair of examples. (See also §2.3.2.)

胸 ‘chest’ Proto-EM *-yŋ > Namlong EM hoŋ¹ GR2, Longdu EM hoŋ¹ GR2, vs. Fúzhōu SEM hyŋ¹, Gǔtián SEM hyŋ¹

肉 ‘meat’ Proto-EM *-yk > Namlong EM nok⁷ GR, Longdu EM nok⁸ AE/GR, vs. Fúzhōu SEM nyɿ⁸, Gǔtián SEM nyk⁸

3.3.3 Proto-EM *-uŋ *-uk > Proto-Fújiàn-NEM *-æŋ *-æk, and unrounding of rounded front vowels

Namlong is different from Longdu with the development of Proto-EM *-uŋ *-uk. Looking first at Longdu, Longdu participated in the sound change of Proto-EM *-uŋ *-uk > Proto-Fújiàn-NEM *-æŋ *-æk, and then Longdu unrounds the front vowels.

Longdu EM:

蟲 ‘insect’ t^hæŋ² AE, t^hæŋ² ZL, t^hæŋ² LC

毒 ‘poison’ tɛ̃⁸ ZL, tek⁸ LC

六 ‘six’ læk⁸ AE, lek⁸ ZL, lek⁸ LC

On the other hand, the cognates in Namlong have -ɔŋ -ɔk in the colloquial stratum, and -oŋ -ok in the literary stratum (Gao 2018:288). (Bodman [1982:13] renders the colloquial finals as -oŋ -ok and the literary finals as -uŋ -uk.)

Namlong EM:

蟲 ‘insect’ Namlong EM t^hɔŋ² GR, t^hoŋ² BMN

毒 ‘poison’ tɔk⁸ GR

(As for 六 ‘six’, only a literary pronunciation is found: lok⁷ GR, cf. the vowel in ZSY/Cantonese /luk⁸/ [lok⁴].)

Namlong -ɔŋ -ɔk is clearly descended from Proto-EM *-uŋ *-uk. However, whether Namlong participated in the change to Proto-Fújiàn-NEM *-æŋ *-æk or not requires further investigations. One possibility is that Namlong did not undergo the sound change of Proto-EM *-uŋ *-uk > Proto-Fújiàn-NEM *-æŋ *-æk. This can be due to one of the following possibilities: a) Namlong is not Fújiàn NEM; b) Namlong is Fújiàn NEM, but escaped this innovation before this sound change occurred in mainstream Fújiàn NEM; or c) the

Namlong is the same as Longdu in not having rounded front vowels.

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Namlong EM:

		old	new	
a1.	Proto-EM *-yai > Proto-NEM *-ya >	-ia	-ia	(/ *K _)
a2.		-ua	-ia	(/ *T _)
b1.	Proto-EM *-uai > Proto-NEM *-ua >	-ua	-ia	(/ { *P or *T } _)
b2.		-ua	-ua	(/ { *K or *0 } _)
c.	Proto-EM *-ua > Proto-NEM *-ua >	-ua	-ua	(/ { *K or *0 } _)

The following are the Namlong data, with Longdu data repeated from §2.3.7. Of particular interest are BMN's data, underlined below, showing what has changed and what has remained the same between the conservative and innovative varieties of Namlong.

Proto-Mǐn **-iai > Proto-EM *-yai > Proto-NEM *-ya

Velar initial:

倚／企 ‘stand’ (*k^h-): Namlong *k^hia³* GR, Longdu *k^hie³* GR, *k^hie⁶* LC, [k^hɪɛ̃] (tone 6) KS

蟻 ‘ant’ (*ŋ-): Namlong *gia⁶* GR, *gie⁶* CX, Longdu *ŋie⁶* AE2/ZL, *ŋie⁶* LC, *ge⁶* GR, [ŋɪɛ̃h] (tone 6?) KS

外 ‘outside’ (*ŋ-): Namlong *ŋia⁶* BMN, *gia⁶* GR, Longdu *ŋie⁶* AE2, *ŋe⁶* ZL, *ŋie⁶* LC, *gie⁶* GR, [ŋɪɛ̃] (sandhi tone?) KS

Coronal initial:

紙 ‘paper’ (*tʃ-): Namlong *tsua³* > *tsia³* BMN, *tsia³* GR, -ia CX, Longdu *tʃuə³* AE2, *tsuə³* ZL, *tsə³* LC/GR

蛇 ‘snake’ (*θ-): Namlong *sia³* GR, vs. Longdu *fue²* AE2, *sə²* ZL/LC/GR

Proto-Mǐn **-(u)ai > Proto-EM *-uai > Proto-NEM *-ua

沙 ‘sand’ (*s-): Namlong *sua¹* > *sia¹* BMN, *sia¹* GR, Longdu *sə¹* ZL/LC/GR

大 ‘big’ (*t-): Namlong *tua⁶* > *tia⁶* BMN, *tia⁶* GR/CX2, Longdu /tua⁶/ [toə̃] EG, *tuə⁶* CL, *tuo⁶* LC, *tə⁶* GR, [tə̃ə̃] (tone 6) KS

破 ‘damage(d)’ (*p^h-): Namlong *p^hua⁵* > *p^hia⁵* BMN, *p^hia⁵* GR, Longdu *p^huə⁵* ZL, *p^huo⁵* LC, p^hə GR

磨 ‘grind’ (*m-): Namlong *bia²* GR, Longdu *muə²* ZL, *muə²* LC, *bə²* GR, [m(b)ə̃ə̃] (tone 3) KS

(Longdu is irregular:)

我 ‘I’ (*0-): Namlong *ua³* GR, Longdu *ua³* ZL/LC/GR, [wa(:)ɪ] (tone 3) JS

Proto-Mǐn **-ua > Proto-EM *-ua > Proto-NEM *-ua

瓜 ‘melon’ *-ua: Namlong *kua¹* BMN/GR, Longdu *kuə¹* ZL, *kuə¹* LC, *kə¹* GR, [kə̃ə̃¹] (tone 1) KS, /kúa/ [koə̃] EG

花 ‘flower’ *-ua: Namlong *ɸa¹* GR, *ɸua¹* CX, Longdu *fə¹* ZL, *fuo¹* LC, *fə¹* ~ *hə¹* GR, /fúa/ [foə̃] EG

瓦 ‘tile’ *-ua: Namlong *va³* GR (< ZSY tone category), Longdu *ŋə⁶* ZL, *ŋuo⁶* LC, *gə⁶* GR

3.4 Longdu-specific sound changes

This section is about how Namlong measures against the Longdu-specific sound changes discussed in §2.4.

The first Longdu-specific sound change is Proto-EM *-æ > Longdu -i. No comparable data are found for 初 ‘beginning’ (only a Yuè-like pronunciation is found: 初 *ts^hə¹* GR, cf. ZSY/Cantonese 初 *ts^hə¹*). On the other hand, with 梳 ‘comb’, Namlong shares the same development as Longdu.

梳 ‘comb’ *-æ: Namlong EM *si¹* GR, Longdu EM *ʃi¹* AE, *si¹* ZL/LC/GR

This has the same reflex as Proto-EM *-i and *-y.

四 ‘four’ *-i: Namlong EM *si*⁵ GR, Longdu EM *fi*⁵ AE, *si*⁵ ZL/LC/GR

鼠 ‘rat’ *-y: Namlong EM *ts^hi*³ GR, Longdu EM *tʃ^hi*³ AE, *ts^hi*³ ZL/LC/GR

Namlong does not share the Longdu trait of having all *-ʔ syllables in tone 7. Namlong has basically dropped all cases of *-ʔ (see §3.3.1). In BMN’s variety of Namlong, tone 7 in syllables with *-p -t -k* is [ɿ], and tone 7 in syllables with *-ʔ dropped is [ɿ]; tone 8 in syllables with *-p -t -k* is [ɿ], and tone 8 in syllables with *-ʔ dropped is [ɿ], the same shape as tone 3 [ɿ]. However, tone 8 [ɿ] and tone 3 [ɿ] have different tone sandhi behaviours, so tone 8 and tone 3 have not yet totally merged. In the varieties described by CX and GR, tone 7 is [ɿ], and tone 8 is [ɿ], the same shape as tone 3 [ɿ]. The variety described by LC and CX2 is different: tone 7 is [ɿ], and tone 8 has the same shape as tone 6 [ɿ]. However, ex-tone 8 syllables that have dropped *-ʔ are explicitly said to have usually merged into tone 3 [ɿ] (LC:161).

百 ‘hundred’ *pa⁷: Namlong EM *pa*⁷ GR, Longdu EM *pa*⁷ AE, *pa*⁷ ZL, *pe*⁷ LC, *pa*⁷ GR

索 ‘string’ *θa⁷: Namlong EM *so*⁷ GR, Longdu EM *so*⁷ ZL, *so*⁷ LC

白 ‘white’ *pa⁸: Namlong EM *pa*⁸ GR, *pa*³ LC/CX2 vs. Longdu EM *pa*⁷ AE, *pa*⁷ ZL, *pe*⁷ LC

學 ‘learn’ *ɔ⁸: Namlong EM *ɔ*⁸ GR/CX, vs. Longdu EM *ho*⁷ ZL, *ho*⁷ LC, *ho*⁷ GR (Longdu has copied a Yuè initial *h*-)

箸 ‘leaf’ *nio⁸: Namlong EM *nio*⁸ GR, vs. Longdu EM *nio*⁷ GR

曝 ‘to sun’ *p^huo⁸: Namlong EM *p^huo*⁸ BMN, *p^ho*⁸ GR, vs. Longdu EM *p^huo*⁷ AE, *p^ho*⁷ GR

3.5 Traits in Namlong that look like other branches of Mǐn

3.5.1 EM vs. SM typological traits

As discussed in §2.5.1, Namlong and Longdu have typological traits that are unlike the typical EM varieties. Namlong has *-m -n -ŋ -p -t -k* (while *-ʔ is basically lost; see §3.3.1), no rounded front vowels, and no SEM-style onset lenition and tone-conditioned rime allophony.

3.5.2 SM-like lexical items

Namlong EM has the SM-like morpheme 知 ‘know’ *tsai*⁵ [ɿ] GR. The tone already tells us that this is not a native Namlong morpheme, as 知 ‘know’ should have tone 1 [ɿ]. Perhaps this was borrowed from Longdu *tsai*¹ [ɿ] GR (itself non-native), or Samheung SM *tsai*¹ [ɿ] GR, or from another SM variety where tone one is [ɿ], i.e. Eastern Guǎngdōng Mǐn or Diànbái Mǐn.⁵⁷

The word *tio*⁵ [ɿ] GR ‘(be) at’ in Namlong presents some questions. It looks somewhat like Longdu 佇 *ti*⁵ [ɿ] GR ‘(be) at’, with matching tone categories. While the Longdu form *ti*⁵ looks very much like Fújiàn SM 佇 *ti* ~ *tu* ~ *tu* ‘(be) at’ (also Samheung SM *tu*¹ GR), the Namlong form *tio*⁵ resembles the SM forms less. Another possibility is that Namlong *tio*⁵ is the EM morpheme 著 ‘(be) at’, e.g. Fúzhōu EM *tu*^o⁸, Fúding EM *tie*⁸. However, former tone **D syllables (syllables that had a plosive coda) cannot have tone 5 [ɿ] in Namlong, thus making this theory less likely correct.

(The following items are discussed in relation to the SM-like morphemes found in Longdu; see §2.5.2.) Only a literary pronunciation of 墨 ‘ink’ has been found for Namlong: [bəkɿ] GR (< Yuè *mək*⁸ [ɿ]; the tone in [bəkɿ] is a not a native Namlong tone). The word 艾 ‘artemisia’ is not found in the Namlong data.

⁵⁷ An alternative to 知 *tsai*⁵ GR ‘know’ is 捌 *pet*⁷ GR ‘know’, which is likely a native morpheme in Namlong EM. Other than “know”, 捌 *pet*⁷ is also a modal for ability. This morpheme 捌 *pet*⁷ is found in many Mǐn varieties, e.g. Fúzhōu EM /peɿ⁷/ [pai²ɿ] ‘know’, Taiwanese SM *bat*⁷ ~ *pat*⁷ ‘know’. This is theorised to be an Austroasiatic substrate word, cf. Vietnamese *biết* ‘know’ (Norman & Mei 1976). However, see also Sagart (2008:141–143)’s alternative viewpoint.

4. Samheung Southern Mǐn

Samheung 三鄉 SM (Sānxiāng, *sa¹ hioŋ¹* GR/BMS, a.k.a. 谷都 Gǔdū) is the smallest of the three ZSM varieties. Samheung is spoken in southern Zhōngshān, about halfway between Shekki and Macau (see Map 1 in §1.1). From its native Mǐn elements, one can easily tell that Samheung is a SM variety, albeit one with some unusual features, some of which are not influences from Yuè or Hakka. The main aim of this section is to demonstrate how Samheung fits in with the various branches of SM. The following are the sources of the Samheung data used in this article:

- BMS: Bodman (1988), data from Pha-O 平湖 (Píng hú) in Samheung proper, and Tio-Pou 大布 (Dà bù); here Pha-O forms are shown by default
 CX2: Chen (1995)
 GR: Gao (2018:318–350); here his data from 小三鄉 ‘Little Samheung’, i.e. Samheung proper, are shown by default
 GR2: Gao (2000), data from Yāgǎng 鴉崗 in Samheung proper
 LC: Lin & Chen (1996)
 ZZ: Zhang (1987), data from Wūshí 烏石 in Samheung proper

One notable trait in Samheung SM is that all nasal vowels have been denasalised, e.g. 三 ‘three’ Samheung SM *sa¹* LC/BMS, vs. Teochew SM *sā¹*, Xiàmén SM *sā¹*. (This is similar to Western Guǎngdōng SM and Hǎinán SM, e.g. Diànbái SM *ta^{1a}*, Wénchāng SM *ta¹*.) Another trait that the reader has to take note of is that in Samheung, /a/ is sometimes reduced to /ə/. These two vowels are separate phonemes, e.g. 慚 *ts^ham⁶* GR ‘ashamed’ vs. 尋 *ts^həm⁶* GR ‘seek’ (both are Cantonese loans, based on the tone value [J], which is Cantonese tone 2 [J], the expected tone category of these two morphemes). In an “established” compound word, /a/ in a non-final syllable is reduced to /ə/ if the following coda is not /-ʔ/ or zero. For instance, 紅 *aŋ²* ‘red’ becomes *əŋ²* in 紅薯 *əŋ²⁻⁶ tsu²* (red potato) ‘sweet potato’ (Gao 2018:323). (However, there seems to be many cases where /a/ became /ə/ even in independent morphemes.) The reader has to note that an *ə* in the Samheung data can potentially be /a/ underlyingly. This phonemic reduction from /a/ to /ə/ also occurs in Namlong EM (§3), but not in Longdu EM (§2), ZSH, ZSY, and Cantonese.

Similar to the other ZSM varieties, Samheung has been majorly impacted by Yuè. The Yuè influence in Samheung is a mix of Cantonese and Hafong 下方 (Southern Heungshan Yuè). Amongst the Samheung Mǐn-speaking villages, some are shared with Yuè and/or Hakka speakers (Gao 2018:318).

Samheung SM has some Hakka influences. For instance, Samheung SM has some Hakka calques which are not found in the nearby Yuè and Mǐn varieties, e.g. 知得 *tsai¹ tit⁷* ‘know’ (Gao 2018:326), cf. ZSH 知得 *ti¹ tet⁷* GJ ‘know’, Moiyen Hakka 知得 *ti¹ tet⁷* ‘know’. Samheung SM quite often has expected tone 6 syllables pronounced in tone 1 instead. One source of Samheung SM tone 6 syllables is Proto-SM tone *4 syllables. Hakka is famous for having some cases of “expected” tone 4 syllables pronounced in tone 1 instead; Hakka probably has a minor role in this tone 6 > 1 sound change in Samheung SM (see discussions in §4.3).

For tone **D syllables in LC, CX2, and ZZ’s varieties of Samheung SM, there are separate tones 7 and 8 as expected. On the other hand, in BMS and GR’s varieties, the native morphemes usually have the same low tone [J] / [J], which we label as tone 7. (A few tone **D syllables have a high tone [I] borrowed from Yuè, even for native morphemes.)

As can be seen throughout this §4, Samheung SM has quite a number of unusual vocalisms (from a SM point of view). It is unfortunately beyond the scope of this article to discuss all the unusual vocalisms in Samheung SM. In most cases, it can be assumed that the immediate ancestral state of the Samheung SM vo-

calisms is like that in Zhāngzhōu SM. Also, different varieties of Samheung SM often have rather different (and equally unusual) vocalisms. All discussions in this §4 are in relation to the 小三鄉 ‘Little Samheung’ varieties, i.e. the majority Samheung-proper varieties, which are spoken more to the west of Samheung Town.

Many Samheung forms have been shown in the preceding sections, especially in §3.1 and §3.2 where many Longdu EM and Samheung SM forms were given as references to the Namlong EM forms discussed. Unlike the preceding two sections where the subsections have exactly the same structure, this §4 on Samheung SM is structured totally differently. Section 4.1 discusses how Samheung SM has participated in the segmental innovations of Proto-SM+PXM and Proto-SM. Section 4.2 discusses how the segmental features of Samheung SM fit in with the various branches within SM. Section 4.3 discusses the tones of Samheung SM.

“Southern Mǐn” 閩南 (Mǐn Nán) in this article is SM in the wider sense, which includes Hǎinán SM and Guǎngdōng SM. SM in the narrower sense, i.e. Fújiàn SM and their more-recent migrant communities elsewhere, is “Fújiàn SM” [FSM] in this article.

4.1 Samheung Mǐn as SM

As noted by Gao (2018:319), while many Samheung Mǐn people claim that their ancestors were from Pútán in Fújiàn, linguistically Samheung SM is clearly SM and not Pú–Xiān Mǐn [PXM]. In this §4.1 we discuss how Samheung SM has participated in the SM+PXM and SM innovations, but none of the PXM-specific innovations.

4.1.1 Proto-Mǐn **nh- **ɲh- sometimes have h- reflexes in SM

Proto-Mǐn **nh- and **ɲh- commonly have h- reflexes in the modern SM varieties. (However, *h- is not necessarily reconstructable all the way to Proto-SM; see also Shen 2023.) In Proto-EM, these simply became voiced nasals (see also §2.1.1 and §3.1.1 on this trait in Longdu EM and Namlong EM respectively). PXM sometimes aligns with SM, and sometimes with EM. Samheung SM aligns with SM.

箸 ‘leaf’ Proto-CsM *nh-:

Proto-SM *nh- > Samheung SM *hiu*⁷ GR/BMS, *hio*⁸ ZZ, Zhāngzhōu SM *hio*⁸, Chéngzhǎi SM *hie*⁸, Luichew SM *hiɔ*⁴

Proto-EM *n- > Longdu EM *niə*⁷ GR, Namlong EM *niə*⁸ GR, Fúzhōu EM *nuo*⁸, Fúqīng EM *nyo*⁸, Gǔtián EM *nyək*⁸

PXM: Pútán PXM *niau*², Xiānyóu PXM *niu*²

肉 ‘meat’ Proto-CsM *nh-:

Proto-SM *nh- > Samheung SM *hip*⁷ GR2/BMS, Xiàmén SM *hik*⁸, Teochew SM *nek*⁸, Luichew SM *hip*⁸ (see §4.2.4 on this -p in Samheung and Luichew SM)

Proto-EM *n- > Longdu EM *nok*⁸ AE/GR, Namlong EM *nok*⁷ GR, Fúzhōu SEM *ny*⁸, Fúqīng EM *ny*⁸, Gǔtián EM *nyk*⁸

PXM: Pútán PXM *næ*², Xiānyóu PXM *nyø*²

耳 ‘ear’ Proto-CsM *ɲh-:

Proto-SM *h- > Samheung SM *hi*⁶ ZZ, *hi*¹ GR, Zhāngzhōu SM *hi*⁶, Xiàmén SM *hi*⁶, Teochew SM *hĩ*⁴, Luichew SM *hi*⁴, Diànbái SM *hi*⁶

PXM *hi*⁶

Proto-EM *ɲ- > Longdu EM *gi*⁶ GR, Namlong EM *gi*⁶ GR, Fúzhōu SEM /ɲi⁶/ [ɲei⁴], Fúqīng EM *ɲi*³, Gǔtián EM *ɲi*⁶

魚 ‘fish’ Proto-CsM *ŋh-:

Proto-SM *h- > Samheung SM *hu*² GR/ZZ/BMS, Zhāngzhōu SM *hi*², Xiàmén SM *hi*², Teochew SM *hu*², Luichew SM *hu*², Diànbái SM *hu*³

PXM *hy*²

Proto-EM *ŋ- > Longdu EM *gi*² GR, Namlong EM *gi*² GR, Fúzhōu SEM *ŋy*², Fúqīng EM *ŋy*², Gǔtián EM *ŋy*²

4.1.2 Coda lenition and breaking of *a in Proto-SM+PXM

After Proto-CsM *a, *e, or *o, the codas *-m *-n *-ŋ *-p *-t *-k lenite in Proto-SM+PXM (VN > *Ũ*, VP > *Vʔ*). The Proto-CsM vowel *a breaks into *ua in many (but not all) finals in Proto-SM+PXM (Kwok 2024). (See §2.2.2-4 and §3.2.2-4 on the development of these in EM.) Below we demonstrate these with just Proto-CsM *-an *-at. Samheung SM aligns with SM+PXM.

山 ‘mountain’ Proto-CsM *-an:

Proto-SM+PXM *-uā > Samheung SM *sua*¹ GR, Zhāngzhōu SM *suā*¹, Xiàmén SM *sũā*¹, Teochew SM *sũā*¹, Diànbái SM *lua*^{1a}, PXM *luā*¹

Proto-EM *-an > Longdu EM *san*¹ LC/ZL, Namlong EM *san*¹ GR, Fúzhōu EM *san*¹

割 ‘cut, sever’ Proto-Coastal Mǐn *-at:

Proto-SM+PXM *-uaʔ > Samheung SM *kua*^{ʔʔ} GR, Zhāngzhōu SM *kua*^{ʔʔ}, Xiàmén SM *kua*^{ʔʔ}, Teochew SM *kua*^{ʔʔ}, Diànbái SM *kua*^{1b}, Pútián PXM *kua*⁶

Proto-EM *-at > Longdu EM *kat*^ʔ AE/ZL/LC, Namlong EM *kat*^ʔ ~ *kət*^ʔ GR, Fúzhōu EM /*kā*^{ʔʔ}/ [*kā*^{ʔʔ}]

4.1.3 Proto-CsM *-uŋ *-uk > Proto-SM+PXM *-aŋ *-ak

Proto-CsM *-uŋ *-uk > *-aŋ *-ak is another innovation shared by SM and PXM. On the other hand, Proto-CsM *-uŋ *-uk remains *-uŋ *-uk in Proto-EM. (See §2.3.3 and §3.3.3 for the development of these in Longdu EM and Namlong EM respectively.) Samheung SM aligns with SM+PXM.

蟲 ‘insect’ Proto-CsM *-uŋ:

Proto-SM+PXM *-aŋ > Samheung SM *t^haŋ*² GR/LC, Zhāngzhōu SM *t^haŋ*², Xiàmén SM *t^haŋ*², Teochew SM *t^haŋ*², Diànbái SM *t^haŋ*², PXM *t^haŋ*²

Proto-EM *-uŋ > Longdu EM *t^hæŋ*² AE, *t^hɛŋ*² ZL, *t^hɛŋ*² LC, Namlong EM *t^hɔŋ*² GR, *t^hoŋ*² BMN, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM *t^hæŋ*², Fúzhōu SEM *t^høyŋ*², Gǔtián SEM *t^høyŋ*²

毒 ‘poison’ Proto-CsM *-uk:

Proto-SM+PXM *-ak > Samheung SM *tak*⁸ LC, Zhāngzhōu SM *tak*⁸, Xiàmén SM *tak*⁸, Teochew SM *tak*⁸, Diànbái SM *tak*⁸, PXM *tə*^{ʔ8}

Proto-EM *-uk > Longdu EM *tek*⁸ LC, *tɛ*^{ʔ8} ZL, Namlong EM *tək*⁸ GR, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM *tok*⁸, Fúzhōu SEM *tøyk*⁸, Gǔtián SEM *tøyk*⁸

4.1.4 Proto-CsM *-aŋ > Proto-SM+PXM *-ā > Proto-SM *-ē

The Proto-CsM coda *-aŋ is lenited in Proto-SM+PXM as *-ā. In Proto-SM, but not in Proto-PXM, this *-ā (including *-uā, but not *-iā) is raised to *-ē. This is one trait that separates Proto-SM and Proto-PXM (Kwok 2024). Samheung SM aligns with SM and not with PXM.

生 ‘give birth’ Proto-CsM *-aŋ:⁵⁸

Proto-SM+PXM *-ã > Proto SM *-ẽ > Samheung SM *sai*¹ LC, *sɐi*¹ GR, Zhāngzhōu SM *sẽ*¹, Xiàmén SM *sĩ*¹, Teochew SM *sẽ*¹, Diànbái SM *te*^{1a}

Proto-SM+PXM *-ã > Proto PXM *-ã > Xiānyóu PXM *lã*¹, Pútán PXM *la*¹

Proto-EM *-aŋ > Longdu EM *saŋ*¹ GR/ZL, Namlong EM *seŋ*¹ GR, Fúzhōu EM *saŋ*¹

The vocalism in Samheung SM 生 *sai*¹ LC / *sɐi*¹ GR ‘give birth’ presents some challenges. (Other reflexes of Proto-CsM *-aŋ are similar, e.g. 平 ‘flat’ Samheung SM *pai*² LC/BMS.) To avoid circular argumentation, for now pretend that we do not know that 生 ‘give birth’ is reconstructed as *sẽ¹ in Proto-SM. There are hints elsewhere which suggest that this case of -ai / -ɐi in Samheung SM is indeed a reflex of Proto-SM *-ẽ. Zhang (1987) makes the observation that the Middle Chinese finals of 果 -a and 假 -æ often correspond with Samheung SM -au and -ai respectively (1987:43). Looking at the -au set, the correspondences in other Mǐn varieties are usually -o, e.g.:

左 ‘left (not right)’: Samheung SM *tsau*³ LC, Teochew SM *tso*³, Xiàmén SM *tso*³, (Proto-SM *tsuo³), Xiānyóu PXM *tsɔ*³, Longdu EM *tso*³ LC, Fúzhōu EM *tso*³

婆 ‘old woman’: Samheung SM *pau*² LC, *pɐu*² GR, Teochew SM *po*² (/ *p^hua*²), Xiàmén SM *po*², Xiānyóu PXM *po*², Longdu EM *po*², Fúzhōu EM *po*²

Looking through various Mǐn varieties, there is no indication that Samheung SM -au demonstrates an ancestral state; in highest likelihood the direction of change was *-o > Samheung SM -au. While not too common, the sound change of *-o > -au is also seen in another Mǐn variety: Cāngnán NEM, which has experienced a sound change of Proto-NEM *-ɔ > *-o > *-ou > *-əu > Cāngnán NEM -au (Akitani 2023b:111–112). Perhaps something similar has happened in Samheung SM (more investigations are needed).

Now turning to the -ai set in Samheung SM, the following are some correspondences:

茶 ‘tea’ Samheung SM *tai*² ZZ, *tɐi*² LC/GR,⁵⁹ Teochew SM *te*², Xiàmén SM *te*², (vs. Xiānyóu PXM *tw*², Longdu EM *ta*² LC/ZL, Fúzhōu EM *ta*²)

家 ‘household’ Samheung SM *kai*¹ ZZ, *kɐi*¹ LC/GR, Teochew SM *ke*¹, Xiàmén SM *ke*¹, (vs. Xiānyóu PXM *kp*¹, Longdu EM *ka*¹ LC/ZL, Fúzhōu EM *ka*¹)

蝦 ‘shrimp’ Samheung SM *hai*² ZZ/LC, *hɐi*² GR, Teochew SM *he*², Xiàmén SM *he*², (vs. Xiānyóu PXM *hp*², Longdu EM *ha*² LC, Fúzhōu EM *ha*²)

(For the development of this set in Longdu EM and Namlong EM, see §2.2.1 and §3.2.1 respectively.) If *-o became Samheung SM -au, then most likely it was *-e that became Samheung SM -ai (Proto-SM 茶 *te², 家 *ke¹, 蝦 *he²). Similarly, *-ẽ > Samheung SM -ai, e.g. 生 Proto-SM *sẽ¹ > Samheung SM *sai*¹ LC, *sɐi*¹ GR.

4.1.5 Proto-SM+PXM *-(u)ẽ > Proto-SM *-(u)õi

(Proto CsM *-en >) Proto-SM+PXM *-ẽ became Proto-SM *-õi. Samheung SM reflects this sound

58 Mǐn languages often have a distinction between 生 *s-* ‘give birth’ and 生 *ts^h-* ‘uncooked’ (e.g. Proto-SM *sẽ¹ vs. *ts^hẽ¹). In Samheung SM these are *sai*¹ LC / *sɐi*¹ GR ‘give birth’ and *tsai*¹ LC / *ts^hɐi*¹ GR ‘uncooked’ respectively. It is unclear whether Longdu EM and Namlong EM also have separate *s-* and *ts^h-* versions of 生.

59 The following are vocalisms of 茶 Proto-SM *te² ‘tea’ in a few Samheung SM varieties: Samheung-proper *twi*², Shénwān Guichōng 神灣桂涌 *twi*², Dàbù 大布 (Tio-Pou) *tia*², Yōngmò 雍陌 / Qiánlǒng 前隴 *ta*² (Gao 2018:343). The *ta*² pronunciation could be a Yuè or Hakka influence, cf. ZSY / Cantonese / ZSH 茶 *ts^ha*². Another possible link is that most Qiánlǒng 前隴 people claim that their ancestors came from Zhāngjiābiān, cf. Namlong EM 茶 *ta*² GR. In Samheung SM there is a morpheme meaning ‘language / speech’ from an earlier form *he⁶, and this has the same vocalisms as 茶 *te² ‘tea’ in the various Samheung SM varieties (see footnote 63).

change. Proto-PXM did not participate in this sound change to *-ōi. Here we show one example of Proto-SM+PXM *-ē, and also one example of Proto-SM+PXM *-uē, which behaves somewhat similarly.

千 ‘thousand’ Proto-CsM *-en:

Proto-SM+PXM *-ē > Proto-SM *-ōi > Samheung SM *ts^hai^l* LC (see §4.2.4 on *-ōi > *-āi), Zhāngzhōu SM *ts^hij^l*, Xiàmén SM *ts^hij^l*, Teochew SM *ts^hōi^l*, Cháoyáng SM *ts^hāi^l*

Proto-SM+PXM *-ē > Proto-PXM *-ē > Xiānyóu PXM *ts^hī^l*, Pútíán PXM *ts^he^l*

Proto-EM *-en > Longdu EM *ts^hien^l* ZL, *ts^hien^l* LC, Fúzhōu EM *ts^hien^l*

懸 ‘tall’ Proto-CsM *-uen:

Proto-SM+PXM *-uē > Proto-SM *-uōi > Samheung SM *kɔi²* GR, Zhāngzhōu SM *kuāi²*, Xiàmén SM *kūāi²*, Teochew SM *kūi²*, Cháoyáng SM *kuāi²*

Proto-SM+PXM *-uē > Proto-PXM *-ē > Xiānyóu PXM *kī²*, Pútíán PXM *ke²*

Proto-EM *-en > Longdu EM *ken²* GR, Fúzhōu EM *kei²*

4.1.6 Proto-PXM innovations

Samheung SM (and the other ZSM varieties) do not share the PXM-specific innovations. The first PXM innovation is (Proto-CsM *-iem / *-ien / *-ian >) Proto-SM+PXM *ĩ > Proto-PXM *-iŋ.

天 ‘sky’ Proto-CsM *-ien:

Proto-SM+PXM *ĩ > Proto-PXM *-iŋ > PXM *t^hiŋ^l*

Proto-SM+PXM *ĩ > Proxo-SM *ĩ > Samheung SM *t^hi^l* LC, Zhāngzhōu SM *t^hī^l*, Xiàmén SM *t^hī^l*, Teochew SM *t^hī^l*, Diànbái SM *t^hi^{la}*

Proto-EM *-ien > Longdu EM *t^hien^l* ZL, Namlong EM *t^hien^l* GR, Fúzhōu EM *t^hien^l*

The second PXM innovation is *-ʔ > -0. Samheung SM does not participate in this. The dropping of *-ʔ also occurs in Namlong EM (§3.3.1), and to a smaller degree also in Longdu EM (§2.3.1), but *-ʔ > -0 is a very common sound change that has occurred in parallel in many different places, e.g. Western Guǎngdōng SM (e.g. Diànbái SM), Hǎinán SM.

石 ‘stone’ Proto-CsM *-ioʔ:

Proto-SM+PXM *-ioʔ > Proto-PXM *-io > Pútíán PXM *liau²*, Xiānyóu PXM *lieu²*

Proto-SM+PXM *-ioʔ > Proto-SM *-ioʔ > Samheung SM *tsiu^{ʔ8}* LC, Zhāngzhōu SM *tsio^{ʔ8}*, Xiàmén SM *tsio^{ʔ8}*, Teochew SM *tsie^{ʔ8}*, Diànbái SM *tsio^{la}*

Proto-EM *-ioʔ > Longdu EM *siø⁷* GR, *sø⁷* ZL, *sø^{ʔ7}* LC, Namlong EM *siø⁸* GR, *sio³* LC, Fúzhōu EM *suø^{ʔ8}*

The third PXM innovation is *-p *-t *-k > *-ʔ. This is related to neighbouring Southern EM; most varieties of Southern EM only have -k and/or -ʔ left. On the other hand, Samheung SM (and the other ZSM varieties) usually have *-p *-t *-k intact.

毒 ‘poison’ Proto-CsM *-uk:

Proto SM+PXM *-ak > Proto-PXM *-aʔ > PXM *tw^{ʔ8}*

Proto SM+PXM *-ak > Proto-SM *-ak > Samheung SM *tak⁸* LC, Zhāngzhōu SM *tak⁸*, Xiàmén SM *tak⁸*, Teochew SM *tak⁸*, Diànbái SM *tak⁸*

Proto-EM *-uk > Longdu EM *tek*⁸ LC, *te*⁸ ZL, Namlong EM *tok*⁸ GR, Fúzhōu EM *tøy*⁸
(See also §2.3.3 and §3.3.3 for the development of these finals in Longdu EM and Namlong EM respectively.)

Notice that Samheung SM not having these PXM-specific innovations does not infer that none of their ancestors were from the Pútían area. It is likely that at least some of them have ancestors from the Pútían area as claimed. These ancestors would have left the Pútían area before these innovations occurred in Proto-PXM; all of these innovations are cross-linguistically rather common. Also, Proto-PXM is rather recent, given how close Pútían PXM and Xiānyóu PXM are. See also the end of §5.3 on a possible linguistic link between PXM and ZSM.

4.2 Samheung SM as Zhāngzhōu-type SM

In this article, we take a conservative approach and divide SM into three branches: Quánzhōu-type SM [QzSM], Zhāngzhōu-type SM [ZzSM], and Guǎngdōng–Hǎinán SM [GHSM].⁶⁰ (When QzSM and ZzSM are discussed together, they are referred as “Fújiàn SM” [FSM].) QzSM includes their migrant communities in, e.g., northeastern Jiāngxī, southeastern Zhèjiāng, northeastern Fújiàn, and Táiwān. ZzSM includes their migrant communities in, e.g., Táiwān, and many enclaves in Guǎngdōng and Guǎngxī. Also included in the ZzSM group are the inland SM varieties of Lóngyán and Dàtián, which show influences from neighbouring Sinitic dialect groups, e.g. Hakka, CnM, and EM. The SM variety of Xiàmén (Amoy), nowadays the largest city in southern Fújiàn, shows a mixture of QzSM and ZzSM features. (Xiàmén is located between the historically more-significant Quánzhōu and Zhāngzhōu cities.) The various Taiwanese SM varieties sit on a continuum between QzSM and ZzSM, i.e. many of them have a mixture of QzSM and ZzSM features (see, e.g., Ang 2019). GHSM includes Eastern Guǎngdōng Mǐn, Western Guǎngdōng Mǐn, and Hǎinán Mǐn.

In this §4.2, we compare the segmental phonological traits of Samheung SM with some of the innovations which define the SM subgroups as discussed in Kwok (2018:129–156). Based on these group-defining innovations, Samheung SM is ZzSM. Section 4.2.1 discusses how Samheung SM is not a member of QzSM. Section 4.2.2 discusses how Samheung SM is not a member of GHSM. Section 4.2.3 discusses how Samheung SM is a member of ZzSM. Despite the conclusions made in the preceding three subsections, Samheung SM does have some traits which resemble other branches of SM, especially GHSM. These traits are discussed in §4.2.4. For discussions on Samheung SM tonal categories and values, see §4.3.

4.2.1 Samheung SM is not QzSM

Samheung SM is not a member of QzSM. QzSM varieties most usually have [ə] as the reflex of Proto-SM *-ø and *-uø. On the other hand, ZzSM and GHSM varieties have [e], [ɛ], or [o] as the reflex of Proto-SM *-ø, and many have retained the distinction between *-ø and *-uø. (See §4.2.3 for the Samheung SM sound changes of *-e > -ai ~ -vi and *-ue > -(u)oi.)

短 ‘short’ Proto-SM *-ø: Samheung ZzSM *twi*³ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *te*³, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *tə*³

坐 ‘sit’ Proto-SM *-ø: Samheung ZzSM *tsai*⁶ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *tse*⁶, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *tsə*⁴

火 ‘fire’ Proto-SM *-uø: Samheung ZzSM *huoi*³ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *hue*³, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *hə*³

尾 ‘tail’ Proto-SM *-uø: Samheung ZzSM *moi*³ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *bue*³, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *bə*³

60 Zhang (2013:53) divides SM into two branches: Fújiàn (i.e. QzSM plus ZzSM), and Guǎngdōng. On the other hand, Kwok (2018) favours a partition between a Northern branch which includes QzSM, and a Southern branch which includes ZzSM and GHSM. Nevertheless, Kwok (2018:156) also mentions that “[w]e cannot rule out the possibility of tripartite split for the SM”. In this article we have adopted this latter more-conservative / agnostic approach. All of the aforementioned phylogenies have their merits and pitfalls; we shall leave it to another opportunity to debate what the most appropriate phylogeny of SM should be.

QzSM has merged Proto-SM *-ioi and *-ue. Samheung ZzSM does not have this trait.

梳 ‘comb’ Proto-SM *-ioi: Samheung ZzSM *se*¹ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *se*¹, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *sue*¹

杯 ‘cup’ Proto-SM *-ue: Samheung ZzSM *puoi*¹ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *pue*¹, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *pue*¹

QzSM has merged Proto-SM *-ō and *-uĩ. Samheung ZzSM does not have this trait.

兩 ‘two’ Proto-SM *-ō: Samheung ZzSM *neu*⁶ GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *lō*⁶, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *ny*⁴

遠 ‘far’ Proto-SM *-uĩ: Samheung ZzSM *hui*¹ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *hui*⁶, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *hy*³

QzSM has raised *e in {*-ẽ *-uẽ *-ue?} to *i. Samheung SM aligns with ZzSM, which has other innovations. Samheung ZzSM also has further innovations of its own (see §4.2.3).

生 ‘give birth’ Proto-SM *-ẽ: Samheung ZzSM *sai*¹ LC, səi¹ GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *sẽ*¹, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *sĩ*¹

橫 ‘across’ Proto-SM *-uẽ: Samheung ZzSM *hua*² LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *huã*², vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *hui*²

血 ‘blood’ Proto-SM *-ue?: Samheung ZzSM *huoi*^{2?} LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *hue*^{2?}, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *hui*^{2?}

4.2.2 Samheung SSM is not GHSM

Despite Samheung’s location in the middle of Guǎngdōng in between Eastern Guǎngdōng Mǐn and Western Guǎngdōng Mǐn, Samheung SM is not a member of GHSM, but a member of ZzSM. In this §4.2.2, we demonstrate how Samheung SM does not align with the GHSM innovations. (In §4.2.3, we demonstrate how Samheung SM has participated in the ZzSM innovations.)

GHSM has merged all cases of Proto-SM *-ue and *-uø. On the other hand, in ZzSM, the distinction is still kept when the Proto-SM initial is velar, glottal, or zero (see Sound Changes B and D in §4.2.3).

Zero / glottal initial:

畫 ‘picture’ Proto-SM *ue⁶: Samheung ZzSM *ua*⁶ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *ua*⁶, vs. Teochew GHSM *ue*⁶, Luichew GHSM *ue*⁶ LC, (Quánzhōu QzSM *ue*³)

火 ‘fire’ Proto-SM *huø³: Samheung ZzSM *huoi*³ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *hue*³, Teochew GHSM *hue*³, Luichew GHSM *hue*³ LC, (vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *hø*³)

(Contrast this with) Labial initial:

杯 ‘cup’ Proto-SM *pue¹: Samheung ZzSM *puoi*¹ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *pue*¹, Teochew GHSM *pue*¹, Luichew GHSM *pui*¹ LC, (Quánzhōu QzSM *pue*¹)

尾 ‘tail’ Proto-SM *buø³: Samheung ZzSM *moi*³ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *bue*³, Teochew GHSM *bue*³, Luichew GHSM *bue*³ LC, (vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *bø*³)

GHSM varieties tend to have the sound change of Proto-SM *-uoŋ *-uok > *-uaŋ *-uak. This is not known to occur in Samheung ZzSM.

爽 ‘comfortable’ Proto-SM *-uoŋ: Samheung ZzSM *sɔŋ*³ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *sɔŋ*³, (Quánzhōu QzSM *sɔŋ*³) vs. Teochew GHSM *suaŋ*³, Luichew GHSM *suaŋ*³ LC

濁 ‘turbid’ Proto-SM *-uok: Samheung ZzSM *tsok*⁸ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *tsɔk*⁸, (Quánzhōu QzSM *tsɔk*⁸) vs. Teochew GHSM *tsuak*⁸, Luichew GHSM *tsuak*⁸ LC

Some lexical items in FSM and GHSM trace to different proto-forms in Proto-SM (Kwok 2018:146–151; if a lexical item is not discussed here, it is because a colloquial stratum pronunciation of that item could

not be found in the Samheung SM data). The Samheung SM numeral 蜀 *tit*⁷ ‘one’ is probably a reflex of the FSM form *tsit⁸ ‘one’ with an irregular initial. GHSM has a different proto-form *tsuuk⁸.⁶¹

蜀 ‘one’:

Proto-SM *tsit⁸: Samheung ZzSM *tit*⁷ BMS/GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *tsit*⁸, Quánzhōu QzSM *tsit*⁸

Proto-SM *tsuuk⁸: Teochew GHSM *tsek*⁸

The morpheme 嚙 ‘throat’ presents some challenges. In Samheung SM there is the word 嚙喉 *lay*² *vu*² ZZ, *ley*²⁻⁷ *au*² GR ‘throat’. The form 嚙 *lay*² / *ley*² is neither a regular reflex of the FSM form *nã² nor the GHSM form *luŋ².

嚙 ‘throat’:

Samheung SM: *lay*²

Proto-SM *nã²: Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *lã*², Quánzhōu QzSM *nã*²

Proto-SM *luŋ²: Teochew GHSM *ley*², Diànbái GHSM *liay*² DD

The regular reflex of Proto-SM *nã² in Samheung SM is *na*² (cf. 林 ‘forest’ Proto-SM *nã² > Samheung SM *na*² LC), and the regular reflex of Proto-SM *luŋ² is *lioy*² (cf. 龍 ‘dragon’ Proto-SM *luŋ² > Samheung SM *lioy*² LC; 綠 ‘green’ Proto-SM *luuk⁸ > Samheung SM *liok*⁸ LC). We deem that Samheung SM 嚙 *lay*² / *ley*² is not related to the GHSM form *luŋ², as the vowels do not match. Instead, 嚙 *lay*² / *ley*² is perhaps descended from the FSM form *nã². The vowel in 嚙 *lay*² / *ley*² is the expected reflex of the vowel in *nã² (the vowel then denasalises in Samheung SM). The consonants in 嚙 *lay*² / *ley*² are influences from the Yuè form 嚙 *loy*² ‘throat’ (in Hafong, ZSY, and Cantonese).

When 翁 ‘elderly man’ is used as a surname (Mandarin *Wēng*, Cantonese *joŋ*¹), in Teochew–Swatow there is a special pronunciation that is different from the usual pronunciations of colloquial *aŋ*¹ and literary *oŋ*¹. Samheung SM lacks this special pronunciation, based on available data. (See also the normal lexical use of Samheung SM 翁 *aŋ*¹ ‘grandfather’ in §5.3.)

翁 surname *Wēng*:

Proto-SM *aŋ¹: Samheung ZzSM *aŋ*¹ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *aŋ*¹, Quánzhōu QzSM *aŋ*¹

Proto-SM *uŋ¹: Teochew GHSM *eŋ*¹

Next is the pronunciation of another surname 王 ‘king’. FSM and GHSM again have different pronunciations of this. However, the Samheung form matches neither. The Samheung SM pronunciation of the surname 王 ‘king’ may surprise many Mǐn speakers.

王 surname *Wáng*:

Samheung ZzSM *ui*² LC (also Diànbái GHSM *ui*²)

Proto-SM *uoŋ²: Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *ɔŋ*², Quánzhōu QzSM *ɔŋ*²

Proto-SM *huŋ²: Teochew GHSM *heŋ*², Luichew GHSM *hiay*² LL

The cause of this is obvious to Yuè and Hakka speakers: the surname 王 ‘king’ is homophonous with another common surname 黃 ‘yellow’ in Yuè and Hakka, e.g. ZSY *wɔŋ*², ZSH *vɔŋ*². Samheung SM speakers

61 See also Akitani (2023a)’s criticisms of what Kwok (2018:102–104) reconstructs as *-uuk and what Zhang (2022:89) reconstructs as *-iək in Proto-SM. See also the discussions related to this towards the end of §4.2.4.

have applied the pronunciation of 黃 ‘yellow’ to 王 ‘king’. (Diànbái Mǐn *ui*² is similarly also under the influence of Diànbái Cantonese and Diànbái Hakka, both *wɔŋ*² DD.) The Samheung SM pronunciation of *ui*² (except the denasalisation) is a retention, and hence cannot be used as an argument for genealogical relationship. Nonetheless, it is worth pointing out that this pronunciation of *ui* is strongly emblematic of ZzSM.

黃 ‘yellow’ / surname *Huáng* Proto-SM **ui*²: Samheung ZzSM *ui*² LC/GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *ui*², Quánzhōu QzSM *ŋ*², Teochew GHSM *ŋ*², Diànbái GHSM *ui*²

Lastly, Samheung SM has the more-Fújiàn trait of using a disyllabic word for ‘eye’: 目珠 *mak*⁸ *tsiu*¹ ZZ, 目睺 *bek*⁷ *tsiu*¹ GR. (Also cf. Longdu EM 目睺 *bi*⁸⁻² *tsiu*¹ GR and Namlong EM 目睺 *bi*⁸ *tsiu*¹ GR.) This contrasts with the more-Guǎngdōng trait of having a monosyllabic word for ‘eye’ (Kwok 2018:151), e.g. Teochew SM 目 *mak*⁸,⁶² Luichew SM 目 *mak*⁸. Hainanese SM also has a monosyllabic 目 *mak*⁸ ‘eye’. Yuè and Hakka usually use a monosyllabic word for ‘eye’, e.g. Hafong / ZSY 眼 *ŋan*³, Cantonese 眼 *ŋan*⁴, ZSH 眼 *ŋan*³.

4.2.3 Samheung SM is ZzSM

Samheung SM is a member of Zhāngzhōu-type SM [ZzSM]. Four ZzSM sound changes are discussed in this §4.2.3, here labelled Sound Changes A to D. Before we introduce Sound Changes A to D, we have to introduce two late-stage Samheung-specific sound changes, here labelled Sound Changes Sa and Sb.

Sound Change Sa: ZzSM *-*ε* > -*ai* or -*vi* (see discussions in §4.1.4)

Sound Change Sb: ZzSM *-*ue* > -(*u*)*oi* LC / -*oi* ZZ / -*ɔi* GR

Examples of Sound Changes Sa and Sb can be seen throughout this §4.2.3, and in many examples in the rest of this §4. Sound Changes Sa and Sb occurred after Sound Changes A to D.

Sound Change A: the first ZzSM innovation is the lowering of Proto-SM *-*e* to *-*ε* or something even lower. In Zhāngzhōu SM, /*e*/ and /*ε*/ are separate phonemes. In Samheung SM, Sound Change Sa occurred subsequently: *-*ε* > -*ai* or -*vi*.

茶 ‘tea’ Proto-SM *-*e*: Samheung ZzSM *tai*² ZZ, *tvi*² LC/GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *te*², vs. Teochew GHSM *te*², Quánzhōu QzSM *te*²

家 ‘household’ Proto-SM *-*e*: Samheung ZzSM *kai*¹ ZZ, *kvi*¹ LC/GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *ke*¹, vs. Teochew GHSM *ke*¹, Quánzhōu QzSM *ke*¹

蝦 ‘shrimp’ Proto-SM *-*e*: Samheung ZzSM *hai*² ZZ/LC, *hvi*² GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *he*², vs. Teochew GHSM *he*², Quánzhōu QzSM *he*²

Sound Change B: *-*e* in the Proto-SM final *-*ue* also lowers, but only after a velar, glottal, or zero initial.⁶³

62 Teochew SM also has a disyllabic 目睺 *mak*⁸ *tsiu*¹, but this means “eyeball”.

63 In Samheung SM, there is a morpheme *hai*⁶ BMS, *hvi*⁶ GR ‘language, speech’, e.g. 講村話 *kəu*³⁻⁶ *tsʰui*¹ *hvi*⁶ GR (speak village language) ‘speak Samheung Mǐn’, 拍電話 *pʰa*² *tin*¹ *hvi*⁶ GR (hit electric language) ‘dial telephone’. The etymon of *hai*⁶ / *hvi*⁶ may or may not be 話 ‘language, speech’ (Proto-SM **ue*⁶ > Zhāngzhōu SM *ua*⁶, Teochew SM *ue*⁶, Quánzhōu SM *ue*⁵). If *hai*⁶ / *hvi*⁶ is indeed a reflex of Proto-SM 話 **ue*⁶, then Samheung SM *hai*⁶ / *hvi*⁶ has not participated in Sound Change B. Alternatively, this *hai*⁶ / *hvi*⁶ came from an earlier **he*⁶ (Sound Change Sa), and an even earlier **he*⁶ (Sound Change A). The vocalisms of this **he*⁶ in the various Samheung SM varieties are the same as that of 茶 Proto-SM **te*² ‘tea’ (see footnote 59). This **he*⁶ ‘language’ is perhaps a combination of the colloquial stratum **ue*⁶ and an **h*- initial from the literary stratum, cf. Zhāngzhōu SM 話 colloquial *ua*⁶, literary *hua*⁶. (Yuè and Hakka do not have a glottal or velar fricative initial for this morpheme, cf. Hafong 話 *va*⁵ ~ *wa*⁵ GR, ZSH *va*⁵.)

瓜 ‘melon’ Proto-SM *kue¹: Samheung ZzSM *kua*¹ GR/LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *kua*¹, vs. Teochew GHSM *kue*¹, Quánzhōu QzSM *kue*¹

花 ‘flower’ Proto-SM *hue¹: Samheung ZzSM *hua*¹ GR/LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *hua*¹, vs. Teochew GHSM *hue*¹, Quánzhōu QzSM *hue*¹

畫 ‘picture’ Proto-SM *ue⁶: Samheung ZzSM *ua*⁶ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *ua*⁶, vs. Teochew GHSM *ue*⁶, Quánzhōu QzSM *ue*⁵

(One slight weakness of applying this argument to Samheung SM is that the cognates of these in Yuè also have labial + *a*, cf. 瓜 ‘melon’ ZSY / Cantonese *kʷa*¹, 花 ‘flower’ ZSY / Cantonese *fā*¹, 畫 ‘picture’ ZSY *wa*⁵, Cantonese 畫 *wa*⁶⁻².)

With other initials, Proto-SM *-ue does not lower, and Proto-SM *-uø merges with *-ue (see Sound Change D below). Here is an example of *-ue which has not lowered (the initial is labial).

杯 ‘cup’ Proto-SM *pue¹: Samheung ZzSM *puoi*¹ LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *pue*¹, Teochew GHSM *pue*¹, Quánzhōu QzSM *pue*¹

Sound Change C: Proto-SM *-oi > *-e. Sound Change A (*-e > *-ε) must have occurred before Sound Change C.

洗 ‘wash’ Proto-SM *-oi: Samheung ZzSM *se*³ GR/LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *se*³, vs. Teochew GHSM *soi*³, (vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *sue*³)

鞋 ‘shoe’ Proto-SM *-oi: Samheung ZzSM *e*² GR/LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *e*², vs. Teochew GHSM *oi*², (vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *ue*²)

Sound Change D: Proto-SM *-uø > *-ue. Notice that this sound change is not specific to ZzSM; this sound change has also occurred in GHSM. However, Kwok concludes that this is the result of parallel development or areal diffusion between ZzSM and GHSM (2018: 141, 145). (On the other hand, QzSM usually has *-uø > -ə; §4.2.1.) The sequence of sound changes must have been Sound Change B (*-ue > *-ua) followed by Sound Change D (*-uø > *-ue), and then Sound Change Sb (*-ue > *-(u)oi) in Samheung SM.⁶⁴

火 ‘fire’ Proto-SM *-uø: Samheung ZzSM *huoi*³ LC, *hɔi*³ GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *hue*³, Teochew GHSM *hue*³ vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *hə*³

稅 ‘tax’ Proto-SM *-uø: Samheung ZzSM *suoi*⁵ LC, *sɔi*⁵ GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *sue*⁵, Teochew GHSM *sue*⁵, vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *sə*⁵

尾 ‘tail’ Proto-SM *-uø: Samheung ZzSM *moi*³ LC, *bɔi*³ GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *bue*³, Teochew GHSM *bue*³ vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *bə*³

Parallel to *-uø > *-ue, *-uø? > *-ue? has also occurred.

月 ‘moon’ Proto-SM *-uø?: Samheung ZzSM *ɲuoi*²⁸ LC, *gɔi*²⁷ GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *gue*²⁸, Teochew GHSM *gue*²⁸ vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *gə*²⁸

4.2.4 Samheung SM traits that are possibly from other branches of SM

In §4.2.3, we discussed how Samheung SM is a member of ZzSM. Nonetheless, Samheung SM does have a few traits which resemble other branches of SM.

Samheung(-proper) has one trait which resembles QzSM: the raising of Proto-SM *-iō to *-iū (and then *-iū > -iu).

⁶⁴ A reviewer suggested that Samheung -uoi in the morphemes 火 ‘fire’, 稅 ‘tax’, and 尾 ‘tail’ may represent a retention of an earlier Proto-CsM *-uoi. If adopted, this proposal could prevent a retrograde change, such as *-uoi > *-uø > -uoi. However, Kwok (2018:72–73) notes that Proto-SM *-uø descended from not only Proto-Min **oi, but also **ye. The morpheme 稅 ‘tax’ exemplifies the latter.

薑 ‘ginger’ Proto-SM *-iō: Samheung ZzSM *kiu*¹ LC, Quánzhōu QzSM *kiū*¹ vs. Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *kiō*¹
娘 ‘lady’ Proto-SM *-iō: Samheung ZzSM *niu*² LC, Quánzhōu QzSM *niū*² vs. Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *liō*²
(This is not an influence from Yuè or Hakka; for this final, ZSH and Hafong have -iōŋ, ZSY has -iōŋ GR or -aŋ ZH, and Cantonese has -aŋ.)

This is perhaps an independent development in Samheung ZzSM, given Samheung’s divergent vocalisms. (However, currently there is no evidence to disprove the alternative theory that this is a QzSM influence.) Looking at Gao (2018:342–344)’s comparison of Samheung-proper with three other Samheung SM varieties, one sees both -iu and -io.

響 ‘loud’ Proto-SM *-iō: Samheung-proper *hiu*³, Shénwān Guichōng 神灣桂涌 *hiu*³, Samheung Dàbù 大布 (Tio-Pou) *hio*³, Samheung Yōngmò 雍陌 / Qiánlǒng 前隴 *hœ*³, (Xiàmén SM *hĩũ*³, Zhāngzhōu SM *hiō*³)

One also sees 箬 ‘leaf’ recorded as *hiu*²⁷ by GR/BMS, and *hio*²⁸ by ZZ.

Samheung SM has a small number of traits which resemble GHSM. This is not contradictory to our claim that Samheung SM is ZzSM. Most Samheung Mǐn villages were established during the Southern Sòng Dynasty (1127–1279) (Gao 2018:5). Further afield, most Mǐn migrants also reached Hǎinán during the Sòng Dynasty (960–1279) (Liu 2006:35). Given that Hǎinán Mǐn is linguistically much closer to Eastern Guǎngdōng Mǐn than to Fújiàn Mǐn, and Zhōngshān is in between Eastern Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán, it is entirely plausible that amongst the SM migrants to Zhōngshān, a significant portion of them were from the Eastern Guǎngdōng Mǐn region, hence making some contributions to the linguistic make-up of Samheung SM. There are several possible scenarios concerning the relationship between the ZzSM and GHSM traits in Samheung SM. One possibility is that Samheung SM started off as ZzSM, and then received some GHSM influences later on. Another possibility is that Samheung SM started off as GHSM, but was later largely overlaid by ZzSM features. A mixture of both is also possible, i.e. Samheung SM started off as GHSM, then largely overlaid by ZzSM features, and then receiving some later GHSM influences. Yet another possibility is that the ZzSM and GHSM migrants arrived in the Samheung area at around the same time, and the resulting Samheung SM took on mostly ZzSM features and only a few GHSM features. It is beyond the scope of this article to determine which of these scenarios (or some other scenario) is correct.

Samheung SM often has an -ai reflex for Proto-SM *-ōi. Kwok (2018:146) mentions that Proto-SM *-ōi becoming *-āi (or *-ai) is a feature that is common in GHSM. However, this is not a defining feature of GHSM, as this trait is not universal in GHSM, and it is also found in some FSM varieties, e.g. Tóng’ān SM. Samheung SM might have been influenced by these GHSM varieties (if this is not a parallel development in Samheung SM).

千 ‘thousand’ Proto-SM *-ōi: Samheung ZzSM *ts^hai*¹ LC, Cháoyáng GHSM *ts^hāi*¹, Jiěyáng GHSM *ts^hāi*¹, Haihong GHSM *ts^hāi*¹, Luichew GHSM *ts^hai*¹, vs. Teochew GHSM *ts^hōi*¹, (Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *ts^hiŋ*¹, Quánzhōu QzSM *ts^hui*¹)

前 ‘front’ Proto-SM *-ōi: Samheung ZzSM *tsai*² LC, Cháoyáng GHSM *tāi*², Jiěyáng GHSM *tāi*², Haihong GHSM *tsai*², Luichew GHSM *tsai*², vs. Teochew GHSM *tōi*², (Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *tsiŋ*², Quánzhōu QzSM *tsui*²)

閑 ‘leisure’ Proto-SM *-ōi: Samheung ZzSM *ai*² LC, *ai*² ~ *vi*² GR, Jiěyáng GHSM *āi*², Haihong GHSM *āi*², Luichew GHSM *ai*², vs. Cháoyáng GHSM *ōi*², Teochew GHSM *ōi*², (Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *iŋ*², Quánzhōu QzSM *ui*²)

Samheung SM uses the morpheme 床／牀 *ts^heu*² GR to mean “table”, e.g. 抹床布 *bua*²⁷ *ts^heu*²⁻⁶ *pɔ*⁵ GR (wipe table cloth) ‘rag for cleaning table’. The morpheme 床 usually means “bed” in Sinitic languages (e.g. Hafong / ZSY / Cantonese 床 *ts^hœ*² ‘bed’). Using 床 to mean “table” is a trait of Hǎinán SM (e.g. Hǎikǒu

*so*²), Guǎngdōng SM (e.g. Luichew *ts^hɔ²*, Jiěyáng *ts^huŋ²*), and PXM (e.g. Pútián *ts^huŋ²*), but not Fújiàn SM (e.g. Kwok 2018:128, 151). (Longdu and Namlong EM use a Yuè morpheme: 枱 *t^hɔi²* GR ‘table’. The usual morpheme for ‘table’ in Mǐn is 桌, e.g. Fúzhōu EM /toʔ/ [tɔʔ], Proto-SM *toʔ⁷ > Taiwanese SM *toʔ⁷*.)

In §4.2.2 we discussed a few lexical items in FSM and GHSM which trace to different proto-forms in Proto-SM. Samheung SM usually aligns with the forms found in FSM. However, for the morpheme 鹿 ‘deer’, the Samheung SM form aligns with the GHSM form *tuk⁸ ~ *luk⁸,⁶⁵ and not with the ZzSM form *lok⁸.

鹿 ‘deer’:⁶⁶

Proto-SM *tuk⁸ ~ *luk⁸: Samheung ZzSM *liok⁸* LC, Jiěyáng GHSM *lek⁸*, Teochew GHSM *tek⁸*, Diànbái GHSM *tiak⁸*

Proto-SM *lok⁸: Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *lok⁷* [sic], Quánzhōu QzSM *lok⁸*

Compare:

龍 ‘dragon’ Proto-SM *luŋ²: Samheung ZzSM *liŋ²* LC, Jiěyáng GHSM *leŋ²*, Teochew GHSM *leŋ²*, Diànbái GHSM *liŋ²*, (Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *liŋ²*, Quánzhōu QzSM *liŋ²*)

獨 ‘only’ Proto-SM *tok⁸: Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *tɔk⁸*, Quánzhōu QzSM *tɔk⁸*, (Samheung ZzSM *tok⁸* LC, Jiěyáng GHSM *tok⁸*, Teochew GHSM *tok⁸*, Diànbái GHSM *tak⁸*)

The tone values in Samheung SM are very similar to those in Eastern Guǎngdōng Mǐn. See §4.3.

There are some traits in Samheung SM which resemble specifically Western Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán Mǐn. Samheung SM has lost its nasal vowels, similar to Western Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán Mǐn. Nonetheless, given the relative rarity of nasal vowels cross-linguistically, the denasalisation of nasal vowels could easily be a parallel development in Samheung SM and Western Guǎngdōng + Hǎinán SM. (There is also the example of Pútián PXM, but not the otherwise very closely related Xiānyóu PXM, having lost its nasal vowels.)

There is one other trait shared by Samheung SM and Western Guǎngdōng + Hǎinán SM which shows a probably non-coincidental direct link between them. Bodman (1982: 407, 1985: 18) observes that there are three morphemes which have a -p instead of an expected -k coda in Samheung SM (central Guǎngdōng) and Luichew SM (western Guǎngdōng): 叔 ‘father’s younger brother’, 肉 ‘meat’, and 竹 ‘bamboo’. These are shown in the data set below. These are reflexes of Proto-Mǐn *-yk; Bodman proposes that these have gone through intermediate stages like *-iuk and/or *-ikw, i.e. **y breaks into *iu, and then the labiality of *u combined with the plosive *-k to become *-p.

Still on the topic of Proto-Mǐn *-yk, Akitani (2023a) criticises Kwok (2018:102–104)’s reconstruction of a single *-uk, and Zhang (2022:89)’s reconstruction of a single *-iək in Proto-SM as the reflex of both Proto-Mǐn *-yk and *-yok. Akitani argues that this Proto-Mǐn distinction should be reconstructed in

65 See also discussions on Proto-Mǐn *-yk below in the main text. Kwok agrees that the reconstruction of Proto-SM *-uk is problematic, and now thinks that this is better reconstructed as *-yk.

66 See also Akitani & Nohara (2022:12–14)’s discussions on 鹿 ‘deer’. The following is a brief summary. The morpheme for ‘deer’ usually traces to **luk amongst Mǐn varieties, except that there are often irregularities with this morpheme in PXM and SM. As pointed out by Norman (2014:11), in GHSM one finds 鹿 ‘deer’ with a *ɬ*-initial, and a final from Proto-Mǐn *-yk. It is often the same or very similar to the pronunciation of 竹 ‘bamboo’ (see below in the main text), except that 竹 ‘bamboo’ is in tone 7 and 鹿 ‘deer’ is in tone 8. Perhaps Samheung SM pronounced 鹿 ‘deer’ as *tiok⁸*, and then the initial changed to *l*- under the influence of nearby languages. For the coronal series of initials in Proto-Mǐn, in contrast to Norman (1974)’s **t-, **ts-, and **tʃ- series, Akitani & Nohara (2022) argue for **t-, **ts-, **tʃ-, and **tʃ- series, with **tʃ- being laminal. The proto-form of 鹿 ‘deer’ in Proto-Mǐn is either **d^huk or **d^huk (2022:13).

Proto-SM as *-iuk and *-iok respectively. Akitani (2023a:327) mentions that “竹類字僅有三例” [there are only three instances of 竹-type characters (i.e. *-yk morphemes)];⁶⁷ these are the three morphemes mentioned by Bodman. The following are examples of the three *-yk morphemes, and two examples of *-yok morphemes. The SM varieties in Samheung, Western Guǎngdōng (e.g. Diànbái, Luichew), and Hǎinán (e.g. Wénchāng) make a distinction between *-yk and *-yok. The same is true for EM varieties (and often also for PXM varieties). However, the better-known SM varieties in Eastern Guǎngdōng (e.g. Teochew) and Fújiàn (e.g. Xiàmén) do not distinguish between *-yk and *-yok.

Proto-Mǐn *-yk:⁶⁸

叔 ‘father’s younger brother’

Samheung SM *tsip*⁷ BMS/GR, Diànbái SM *tsip*⁷ DD, Luichew SM *tsip*⁷ LL, Wénchāng SM *teiop*⁷,⁶⁹
(Teochew SM *tsek*⁷, Xiàmén SM *tsik*⁷)

Fúzhōu EM /tsyʔ⁷/ [tsøyʔ⁷], Níngdé EM *tsək*⁷, Xiānyóu PXM *tsyø*⁷

肉 ‘meat’

Samheung SM *hip*⁷ BMS/GR, Diànbái SM *hip*⁸ DD, Luichew SM *hip*⁸ LL, Wénchāng SM *hiok*⁸
(Teochew SM *nek*⁸, Xiàmén SM *hik*⁸)

Fúzhōu / Fúqīng EM *ny*²⁸, Níngdé EM *nyk*⁸, Xiānyóu PXM *ny*²⁸ (< Fúzhōu / Fúqīng influence)

竹 ‘bamboo’

Samheung SM *tip*⁷ BMS/GR, Diànbái SM *tip*⁷ DD, Luichew SM *tip*⁷ LL, Wénchāng SM *diok*⁷
(Teochew SM *tek*⁷, Xiàmén SM *tik*⁷)

Fúzhōu EM /tyʔ⁷/ [tøyʔ⁷], Níngdé EM *tək*⁷, Xiānyóu PXM *tyø*⁷

Proto-Mǐn *-yok:

綠 ‘green’

Samheung SM *liok*⁸ LC, Diànbái SM *liak*⁸ DD, Luichew SM *liak*⁸ LL, Wénchāng SM *liak*⁸
(Teochew SM *lek*⁸, Xiàmén SM *lik*⁸)

Fúzhōu EM *luo*²⁸, Níngdé EM *luo*²⁸, Xiānyóu PXM *lv*²⁸

67 The situation is more complex than what Akitani has mentioned. There are some morphemes of which the EM (and PXM) forms indicate that the Proto-Mǐn form should be *-yk, while the Samheung, Western Guǎngdōng and/or Hǎinán SM forms indicate that it should be *-yok. For instance:

熟 ‘cooked’ Fúzhōu EM *sy*²⁸, Níngdé EM *sy*²⁸, Xiānyóu PXM *lvø*²⁸, vs. Samheung SM *siok*⁸ LC, Diànbái SM *liak*⁸ DD/LC, Luichew SM *siak*⁸ LL, Wénchāng SM *tiak*⁸

縮 ‘shrink’ Fúzhōu EM /tʰyʔ⁷/ [tʰøyʔ⁷], Xiānyóu PXM *lvø*²⁷, vs. Samheung SM *siok*⁷ LC, Wénchāng SM *tiak*⁷

菊 ‘chrysanthemum’ Fúzhōu EM /kyʔ⁷/ [køyʔ⁷], Níngdé EM *kək*⁷, Xiānyóu PXM *kyø*²⁷, vs. Wénchāng SM *kiak*⁷

贖 ‘redeem’ Fúzhōu EM *sy*²⁸, Níngdé EM *syk*⁸, Xiānyóu PXM *lvø*²⁸, vs. Samheung SM *siok*⁸ LL

粥 ‘rice gruel’ Fúzhōu EM /tsyʔ⁷/ [tsøyʔ⁷], Níngdé EM *tsək*⁷, Xiānyóu PXM *tsyø*²⁷, vs. Samheung SM *tsiok*⁷ GR.

68 Luichew SM has one more case of an unexpected *-ip* final: 寂 *tsip*⁷ LL ‘lonely’. The expected coda is *-k*, cf. Teochew SM *sok*⁷, Xiàmén SM *tsik*⁸. (Cantonese also has *-k*: *tsek*⁸.) Perhaps the pronunciation of 寂 *tsip*⁷ ‘lonely’ was influenced by that of 叔 *tsip*⁷ ‘father’s younger brother’. See also Lin (2006:150–151) for his comments on the relationship between these four Luichew SM *-ip* morphemes and Old Chinese rime categories. (We have no data for 寂 in Samheung SM. Diànbái Mǐn has 寂 *tser*⁸ DD ‘lonely’ < Diànbái Hakka 寂 *tsʰø*⁸.)

69 Several other Hainanese Mǐn varieties also have an *-ip* final for 叔 ‘father’s little brother’ (Liu 2006:166), e.g. Hǎikǒu Fúchéng 海口府城, Chéngmài 澄邁, Tōngzá 通什 (Wúzhīshān 五指山). Other Hainanese Mǐn varieties have a different coda or no coda; with these it is difficult to determine whether they once had a *-p* in this morpheme or not.

粟 ‘grain’

Samheung SM *ts^hiok⁷* LC, Diànbái SM *tiak⁷* DD, Luichew SM *ts^hiak⁷* LL, Wénchāng SM *tiak⁷*

(Teochew SM *ts^hek⁷*, Xiàmén SM *ts^hik⁷*)

Fúzhōu EM /ts^huo⁷/ [ts^huo⁷], Níngdé EM *ts^huk⁷*, Xiānyóu PXM *ts^hp⁷*

Although Samheung, Western Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán SM having a ****-yk versus ****-yok distinction is a retention, the sound change of ****-k > ***-p is a very unusual innovation for Sinitic languages (and also for the Kra-Dai languages in the region). Especially given that only ****-yk, and not the other ****-k finals, is affected in all these western SM varieties, it is unlikely that this sound change occurred in Samheung and Western Guǎngdōng + Hǎinán separately. Given the history of migration of Mǐn speakers from east to west, one possible scenario is that ****-yk > ***-ip developed in Zhōngshān, and this sound change was spread to Western Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán along with the waves of westward migration of Mǐn speakers. This development indicates that Samheung and Western Guǎngdōng + Hǎinán SM splintered off mainstream SM before the merger of ****-yk and ****-yok affected the entire mainstream SM area in Fújiàn and Eastern Guǎngdōng.

4.3 Some notes on the tonal categories and values in Samheung SM

The development of the tones in Samheung SM is not very complex (e.g. not as complex as Western Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán Mǐn). Nonetheless, some aspects of this raise some questions.

We now discuss the splits and mergers with the reflexes of Proto-Mǐn tones ****B and ****C. The first point to note is that Proto-Mǐn tone ****B syllables with voiced sonorant initials have tone *3 in Proto-SM, and those with voiceless sonorant initials have tone *4 in Proto-SM, opposite of what the voicing suggests (e.g. Shen 2023:520–522; see also footnote 19). Beyond this, ZzSM, QzSM, and Eastern Guǎngdōng SM have different behaviours with the mergers of tonal categories. Samheung ZzSM is not QzSM: QzSM has merged tones 6 (Lower Tone C) and 5 (Upper Tone C), while Samheung ZzSM has separate tones 5 and 6. Samheung ZzSM has instead merged tone 4 (Lower Tone B) and tone 6, similar to Zhāngzhōu SM and other ZzSM varieties. Nonetheless, the merger of tones 4 and 6 is a very common sound change amongst Sinitic languages. Examples of this include Mandarin, EM (Akitani 2018:668–669, 711–712), Diànbái GHSM (Dai et al. 1994:10), and Hǎinán GHSM (e.g. Liu 2006:169–171, Xin 2013:113–138). For this reason, we remain conservative and agnostic towards whether this trait in Samheung ZzSM is related to the other ZzSM varieties, Diànbái / Hǎinán GHSM, and/or Zhōngshān EM.⁷⁰ Another possibility is that this is an independent development in Samheung SM. The aforementioned splits and mergers in SM varieties are summarised in Table 1 below. Samheung SM has the additional development of having some tone 6 morphemes shifted to tone 1 (see below). For Lower Tone C, Teochew SM has tone 6 in the colloquial stratum, but tone 4 in the literary stratum (e.g. Kwok 2018:116–118).⁷¹

70 What is clear is that this was not caused by the contact with Yuè. Yuè dialects have many cases of Middle Chinese “Tone 4” syllables shifting to tone 6, but they also have some syllables that have remained in tone B (tone 3 or 4). Samheung SM has examples like 厚 *kau⁶* LC ‘thick’ (Proto-SM **kau⁴*) and 旱 *ua¹* LC ‘drought’ (cf. Teochew SM *ũã⁴*), which have experienced the change of tone *4 to 6 (and then to 1 for 旱 *ua¹*), but the cognates in Yuè have not shifted to tone 6 (Cantonese 厚 *heu⁴*, 旱 *hɔn⁴*; ZSY 厚 *heu³*, 旱 *hɔn³*), testifying that Yuè was not the cause (or not the primary cause) of tone *4 > 6 in Samheung SM. Hakka, on the other hand, does show some similarities, with ZSH 厚 *heu³* also in tone C, and 旱 *hɔn¹* also in tone 1.

71 Not demonstrated in Table 1 are Western Guǎngdōng Mǐn and Hǎinán Mǐn, where the situation is rather complex. See, e.g., Lin & Chen (1996), Lin (2006), Dai et al. (1994), Liu (2006), Xin (2013).

Table 1. Tone categories in Samheung SM and some other SM varieties

	Proto-SM		Zhāngzhōu ZzSM		Samheung ZzSM	
	**B	**C	**B	**C	**B	**C
**_VCE, SONR	*4	*5	6	5	6 (or 1)	5
**_VCE, OBST	*3		3		6	
**_+VCE, SONR		*6		6		6 (or 1)
**_+VCE, OBST	*4		6		6 (or 1)	
	Quánzhōu QzSM		Teochew GHSM			
	**B	**C	**B	**C		
**_VCE, SONR	4	5	4	5		
**_VCE, OBST	3		3			
**_+VCE, SONR						
**_+VCE, OBST	4		4	LIT:4		

The following are some examples. Quánzhōu QzSM has merged tones 5 and 6, whereas Samheung ZzSM and the others have kept tones 5 and 6 apart.

路 ‘road’ Proto-SM tone *6: Samheung ZzSM *lɔ̃⁶* LC, (*lɔ̃¹* ~ *lɔ̃⁶* GR,) Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *lɔ̃⁶*, Teochew GHSM *lou⁶* vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *lɔ̃⁵*

舊 ‘old (inanimate)’ Proto-SM tone *6: Samheung ZzSM *ku⁶* LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *ku⁶*, Teochew GHSM *ku⁶* vs. Quánzhōu QzSM *ku⁵*

吐 ‘vomit’ Proto-SM tone *5: Samheung ZzSM *tʰɔ̃⁵* LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *tʰɔ̃⁵*, Teochew GHSM *tʰou⁵*, Quánzhōu QzSM *tʰɔ̃⁵*

鋸 ‘saw (n.)’ Proto-SM tone *5: Samheung ZzSM *ku⁵* LC, *ki⁵* GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *ki⁵*, Teochew GHSM *ku⁵*, Quánzhōu QzSM *ku⁵*

Samheung ZzSM has merged tone 4 into tone 6, similar to Zhāngzhōu ZzSM. Samheung has the additional change of shifting some tone 6 syllables to tone 1 (see below).

兩 ‘two’ Proto-SM tone *4: Samheung ZzSM *neu⁶* GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *lɔ̃⁶*, vs. Teochew GHSM *no⁴*, Quánzhōu QzSM *ny⁴*

遠 ‘far’ Proto-SM tone *4: Samheung ZzSM *hui¹* LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *hui⁶*, vs. Teochew GHSM *hy⁴*, Quánzhōu QzSM *hy³* [sic]

坐 ‘sit’ Proto-SM tone *4: Samheung ZzSM *tsai⁶* LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *tse⁶*, vs. Teochew GHSM *tso⁴*, Quánzhōu QzSM *tsə⁴*

The next phenomenon to be discussed is the shifting of some tone 6 morphemes to tone 1. Gao (2002:116; 2018:320) notices that some tone 1 morphemes in Samheung SM correspond with Middle Chinese “Tone 4” (and tone 4 in Samheung SM has merged into tone 6). Zhang (1987:43) compares this with Samheung Hakka; Hakka in general is well known for having many cases of tone 1 morphemes corresponding with Middle Chinese “Tone 4” morphemes (see, e.g., Xie 2003:78–90, and references therein). The question is whether this phenomenon in Samheung SM is an influence from Hakka or not. The following are some examples in tone 1 in both Hakka and Samheung SM, but in other tones in other nearby Mǐn and Yuè varieties. These trace to Proto-SM tone *4, Proto-EM tone *6 (< Proto-Mǐn tone **B), or Middle Chinese

“tone 4” (i.e. Middle Chinese tone B with voiced initial). Most of these Mǐn cases have an obstruent initial, but some do not, e.g. 有 ‘have / exist’ (the tone *4/*6 indicates that the initial was voiced, so the initial of 有 was not a glottal stop).

Proto-SM tone *4, [Proto-EM tone *6,] {Middle Chinese “tone 4”}:⁷²

- 被 ‘quilt’: {ZSH *p^hi^l*, Moiye Hakka *p^hi^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *p^hɔi^l* ~ *p^hɔi⁶* GR, (*p^hoi³* LC < Yuè tone category,) Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *p^hue⁶*, Teochew GHSM *p^hue⁴*, [Longdu EM *puoi⁶* LC, *p^huoi⁶* ZL, *p^hoi⁶* GR, Namlong EM *p^hoi⁶* GR,] {Cantonese *p^hei⁴*, ZSY *p^hi³*}
- 動 ‘move’: {(ZSH *tui⁵* < Yuè tone category,) Moiye *t^hui^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *toi^l* LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *tan⁶*, Teochew GHSM *tan⁴*, [Longdu EM *tei⁶* LC] {Cantonese *toi⁶*, ZSY *toi⁵*}
- 坐 ‘sit’: {ZSH *ts^hɔ^l*, Moiye *ts^hɔ^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *tsɛi^l* GR, *tsai^l* ZZ, (*tsai⁶* LC,) Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *tse⁶*, Teochew GHSM *tso⁴*, [Longdu EM *soi⁶* LC, Namlong EM *sɔi⁶* GR,] {Cantonese *ts^hɔ⁴*, ZSY *ts^hɔ³*}
- 咬 ‘bite’: {ZSH *ŋau^l*, Moiye *ŋau^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *ka^l* GR/ZZ, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *ka⁶*, Teochew GHSM *ka⁴*, [Longdu EM *ka⁶* GR, Namlong EM *ka⁶* GR,] {Cantonese *ŋau⁴*, ZSY *ŋau³*}
- 蟻 ‘ant’: {ZSH *ni^l*, Moiye *ni^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *hia^l* GR/ZZ, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *hia⁶*, Teochew GHSM *hia⁴*, [Longdu EM *ŋie⁶* LC, *ŋie⁶* ZL, *gie⁶* GR, Namlong EM *gia⁶* GR,] {Cantonese *ŋvi⁴*, ZSY *ŋvi³*}
- 有 ‘have / exist’: {ZSH *iu^l*, Moiye *iu^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *u^l* GR, (*u⁶* LC,) Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *u⁶*, Teochew GHSM *u⁴*, [Longdu EM *u⁶* GR/ZL/LC, Namlong EM *u⁶* GR,] {Cantonese *jeu⁴*, ZSY *ieu³*}

However, on closer inspection, there are differences. Xie (2003:83–85) lists 48 Middle Chinese tone B morphemes which commonly have tone 1 in Hakka varieties. Amongst these, other than cognates of Proto-SM tone *4 discussed above, many are cognates of Proto-SM tone *3 (primarily ones with sonorant initials). In Samheung SM, other than one single case of 買 *be^l* ‘buy’, there are no cases of Proto-SM tone *3 morphemes becoming tone 1. The following are some examples.

Proto-SM tone *3, [Proto-EM tone *3,] {Middle Chinese “tone 4”}:

- 買 ‘buy’: {ZSH *mai^l*, Moiye Hakka *mai^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *be^l* ZZ, (*be³*, GR, *me⁶* LC,) Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *be³*, Teochew GHSM *boi³*, [Longdu EM *me³* LC, *be³* GR, Namlong EM *bɛ³* GR,] {Cantonese *mai⁴*, ZSY *mai³*}
- 馬 ‘horse’: {ZSH *ma^l*, Moiye *ma^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *mɛi³* LC, *mɛi³* ~ *bɛi³* GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *be³*, Teochew GHSM *be³*, [Longdu EM *ma³* LC/ZL, *ba³* GR, Namlong EM *ba³* GR,] {Cantonese *ma⁴*, ZSY *ma³*}
- 軟 ‘soft’: {ZSH *ŋiɔn^l*, Moiye *ŋiɔn^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *nui³* LC/GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM *luĩ³*, Teochew GHSM *nui³*, [Longdu EM *nien³* LC/GR, Namlong EM *niɔn³* GR,] {Cantonese *jyn⁴*, ZSY *ŋyn³*}
- 語 ‘language’: {(ZSH *ŋi³*,) Moiye *ŋi^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *ŋi³* LC, Teochew GHSM *guĩ³*, [Longdu EM *ŋi³* LC/ZL, Namlong EM *niɔn³* GR,] {Cantonese *jy⁴*, ZSY *ŋy³*}
- 禮 ‘ritual’: {ZSH *li^l*, Moiye *li^l*,} Samheung ZzSM *le³* LC/GR, Teochew GHSM *loi³*, [Longdu EM *le³* ZL/GR, *le³* LC] {Cantonese *lei⁴*, ZSY *lei³*}

Hakka was not the primary driver of this change in Samheung SM. If this change in Samheung SM was driven by bilinguals of Samheung SM and Hakka, the Hakka tone 1 morphemes would affect both Sam-

72 Other known examples of Hakka tone 1 matching with Samheung SM tone 1 (< Proto-SM tone *4): 弟 ‘younger brother’ ZSH *t^hai^l*, Samheung SM *ti^l* ~ *ti⁶* GR; 斷 ‘sever’ ZSH *t^hɔn^l*, Samheung SM *tui^l* GR; 丈 ‘parent’s sister’s husband’ ZSH *ts^hɔŋ^l*, Samheung SM *tiu^l* GR; 上 ‘ascend’ ZSH *sɔŋ^l*, Samheung SM *tsiu^l* ~ *tsiu⁶* GR; 旱 ‘drought’ ZSH *hɔn^l*, Samheung SM *ua^l* LC. There are also many cases where Hakka has tone 1, but Proto-SM tone *4 has not shifted to tone 1 in Samheung SM, e.g. 兩 ‘two’ Moiye Hakka *liɔŋ^l*, (ZSH *liɔŋ³*,) Samheung SM *neu⁶* GR; 近 ‘near’ ZSH *k^hiun^l*, Samheung SM *kin⁶* LC; 倚 / 企 ‘stand’ ZSH *k^hi^l*, Samheung SM *k^hia³* LC (< ZSY tone).

heung SM tone 3 (< tone *3) and tone 6 (< tone *4) morphemes to a similar degree. Also note that there are many tone 1 morphemes in Samheung SM which are not in tone 1 in Hakka. (See also, e.g., Sagart (2001)’s list of such morphemes in Hakka which have tone 3 when the initial is sonorant, and tone 5 when the initial is obstruent.) These cases of Samheung SM tone 1 are obviously not influenced by Hakka. The following are some examples. The first three of the following examples show that morphemes with a nasal or liquid initial can also shift to tone 1 in Samheung SM.

Proto-SM tone *4, [Proto-EM tone *6,] {Middle Chinese “tone 4”}:

- 五 ‘five’: {ZSH η^3 , Moiye Hakka n^3 ,} Samheung ZzSM η^1 ZZ, η^1 LC, g^1 GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM g^6 , Teochew GHSM η^6 , [Longdu EM η^6 LC/ZL, (Namlong EM η^3 GR < Yuè tone category,)] {Cantonese η^4 , ZSY η^3 }
- 老 ‘old (animate)’: {ZSH lau^3 , Moiye lau^3 ,} Samheung ZzSM $lau^1 \sim leu^1$ GR, (leu^6 LC, lau^6 ZZ,) Zhāngzhōu ZzSM lau^6 , Teochew GHSM lau^4 , [Longdu EM lau^6 GR, (leu^5 LC, leu^3 ZL,) (Namlong EM leu^2 GR,)] {Cantonese lou^4 , ZSY lou^3 }
- 卵 ‘egg’: {ZSH lon^3 , Moiye lon^3 ,} Samheung ZzSM nui^1 GR/LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM lui^6 , Teochew GHSM nui^4 , [(Longdu EM lan^3 LC, len^3 ZL,)] {Cantonese lon^4-3 , ZSY lon^3 }
- 遠 ‘far’: {ZSH ien^3 , Moiye ian^3 ,} Samheung ZzSM hui^1 LC/GR, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM hui^6 , Teochew GHSM hy^4 , [Longdu EM ϕen^6 GR, $ɔn^6$ ZL, ($fu en^2$ LC,) Namlong EM ϕen^6 GR,] {Cantonese jyn^4 , ZSY yn^3 }
- 是 ‘be’: {ZSH sz^5 , Moiye sz^5 ,} Samheung ZzSM si^1 GR, (si^6 LC,) Zhāngzhōu ZzSM si^6 , Teochew GHSM si^4 , [Longdu EM si^6 LC/ZL/GR, Namlong EM si^6 GR,] {Cantonese si^6 , ZSY si^5 }
- 後 ‘behind’: {ZSH heu^5 , Moiye heu^5 ,} Samheung ZzSM au^1 GR/LC, Zhāngzhōu ZzSM au^6 , Teochew GHSM au^4 , [Longdu EM eu^6 LC, au^6 ZL/GR, Namlong EM au^6] {Cantonese heu^6 , ZSY heu^5 }

This tone 6 > 1 change is primarily an internal change within Samheung SM. The tone [ɿ] is the sandhi tone of tone 6 [ɿ], and [ɿ] has the same value as tone 1 [ɿ]. Tone 1 [ɿ] remains [ɿ] in tone sandhi contexts. These cases of tone 6 > 1 are probably simply cases where the sandhi tone [ɿ] of tone 6 has been reinterpreted as tone 1 [ɿ] underlyingly. In some cases Hakka might have helped with the process, especially with 買 ‘buy’ Samheung SM be^1 ZZ, which is not from Proto-SM tone *4. Nonetheless, Hakka was not the primary driver of the tone 6 > 1 change in Samheung SM. There are also some cases of tone 6 from Proto-SM tone *6 becoming tone 1. These cases in Samheung SM are definitely not influenced by Hakka, as ZSH has tone 5 [ɿ] in the cognates. These cases in Samheung SM are inspired by other cases of tone 6 > 1 [ɿ] within Samheung SM, and perhaps also helped by the cognates in ZSY and Hafong having the same tone value (tone 5 [ɿ]). This is the case with the following examples, and also the last two examples above.⁷³

Proto-SM tone *6, [Proto-EM tone *6,] {Middle Chinese “tone 6”}:

- 病 ‘sick’: {ZSH p^hian^5 , Moiye Hakka p^hian^5 ,} Samheung ZzSM pvi^1 GR, (pai^6 LC,) Zhāngzhōu ZzSM $pē^6$, Swatow GHSM $pē^6$, Jiēyáng GHSM $pē^6$, [Longdu EM $paŋ^6$ LC/ZL/GR] {Cantonese $peŋ^6$, ZSY $piaŋ^5$ }

73 The tone 6 > 1 development in Samheung SM is different from that in Western Guǎngdōng Mǐn and Hǎinán Mǐn. In Samheung SM, the tone 6 morphemes that have shifted to tone 1 are mostly Proto-Mǐn tone *4 morphemes, and a few are tone *6 morphemes. The situation in Western Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán Mǐn is the opposite. Looking at the situation in Diǎnbái SM (Dai et al. 1994), Luichew SM (Lin 2006), and Wénchāng SM (Woon 1987), there are many cases of tone 1 corresponding with Middle Chinese “tone 6”, but very few cases corresponding with Middle Chinese “tone 4”.

- 事 ‘affair’: {ZSH *sz*⁵, Moiye *sz*⁵,} Samheung ZzSM *si*¹ ZZ, *su*¹ ~ *su*⁶ GR, (*su*⁶ LC,) Swatow GHSM *se*⁶, Jiěyáng GHSM *su*⁶, [Longdu EM *su*⁶ LC/ZL, Namlong EM *su*⁶,] {Cantonese *si*⁶, ZSY *si*⁵}
- 汗 ‘sweat’: {ZSH *hɔn*⁵, Moiye *hɔn*⁵,} Samheung ZzSM *kua*¹ ~ *kua*⁶ GR, (*kua*⁶ LC,) Teochew GHSM *kũã*⁶, [Longdu EM *han*⁶ LC/ZL, *kan*⁶ GR, Namlong EM *kan*⁶,] {Cantonese *hɔn*⁶, ZSY *hɔn*⁵}
- 外 ‘outside’: {ZSH *ŋɔi*⁵, Moiye *ŋɔi*⁵,} Samheung ZzSM *ŋua*¹ ZZ, (*ŋua*⁶ LC, *gua*⁶ GR,) Swatow GHSM *gua*⁶, Jiěyáng GHSM *gua*⁶, [Longdu EM *ŋe*⁶ ZL, *ŋe*⁶ LC, *gie*⁶ GR, Namlong EM *gia*⁶,] {Cantonese *ŋɔi*⁶, ZSY *ŋɔi*⁵}

We now turn to the phonetic tone values in Samheung SM. In contrast to its tone categories, which resemble ZzSM (see above), the tone values of Samheung SM resemble Eastern Guǎngdōng Mǐn. (See §4.2.4 on how having some GHSM traits is not contradictory to the claim that Samheung SM is ZzSM.) Both Bodman (1988:411–412) and Lin & Chen (1996:187) [LC] note the striking similarities between the tone values in Samheung SM and Teochew–Swatow SM. This is especially the case with the isolate tones (non-sandhi tones). The level of similarity is lower with the sandhi tones, but the resemblance is still remarkable. The tone values of Samheung SM and Swatow (Shàntóu) SM are presented in Table 2 (data from LC: 19, 187). The tones in Haihong (Hǎifēng) SM are in some ways even more similar. For comparison, the tone values in some other SM varieties are also given. (Diànbái: Dai et al. 1994:11; Haihong, Zhāngzhōu, and Quánzhōu: Chen 2010; Luichew: Lin 2006:10–11; Wénchāng: Woon 1987:14–31.)

Table 2. Tone values in Samheung SM and some other SM varieties

	**A		**B	**C			**D		
	1	2	3	4	5	6	- ^{ptk}	-?	8
<u>Isolate:</u>									
Samheung	↑	↑	↓	(>6)	↓	↓	↓		↓
Swatow	↑	↑	↓	↑↓	↓	↓	↓		↑
Haihong	↑	↑	↓	↑↓	↓	↓	↓		↓
Zhāngzhōu	↑	↓	↓	(>6)	↓	↓	↓		↓
Quánzhōu	↑	↓	↑	↓	↓	↑	↓		
Diànbái(L)	↑ / ↑	↓	↓	(>6)	↑	↓	↑		↓
Diànbái(H)	↑ / ↑	↓	↓	(>6)	↓	↓	↑		↓
Luichew	↓	↓	↓	↑	↓	↑	↑		↓
Wénchāng	↑	↑	↓ ²	(>8)	↓	(>8)	↓ ^(?)		↓ ²
<u>Sandhi:</u>									
Samheung		↑L	L	(>6)	↑	↑	↑		↑↑
Swatow	↑↑	↑L	↑↑	↑L	↑	L	↑		↑
Haihong	↑	↑L	↑↑ ~ ↑↑	↑	↑	↑	↑↑		↑
Zhāngzhōu	↑	↑	↑↑	(>6)	↑↑	L	↑	↑↑	L
Quánzhōu		↑	↑↑		↑	↑	↑↑	↑	↑
Diànbái									
Luichew	↑		↑↑ /		↑ /				
Wénchāng			↑		↑				L

Notes: Blank means no sandhi tone, e.g. Diànbái SM has no tone sandhi. Diànbái SM tone 1b [ɿ]/[ʏ] came from: a) tone *7 syllables that have lost their plosive codas, b) some tone *5 syllables, and c) some tone *1 syllables (Dai et al. 1994:10–11). Diànbái(L) is Diànbái Lihua 黎話 (the default Diànbái Mǐn variety in this article), and Diànbái(H) is Diànbái Hǎihuà 海話. Luichew SM tones 3 and 5 undergo tone sandhi in some environments, and retain their non-sandhi tones in other environments.

5. Interactions amongst ZSM varieties, and lexical ties with NEM

There are the questions of how much and what types of interactions existed amongst the three ZSM varieties. The following are some observations.

5.1 Common calques vs. direct borrowings

Some lexical traits that are shared amongst the ZSM varieties can be attributed to them having applied similar strategies when calquing Yuè terms. For instance, there are Longdu EM 男仔 *nam² kien³* GR, *nam²⁻⁶ kien³* CSH, Namlong EM 男仔 *nam² kien³* GR, and Samheung SM 男仔 *nam² kia³* GR ‘boy’. The ZSM varieties have calqued ZSY or Cantonese 男仔 *nam² tsei³* (male DIM) ‘boy’, substituting the Yuè morpheme 仔 *tsei³* (e.g. Kao 2007, Kwok 2016) with their native Mǐn morpheme 仔 *kien³ / kien³ / kia³*, which is similarly a word for “son” and a diminutive suffix (see, e.g., Chen 1999; Shao & Gan 2002; Tsao & Liu 2008 on Mǐn diminutives). (Typical Mǐn words for “boy” are, e.g., Teochew SM 丈夫仔 *ta¹ pou¹ kiã³*, Taiwanese SM 查埔仔 {ts~t} *a¹⁻⁶ pɔ¹⁻⁶ gin³⁻¹ a³*, Fúzhōu EM 丈夫仔 (唐埔仔) [təuŋk muo¹ iəŋtɿ], and Jiàn’ōu NM 丈夫仔 *tiəŋ⁶ mu⁸ kyin³ tsiẽ³*, with 丈夫 ‘male’ followed by DIM or DIM DIM.) In another example, there are Longdu EM 熊儂 *hoŋ² neŋ²* GR, Namlong EM 熊儂 *hoŋ³ nɔŋ²* GR, and Samheung SM 熊儂 *hoŋ²⁻⁷ naŋ²* GR ‘bear’. In each case they have calqued a Yuè word: ZSY 熊人 (婆) *hoŋ² jɛn² (p^hɔ²)* GR (bear person [grandma]) ‘bear’, or Cantonese 熊人 *hoŋ² jɛn²⁻³* (bear person) ‘bear’ (left-headed compound), substituting the Yuè morpheme 人 *jɛn²* ‘person’ with the Mǐn morpheme 儂 *neŋ² / nɔŋ² / naŋ²* ‘person’. (熊 ‘bear’ Proto-EM / Proto-SM *him²; ZSM 熊 *hoŋ² / hoŋ³* [ɿ] / *hɔŋ²* is a literary pronunciation, cf. Middle Chinese *hiuŋ⁴*, ZSY 熊 *hoŋ²* [V].) As far as we know, “bear” expressed as 熊人 (bear person) is not found in other Mǐn varieties.⁷⁴

The three ZSM varieties also likely had some direct contacts with each other without going through the intermediary of ZSY. Perhaps some of these interactions occurred rather early, when Mǐn was still the majority in the Heungshan Islands, i.e. when Yuè did not have as much influence. In §2.5.2 and §3.5.2 we have seen how Longdu and Namlong EM have some SM-looking lexical items. (These would have come from Samheung SM, or from another SM variety, a variety spoken by SM fisherfolk visiting Zhōngshān.) In the other direction, does Samheung SM have some EM traits? The 翁 *aŋ¹* ‘grandfather’ morpheme (see §5.2) is one EM trait in Samheung SM. Another EM influence in Samheung SM can be seen in the morphemes 鼻 ‘nose’ and 艾 ‘artemisia’ (Proto-SM 鼻 *p^{hi}6 ~ *p^{hi}6, 艾 *ŋhiã6). For these morpheme, LC give the forms 鼻 *pɛi⁵* and 艾 *hia⁵*.⁷⁵ This tone 5 [ɿ] is only possible in native Mǐn morphemes, not in Yuè loans. The tone [ɿ] is also not a sandhi tone of the other tones. So far we have not encountered other cases of expected tone 6 morphemes pronounced in tone 5 in Samheung SM. These two cases in Samheung SM are probably direct

74 The variety of ZSH documented by GR also has a Yuè-like word: 熊人 *fuy² gin²* (bear person) ‘bear’. On the other hand, the variety of ZSH documented by GJ has a more-typical Hakka word: 熊家嫲 *iuj² ka¹ ma²* (bear household female) ‘bear’.

75 On the other hand, ZZ gives the form 鼻 *pi⁶* ‘nose’ with an expected tone 6, and GR gives 鼻 *pi¹* with the common change of tone 6 > tone 1 in Samheung SM (§4.3). As for the initial, 鼻 ‘nose’ is usually *p^h-* in SM varieties, but *p-* is also found in some SM varieties, e.g. Xiàmén literary *pi⁶*. Alternatively, the unaspirated initial in Samheung SM *pi⁶* ZZ / *pi¹* GR is a Yuè influence, cf. ZSY 鼻 *pi³*, Cantonese *pei⁶*. (ZSH 鼻 *pi^{hi}5*.) Data for 艾 ‘artemisia’ are not found in the other Samheung data sources.

influences from Longdu and/or Namlong EM, cf. Longdu EM 鼻 p^{hi} ZL, 艾 $ɲie^5$ LC, Namlong EM 鼻 p^{hi} GR (Proto-EM 鼻 $*p^{hi}$, 艾 $*ɲyai^5$). It is a common trait in EM for Proto-Mǐn tone $**C$ morphemes with a voiced aspirated initial to be in tone 5 instead of tone 6 (Proto-Mǐn 鼻 $**bh-$ C, 艾 $**ɲh-$ C; see discussions in §2.1.4 and §3.1.4). This does not occur in the coastal SM varieties, which Samheung SM is a member of.

Another possibility is that this confusion of tones 5 and 6 is caused by the influence of Heungshan Yuè and ZSH, which do not have a distinction between tones 5 and 6. However, we do not see other cases of confusion between tones 5 and 6 in Samheung SM. Given how Yuè-ised Samheung SM is in general, one would expect many more cases of confusion between tones 5 and 6 if this is one aspect that Samheung SM is open to Yuè-influence. The tone 5 in Samheung SM 鼻 $pɛi^5$ and 艾 hia^5 is more likely an influence from Longdu and/or Namlong EM.

5.2 “Yesterday”

We shall now discuss two lexical items, “yesterday” (§5.2) and “grandfather” (§5.3). Together they link Longdu and Namlong EM with one specific part of the NEM area in northeastern Fújiàn. Samheung SM shares with Longdu and Namlong EM the use of 翁 an^1 ‘grandfather’, but not “yesterday”. (Samheung SM has a relatively normal-looking SM word 昨暝昏 $tsa^1 bei^{2-6} hui^1$ GR ‘yesterday’, similar to, e.g., Taiwanese SM 昨昏 $tsa^{1-6} hy^1$ ‘yesterday’. Samheung SM 昨暝昏 $tsa^1 bei^{2-6} hui^1$ ‘yesterday’ is discussed again at the end of this §5.2.)

The Longdu word for “yesterday” is briefly mentioned, as a side comment, at the end of Akitani (2022a)’s §3 (:21). The word for “yesterday” in Longdu EM is $soŋ^6 mu\theta^6$ AE, $[s\thetaŋ^6 m\theta]$ JS ([ŋ] is tone 6), $soŋ^6 buo^5$ CSH, $soŋ^5 b\theta^5$ GR. Namlong EM has a very similar $soŋ^3 b\theta^6$ GR ‘yesterday’. Similar forms can be found in Níngdé, Zhōuníng, and Fú’ān in northeastern Fújiàn. Akitani gives the following examples: Early Fú’ān EM <sou²mu⁶> $\theta o^2 mu^6$ (Ibáñez 1941–1943), Fú’ān Mùyáng 福安穆陽 EM $\theta aŋ^2 mu^6$, Zhōuníng Xiáncūn 周寧咸村 EM $\theta aŋ^2 mu^6$.⁷⁶ There is also $sen^2 mu^6$ in Níngdé Jiǔdū 寧德九都 EM, with the same second morpheme (while the first morpheme sen^2 is said to be 前 ‘preceding’). According to Akitani, amongst Sinitic languages, this form for “yesterday” is only found in Longdu and the NEM varieties around Fú’ān / Zhōuníng.

(Not including the morpheme 前 ‘preceding’ in Níngdé Jiǔdū,) here we refer to all these forms informally as $*s\theta k^8 pu^6$.⁷⁷ (The tone 6 of $*pu^6$ here is important; below we will talk about another form $*s\theta k^8 pu^1$ with pu^1 in tone 1.) So far we have found $*s\theta k^8 pu^6$ ‘yesterday’ in one other location: Pútían PXM $[t\theta^7 k^8 m\theta u]$ (tones 8 and 6; $p-$ > $m-$ through normal lenition rules) (Chang 2005:190).⁷⁸ The $*s\theta k^8 pu^6$ forms link Longdu and Namlong with Fú’ān and Pútían areas (ignoring the Longdu forms $soŋ^6 buo^5$ CSH and $soŋ^5 b\theta^5$ GR for the moment). Logically speaking, this does not infer that the Mǐn ancestors of Longdu and Namlong

76 Akitani (2022a:21) renders this as $<[\theta\theta\eta^{33}mu^6]>$. Akitani (2018:391) gives both $[\theta\theta\eta^{33}mu^6]$ and $[\theta\theta\eta^{33}mu^{33}]$, with ³³ being the phonetic value [t] and ⁶ being the tone category. Akitani is being very cautious in not giving the tone category of $[\theta\theta\eta]$, perhaps because the etymon of this is unclear. The rendition of $\theta aŋ^2 mu^6$ here is our interpretation of what the underlying tones would be, if normal tone sandhi rules were applied (which this word need not have). Looking at the regular disyllabic tone sandhi chart of Xiáncūn EM in Akitani (2018:163), the only possibility for $[^{33}^{33}]$ is tone 2 followed by tone 6 $[44 + J] > [t\theta]$.

77 This informal reconstruction $*s\theta k^8 pu^6$ also takes into account the segments in the forms Zhōuníng EM ($s\theta k^7 pu^1 >$) $sum^2 mu^1$ ‘yesterday’ and Fú’ān EM $sak^7 mu^1$. The morpheme 昨 ‘yester’ does not exist in Akitani (2018)’s reconstructions of Proto-Níngdé and Proto-EM. The $*s-$ initial comes from the fact that Zhōuníng EM has a $/s-/ / \theta-/$ contrast, and this is a retentive trait (:709–710). The $*\theta$ comes from the ease of $*\theta$ becoming a or θ in contrast to a reconstruction with $*a$ or $*\theta$ in the first syllable. (There is also the case of 各 $*k\theta^7$ (as in 各農 ‘other people’) becoming $k\theta^7$ irregularly in Xiáncūn EM; Akitani 2018:637.) The final in the second syllable is reconstructed as $*-uo$ by Akitani (2018:511–512, 710–712).

78 <https://hinghwa.cn> 興化語記 gives another Pútían PXM form: $[t\theta p^1 m\theta u14]$ (tones 8 and 5).

must have come from around Fú'ān or Pútían; one possibility is that the area where *sək⁸pu⁶ was used was significantly larger in the past, and the Mǐn ancestors of Longdu and Namlong that brought along the word *sək⁸pu⁶ came from somewhere not that close to Fú'ān or Pútían. Nonetheless, the chances are very high that the Mǐn ancestors of Longdu and Namlong did in fact come from somewhere in northeastern Fújiàn; it is probably too much of a coincidence that *sək⁸pu⁶ ‘yesterday’ is found in Zhōngshān, Pútían area, and Fú'ān area.

Akitani (2022a:21) renders *sək⁸pu⁶ (for his Longdu, Early Fú'ān, Fú'ān Mùyáng, and Zhōuníng Xiáncūn examples) with an “etymology-unclear square” for the first syllable, and 暮 ‘twilight / dusk’ for the second syllable. Akitani has a footnote specifically saying that the second syllable is not 晡 ‘evening’.⁷⁹ The tones do not match: Zhōuníng Xiáncūn NEM [θœŋt̚ mu˥] ‘yesterday’ with /-Cu˥/ in tone 6 vs. 半晡 [puən˥ nu˥] ‘dusk’, 冥晡 [maŋt̚ ɲu˥] or 冥晡頭 [maŋt̚ ɲu˥ lau˥] ‘evening’ with 晡 /pu˥/ in tone 1. Akitani’s footnote was perhaps a reaction to how Zhouning (1993) and Fu’an (1999) render (the urban varieties of) Zhōuníng 周寧 EM (sək⁷ pu˥ >) sum² mu˥ and Fú'ān 福安 EM sak⁷ mu˥ ‘yesterday’ respectively as 昨晡 (yester evening). Notice how the second syllable is in tone 1. This tone 1 is what we would expect from 晡 (Proto-EM tone 1). Here we refer to these tone 1 “yesterday” forms informally as *sək⁸pu¹.⁸⁰ Other than the *sək⁸pu¹ forms in the aforementioned NEM varieties of Fú'ān and Zhōuníng, in the wider region there are a few Shē varieties with forms that are very close to *sək⁸pu¹: Fú'ān 福安 Shē t^hɔm⁶ mu˥, Jǐngníng 景寧 Shē t^hɔm⁶ pu˥ (in Zhèjiāng to the north), Luóyuán 羅源 Shē t^ha⁶ pu˥ (south of Níngdé). The direction of borrowing was perhaps from NEM to Shē, given that the Shē varieties are strongly influenced by the dominant local Sinitic varieties wherever Shē people move to. However, the reverse is not impossible, given that the morpheme 晡 pu˥ is also widely used in Shē and Hakka varieties in words for “yesterday” and “today”.⁸¹ For instance, ZSH has 參晡日 ts^ham¹ pu˥ ɲit⁷ ~ 秋晡日 ts^hiu¹ pu˥ ɲit⁷ ‘yesterday’, 今晡日 kim¹ pu˥ ɲit⁷ ‘today’.

What is the relationship between *sək⁸pu¹ and *sək⁸pu⁶? Words for “yesterday”, “today”, and “tomorrow” are often irregular cross-linguistically. English is an example, with each of these three words containing a morpheme which is nowadays not productive. These terms are highly irregular in Japonic, e.g. Okinawan t̚ʃinū ‘yesterday’, t̚ʃū ‘today’, at̚ʃa ‘tomorrow’ (and asati ‘day after tomorrow’). In Cantonese, both k^hem²-jet⁸ ~ ts^hem²-jet⁸ ‘yesterday’ and t^hŋ¹-jet⁸ ‘tomorrow’ begin with a prefix with highly-restricted usage (i.e. near-cranberry morph; see further discussions in footnote 82). In the NEM region, Níngdé Hǔpèi 寧德虎淝 EM has irregular tone sandhi in the words 今早 kin¹ na³ ‘today’ ([ɿ ɿ] > [ɿ ɿ]) and 明早 maŋ² na³ ‘tomorrow’ ([ɿ ɿ] > [ɿ ɿ]) (Akitani 2018:75). Words like “yesterday”, “today”, and “tomorrow” are highly susceptible to irregularities. We think *sək⁸pu⁶ is a word for “yesterday” with irregular tones, of which the origin is the etymologically transparent *sək⁸pu¹ 昨晡 (yester evening). This irregular sound change from *pu¹ to *pu⁶ would be rather old, as this is shared by some of the aforementioned Mǐn varieties in the Fú'ān area, Pútían area, and Longdu and Namlong in Zhōngshān. The Longdu forms sɔŋ⁶ buo⁵ CSH and soŋ⁵ bə⁵ GR would then be forms which have experienced further irregular changes in their tones.

79 The morpheme 晡 (Middle Chinese pu⁴) means “late afternoon” in Classical Chinese, more specifically the 申 Shēn division of the day (3 to 5 p.m.).

80 Chang (2005:190) records the following forms for “yesterday” in Fú'ān EM: [sɔʔt̚ɿ mu˥t̚ɿ ja˥] ~ [saŋɿɿ mu˥t̚ɿ] ([t̚ɿɿ] is tone 1). Another Mǐn data point with *sək⁸pu¹ is Dàtián SM tsɔʔ⁶ bu˥ (see §2.1.2 on the ts- ~ s- correspondence amongst Mǐn varieties).

81 In a great number of Shē and Hakka varieties, the morpheme 晡 pu˥ is used in words for “yesterday” and “today”, and often also “day before yesterday” and “day after tomorrow”, but not “tomorrow”. Here are examples of “yesterday” with this morpheme in a few Hakka varieties: Wǔpíng 武平 Hakka ts^hia² pu˥, Chángtǐng 長汀 Hakka ts^hio² pu˥, Moiyen 梅縣 (Méixiàn) Hakka ts^hiu¹ pu˥ ɲit⁷ (< 日 ɲit⁷ ‘day’), Huidōng 惠東 Hakka ts^ham¹ pu˥ ɲit⁷.

Another facet of this irregularity is the added nasality in the medial consonants in many reflexes of *sɔkpu, especially with the initial *p-. We can think of two hypotheses. One hypothesis is that the nasality was simply “lenition” that happened with these frequently used words: the coda *-k was lenited first (became a sonorant), and then the nasality was spread rightward to the following initial. (Rightward assimilation is very common in northeastern Fújiàn. As for Longdu and Namlong, their *m* and *b* are not contrastive.) Another hypothesis is that there was previously another morpheme with nasal consonant(s) between *sɔk⁸ 昨 ‘yester’ and *pu¹ 晡 ‘evening’. Perhaps this was *maŋ² 冥 / 暝 ‘evening’, i.e. *sɔk⁸ maŋ² pu¹ 昨冥晡 (yester evening evening),⁸² similar to how Samheung SM has tsa¹ bei²⁻⁶ hui¹ 昨暝昏 (yester evening evening) ‘yesterday’. (Zhāngzhōu SM has [tsaŋ¹ hun¹] ‘yesterday’ (Chang 2005:190), which looks like 昨暝昏 with the first two syllables coalesced into one syllable.) The morpheme *maŋ² 冥 / 暝 ‘evening’ would be a prime candidate for this hypothesised morpheme between *sɔk⁸ 昨 ‘yester’ and *pu¹ 晡, as this morpheme is quite commonly found in words for “yesterday” in EM varieties, e.g. Fúding NEM 昨暝月 [θa¹ maŋ¹ ni²ʔ¹] (yesterday evening moon), Shòuning NEM 昨暝 [syø²ʔ¹ maŋ¹] (yester evening), Fúzhōu SEM [so¹ maŋ¹] (yester evening) (Chang 2005:190), 昨暝 so²⁸ maŋ² (Feng 1998:415).

5.3 “Grandfather”

The next lexical item to be discussed is the morpheme 翁: Longdu ɛŋ¹, Namlong ɔŋ¹, Samheung aŋ¹. (All forms concerning ZSM 翁 and Heungshan Yuè 公 here are from GR unless otherwise indicated.) The morpheme 翁 means “elderly man” in Classical Chinese, and it has a wide range of usage in ZSM. The unmarked meaning of 翁 is “grandfather” in all three ZSM varieties. In Samheung SM, 翁 aŋ¹ in isolation, or when prefixed by the “name” prefix 阿 a¹- (address term prefix), means “paternal grandfather”. In Longdu EM, 阿翁 a²- ɛŋ¹ (NAME- grandpa) is “paternal grandfather”. In Namlong EM, although the word for “paternal grandfather” has been replaced by a Yuè term (阿公 a⁵ koŋ⁷ [1], cf. ZSY 阿公 a⁵ koŋ¹ [1] ‘paternal / maternal grandfather’), the morpheme 翁 ɔŋ¹ is found in many related kinterms, e.g. 太翁 t¹ai⁵⁻⁷ ɔŋ¹ (great grandpa) ‘great²¹ grandfather’.

Words for “maternal grandfather”, and many other adult male kinterms, are also built from the root 翁. The morpheme 翁 is used in words depicting respectable men in general. The following are examples of 翁 used in kinterms and other human nouns.

Longdu EM:

阿翁 a²- ɛŋ¹ (NAME-grandpa) ‘paternal grandfather’, 外翁 gie⁶⁻² ɛŋ¹ (external grandpa) ‘maternal grandfather’, 翁老 ɛŋ¹ lau² (grandpa old) ‘great grandfather’, 家翁 ka¹⁻² ɛŋ¹ (household grandpa) ‘hus-

82 Also cf. the case with Cantonese k^hem² jet⁸ 琴日 or ts^hem² jet⁸ 尋日 ‘yesterday’. Of these, ts^hem² jet⁸ 尋日 is older; Ball (1888:9) records ‘yesterday’ as tsɔk⁸ jet⁸ 昨日, which freely varies with ts^hem² mət⁸. Nowadays, tsɔk⁸ jet⁸ ~ tsɔk^{7b} jet⁸ 昨日 is only used in Standard Cantonese as a literary word, but 昨日 is still found in many Yuè dialects as the ordinary word for “yesterday”, e.g. ZSY tsɔk⁸ iet⁸ 昨日, Tungkun / Dōngguān tsɔk⁸ zək⁸ 昨日 (Zhan et al. 2002:396). In the nearby Szeyp (Siyi) Yuè dialects, the word for ‘yesterday’ often includes the morpheme ^mban 晚 ‘evening / night’, e.g. Toishan / Táishān [tam¹ ^mban¹], Kāipíng Chikán 開平赤坎 [tɔk¹ ^mban¹] (get¹) 昨晚 (日) (yester evening (day)) (Zhan et al. 2002:396). Cantonese ts^hem² jet⁸ 尋日 ‘yesterday’ is likely originally tsɔk⁸ man⁴ jet⁸ 昨暝日 (yesterday evening day). (Based on Cantonese phonotactic rules, either tone 2 or tone 4 would cause the initial in ts^hem² to be aspirated from the original ts-) See also Li (2007) for basically the same theory on Cantonese “yesterday”. Li (2007) also raises many examples of Wú and Mǐn varieties where ‘yesterday’ is expressed as “yester evening” or “yester evening day”; nearly all of these “evening” morphemes have a nasal coda, e.g. 暗 (*-m), 晚 (*-n), 冥 (*-ŋ). (That yesterday is expressed as “yester-evening” is paired with many examples of tomorrow being expressed as “to-morning”.) These facts help with the hypothesis that *sɔk-pu with a medial nasal consonant in the reflex was originally something like *sɔk-maŋ-pu (yester-evening-evening).

band's father', 太翁 *tʰai⁵⁻⁸ ɛŋ¹* (great grandpa) 'ancestor' (e.g. 拜太翁山 *pai⁵⁻² tʰai⁵⁻² ɛŋ¹ san¹* (worship great grandpa mountain) 'sweeping ancestors' graves'), 老翁 *lau⁶⁻² ɛŋ¹* GR, [la:wɿ ʔæ:ŋ] EG (old grandpa) 'husband'

Namlong EM:

太翁 *tʰai⁵⁻⁷ ɔŋ¹* (great grandpa) 'great² grandfather', 祖翁 *tsu³ ɔŋ¹* (ancestor grandpa) 'ancestor', 大官翁 *tia⁶⁻² kən¹⁻³ ɔŋ¹* (big mandarin grandpa) 'husband's father', 舅翁 *ku⁶⁻³ ɔŋ¹* (mum.bro grandpa) 'maternal uncle', 舅翁团 *ku⁶⁻⁷ ɔŋ¹⁻² kien³* (mum.bro grandpa DIM) 'wife's younger brother', 老翁 *lau² ɔŋ¹* (old grandpa) 'husband' or 'old man', 聾翁 *lɔŋ²⁻³ ɔŋ¹* (deaf grandpa) 'old deaf man', 事頭翁 *su⁶⁻² tʰau² ɔŋ¹* (matter head grandpa) 'boss', 包租翁 *pau¹⁻⁷ tsu¹⁻⁷ ɔŋ¹* (bundle rent grandpa) 'landlord'

Samheung SM:

(阿)翁 (*a¹-aŋ¹* ([NAME-]grandpa) 'paternal grandfather', 外翁 *gua¹ aŋ¹* (external grandpa) 'maternal grandfather', 祖翁 *tsɔ³⁻⁶ aŋ¹* (ancestor grandpa) 'ancestor', 家翁 *kei¹ aŋ¹* (household grandpa) 'husband's father', 老翁 *leu¹ aŋ¹* (old grandpa) 'husband', 新娘翁 *sin¹ niu²⁻⁶ aŋ¹* (new lady grandpa) 'bridegroom', 老蚊翁 [*lau¹ bən¹ aŋ¹*] (old mosquito? grandpa) 'elderly person', 兩翁婆 *neu⁶⁻¹ ɛŋ¹ pɐu²* (two grandpa grandma) 'husband and wife', 無鬚翁 *bɐu² tsʰiu¹ aŋ¹* (no.have beard grandpa) 'beardless (old) man'

The morpheme 翁 is also used in the names of many anthropomorphic entities related to traditional beliefs. Egerod (1956:106) glosses Longdu /ʔɛq/ [ʔæ:ŋ] as 'worshipped ancestors', and /khǔaj ʔɛq/ [k^{wha}:jɿ ʔæ:ŋ] as 'worship spirits' (1956:128–133). The following are some other examples.

Longdu EM:

雷翁 *lai² ɛŋ¹* 'thunder deity', 灶翁 *tsau⁵⁻⁸ ɛŋ¹* 'kitchen deity', 土地翁 *tʰu³ ti⁶ ɛŋ¹* 'earth deity'

Namlong EM:

雷翁 *lei²⁻³ ɔŋ¹ ~ lui²⁻³ ɔŋ¹* 'thunder deity', 灶翁 *tsau⁵⁻³ ɔŋ¹* 'kitchen deity', 涂地翁 *tʰu³ ti⁶⁻³ ɔŋ¹* 'earth deity', 天翁 *tʰien¹⁻⁷ ɔŋ¹* (sky grandpa) 'god / heavens', 月翁 *βet⁷ ɔŋ¹* (moon grandpa) 'moon'

Samheung SM:

雷翁 *lui²⁻⁶ aŋ¹* 'thunder deity', 灶翁 *tsɐu⁵⁻¹ aŋ¹* 'kitchen deity', 月(光)翁 *gɔi² (kui¹) aŋ¹* (moon (light) grandpa) 'moon', 關帝翁 *kən¹ te⁵⁻¹ aŋ¹* (Guān Lord grandpa) 'Lord Guān (deity)'

The morpheme 翁 is also used as a suffix to indicate male sex on animal nouns.

Longdu EM:

豬翁 *ti¹⁻²-ɛŋ¹* (swine-male) 'boar', 雞翁 *kie¹⁻²-ɛŋ¹* (fowl-male) 'rooster'

Namlong EM:

豬翁 *ti¹⁻³-ɔŋ¹* (swine-male) 'boar' (also 豬牯 *ti¹⁻³-ku³* 'boar'), 雞翁 *kia¹⁻³-ɔŋ¹* (fowl-male) 'rooster' (but 牛牯 *ŋ²⁻³-ku³* 'ox')

Samheung SM:

豬翁 *tu¹-aŋ¹* (swine-male) 'boar', 雞翁 *ke¹-aŋ¹* (fowl-male) 'rooster', 馬兒翁 *bɛi³⁻⁶-zi²-aŋ¹* (horse-DIM-male) 'tomcat' [sic]

The morpheme 翁 is also used with many other nouns.

Longdu EM:

手指(頭)翁 $ts^{hiu^3} tsi^3 (t^{hau^2}) \varepsilon\eta^1$ (hand digit (head) grandpa) ‘thumb’, 骹趾頭翁 $k^{ha^1-2} tsi^3 t^{hau^2} \varepsilon\eta^1$ (leg digit head grandpa) ‘big toe’, 草花翁 $ts^{hau^3} \phi\theta^{1-2} \varepsilon\eta^1$ (grass flower grandpa) a species of snake (perhaps *Xenochrophis* / *Fowlea piscator*)

Namlong EM:

手指頭翁 $ts^{hiu^3} tsi^{3-2} t^{hau^2} \varepsilon\eta^1$ (hand digit head grandpa) ‘thumb’, 骹趾頭翁 $k^{ha^1-3} tsi^{3-2} t^{hau^2} \varepsilon\eta^1$ (leg digit head grandpa) ‘big toe’, 沙翁 $sia^{1-3} \varepsilon\eta^1$ (sand grandpa) ‘sand’, 翁囡 $\varepsilon\eta^{1-7} kien^3$ (grandpa DIM) ‘doll’

Samheung SM:

稱頭翁 $ts^{hin^{5-1}} t^{heu^{2-6}} a\eta^1$ ‘thumb’, 骹稱頭翁 $k^{ha^1} ts^{hin^{5-1}} t^{heu^{2-6}} a\eta^1$ ‘big toe’

One observation is that the use of the morpheme 翁 $\varepsilon\eta^1$ / $\varepsilon\eta^1$ / $a\eta^1$ in the ZSM varieties overlaps to a large degree with the morpheme 公 $ko\eta^1$ in ZSY. Similar to how the ZSM varieties use Mǐn 儂 $n\varepsilon\eta^2$ / $n\varepsilon\eta^2$ / $na\eta^2$ ‘person’ and 囡 $kien^3$ / $kien^3$ / kia^3 to calque Yuè 人 $j\eta n^2$ ‘person’ and 仔 $t\phi i^3$ ‘son’ respectively (§5.1), the ZSM varieties have come up with the idea of using Mǐn 翁 $\varepsilon\eta^1$ / $\varepsilon\eta^1$ / $a\eta^1$ to calque Yuè 公 $ko\eta^1$. (Perhaps the calquing was sometimes the other way round; it is hard to tell.) The following are some examples of 公 $ko\eta^1$ in Heungshan Yuè. (Only some of these are found in Cantonese.)

ZSY:

伯爺公 $pak^8 ja^{2-1} ko\eta^1$ (senior lord grandpa) ‘old man’, 雷公 $lui^2 ko\eta^1$ (thunder grandpa) ‘thunder deity’, 豬公 $tsy^1-ko\eta^1$ (swine-male) ‘boar’, 腳趾公 $ki\phi k^8 tsi^3 ko\eta^1$ (leg digit grandpa) ‘big toe’, 飯公 $fan^5 ko\eta^1$ (rice grandpa) ‘rice ball’, 大沙公 $tai^5 sa^1 ko\eta^1$ (big sand grandpa) ‘coarse sand’, 草花公 $ts^{hou^3} fa^1 ko\eta^1$ (grass flower grandpa) a species of snake

Hafong:

雞公 $kvi^{1-2}-ko\eta^1$ (fowl-male) ‘rooster’, 腳趾公 $ki\phi k^{7-2} tsi^{3-1} ko\eta^1$ (leg digit grandpa) ‘big toe’, 草花公 $ts^{heu^{3-1}} fa^{1-2} ko\eta^1$ (grass flower grandpa) species of snake

We have already seen above how the ZSM varieties use 翁 $\varepsilon\eta^1$ / $\varepsilon\eta^1$ / $a\eta^1$ as the equivalent of Yuè 公 $ko\eta^1$ in many of these cases. In ZSY, the basic meaning of 公 $ko\eta^1$ is “grandfather”, e.g. 阿公 $a^5-ko\eta^1$ [1] (NAME-grandpa) ‘grandfather’.⁸³ It is natural for at least Longdu EM to use 翁 $\varepsilon\eta^1$ as the equivalent of Yuè 公 $ko\eta^1$, as the basic meaning of the morpheme 翁 $\varepsilon\eta^1$ is also “grandfather”. Although Namlong EM uses borrowed Yuè terms for “grandfather” – 阿公 $a^5-ko\eta^7$ [1] (NAME-grandpa) ‘paternal grandfather’, 外公 $gia^{6-2} ko\eta^7$ (external grandpa) ‘maternal grandfather’ – we have seen above that in Namlong EM, the morpheme 翁 $\varepsilon\eta^1$ also has “grandfather” as its basic meaning.

The morpheme 翁 is nowhere as productive in the nearby Yuè and Hakka varieties. ZSY 翁 $\varepsilon\eta^1$ and ZSH 翁 iun^1 are usually only used in literary words. In most other Mǐn varieties, especially SM varieties, 翁 is not very productive (see below).

The question is where this use of 翁 $\varepsilon\eta^1$ / $\varepsilon\eta^1$ / $a\eta^1$ ‘grandfather’ in the ZSM varieties came from. This is actually a combination of two related questions: 1. where else is 翁 also used as the basic word for “grandfather”, and 2. amongst these speech varieties, is the use of the 翁 morpheme also as widespread as it is in

83 Looking at Zhan et al. (2002:422)’s lexical list of eleven Guǎngdōng Yuè varieties, in Zhōngshān and three other Yuè varieties (Sháoguān Cantonese, Dōngguān, Liánjiāng), 阿公 $a^5 ko\eta^1$ means both “paternal grandfather” and “maternal grandfather”. In two Yuè varieties (Dōumén, Xinyi), 阿公 $a^5 ko\eta^1$ means “paternal grandfather”, and the word for “maternal grandfather” also contains the morpheme 公 $ko\eta^1$. This is different from Standard Cantonese where 阿公 $a^5 ko\eta^1$ is specifically “maternal grandfather”, and “paternal grandfather” is 阿爺 $a^5 je^2$.

the ZSM varieties. The “best” scenario would be having speech varieties which fit both criteria, and they are known to have links with the ZSM varieties. Again, the same parts of northeastern Fújiàn fit these two criteria, albeit not perfectly. Looking at the Linguistic Atlas of Chinese Dialects [LACD] (Cao 2008), there is Lexicon map 042 “爺爺呼稱 ‘Paternal Grandfather’ (direct address)”. The Sinitic varieties where the morpheme 翁 is used in the word for “paternal grandfather” are nearly all found in northern Fújiàn, amongst EM, NM, and Shē varieties. The following is the range of Sinitic varieties, and the word in Chinese characters in parentheses:

NE and N Fújiàn: Fú’ān 福安 EM (祖翁), Níngdé 寧德 EM (翁), Níngdé 寧德 Shē (翁), Zhōuníng 周寧 EM (阿翁), Zhèngghé 政和 NM (翁), Sōngxī 松溪 NM ([kaɿ] 翁), Jiàn’ōu 建甌 NM (阿翁), Nánpíng 南平 NM⁸⁴ (阿翁)

Neighbouring S Zhèjiāng: Cāngnán 蒼南 EM (翁), Jǐngníng 景寧 Shē (翁)

(Unrelated?) W Guǎngdōng: Déqìng 德慶 Yuè (阿翁)

Data from 古音小鏡 (http://www.kaom.net/si_ci.php) show a similar distribution (Chinese characters followed by IPA):

NE & N Fújiàn: Níngdé Jiāoběi 寧德蕉北 EM (翁 [æŋ-ɿ]), Zhōuníng 周寧 EM (翁 [æŋɿ]), Zhèngghé 政和 NM (阿翁 [aŋɿ æyŋɿ]), Sōngxī 松溪 NM (家翁 [kəɿ æyŋɿ]), Pǔchéng Shíbēi 浦城石陂 NM (翁爹 [əŋɿ taɿ])

Neighbouring S Zhèjiāng: Jǐngníng Zhèngkēng 景寧鄭坑 Shē (翁 [əŋɿ]), Jǐngníng Hèxī 景寧鶴溪 Shē (翁 [əŋɿ])

(Related) Jiāngxī: Wǔníng Xīnníng 武寧新寧 Shē (翁 [aŋ])

(Unrelated?) W Guǎngdōng: Déqìng Déchéng 德慶德城 Yuè (阿翁 [aɿ oŋɿ])

NE Guǎngxī: Zhāopíng 昭平 Yuè (阿翁 [aɿ oŋɿ])

S Húnán: Jiānghuá Tǎoxū 江華濤墟 Tǔhuà (屋翁 [nɿ moŋɿ])

(Unrelated?) Hǎinán: Sānyà Yázhōu 三亞崖州 Yuè (翁 [uŋɿ])

From other publications we also find forms like Níngdé EM 翁 $\alpha\eta^1$ ‘paternal grandfather’, Zhōuníng EM 阿翁 $a^2-\alpha\eta^1$ (NAME-grandpa) ‘paternal grandfather’. (See also below for Akitani 秋谷 (2018)’s data from three less-urban varieties of NEM in Níngdé and Zhōuníng.) In Fú’ān EM we find 公 $kou\eta^1$ ‘paternal grandfather’. However, the “grandfather” morpheme in [ŋuoiɬ ouŋ-ɿ] (external grandpa) ‘maternal grandfather’ and [lauɬ ouŋ-ɿ] (old grandpa) ‘husband’ can be either 公 $kou\eta^1$ or 翁 $ou\eta^1$ underlyingly, given Fú’ān EM’s onset lenition rules. As for Shē, some Shē varieties use 翁 $\alpha\eta^1$ for “paternal grandfather” (You 2002:311): Fú’ān 福安, Jǐngníng 景寧, and Lǐshuǐ 麗水 Shē 翁 $\alpha\eta^1$ ‘paternal grandfather’, Shùchāng 順昌 Shē 阿翁 $a^1-\alpha\eta^1$ (NAME-grandpa) ‘paternal grandfather’.⁸⁵ The direction of borrowing of 翁 ‘grandfather’ is perhaps from NEM to Shē, given Shē’s lower socio-economic status in relation to NEM. However, the opposite scenario, i.e. this is a borrowing from Shē to NEM, is not impossible. For instance, amongst Hmong–Mien languages, we find Iu Mien with $ou\eta^1$ ‘grandfather’, which is found in seemingly all varieties of the majority Guǎngdiān and Xiāngnán branches of Iu Mien (e.g. Mao 2004:473; GSYGV 2008:194; Ouyang 2015; Arisawa 2016).⁸⁶ In either scenario, we have 翁 with “grandfather” as its basic meaning in some of the NEM and Shē varieties in northeastern Fújiàn, e.g. Níngdé, Zhōuníng, Fú’ān. This area is likely the origin of the word 翁 ‘grandfather’ in ZSM.

⁸⁴ The Nánpíng data point in the LACD is not Nánpíng Mandarin.

⁸⁵ All Shē varieties documented by You (2002) use 公 $kou\eta^1$ for “maternal grandfather”, and some also use 公 $kou\eta^1$ for “paternal grandfather”.

⁸⁶ In both Hmong–Mien and Sinitic, forms like $ou\eta^1$ ‘grandfather’ are not widespread, so it is difficult to say whether Iu Mien $ou\eta^1$ is of native or Sinitic origin. This is one line of inquiry worth investigating.

In the LACD, there is also Lexicon map 044 “外祖父敘稱 ‘Maternal Grandfather’ (indirect address)”. We see 翁 used for “maternal grandfather” primarily in some NM varieties. The following is the range of Sinitic varieties which use the morpheme 翁 in their word for “maternal grandfather”.

N Fújiàn: Píngnán 屏南 EM (阿翁), Sōngxī 松溪 NM (翁伯), Pǔchéng 浦城 NM⁸⁷ (翁子), Wǔyíshān 武夷山 NM (翁翁), Jiàn’ōu 建甌 NM (姐翁)

(Unrelated?) W Guǎngdōng: Déqíng 德慶 Yuè (翁娣), Fēngkāi 封開 Yuè (翁娣)⁸⁸

Data from 古音小鏡 (http://www.kaom.net/si_ci.php) show a similar distribution:

NE & N Fújiàn: Níngdé Jiāoběi 寧德蕉北 EM (外翁 [ɲieɫ æŋɬ]), Zhōuníng 周寧 EM (娘翁 [næŋɬ æŋɬ]), Shòuníng Áoyáng 壽寧龍陽 EM (外翁 [ɲiaɫ æŋɬ]), Zhènghé 政和 NM (婆翁 [poɫ æŋɬ]), Sōngxī 松溪 NM (翁伯 [æŋɬ poɫ]), Pǔchéng Shíbēi 浦城石陂 NM (翁仔 [æŋɬ te]), Wǔyíshān Wǔyí 武夷山武夷 NM (外翁 [ɲyaiɫ eiŋɬ])

Neighbouring S Zhèjiāng: Tàishùn Shiyáng 泰順仕陽 Shē (外翁 [niaɫ uəŋɬ])

(Unrelated?) W Guǎngdōng: Déqíng Déchéng 德慶德城 Yuè (翁 ? [oŋɬ taɬ]), Fēngkāi Jiāngkǒu 封開江口 Yuè (翁娣 [oŋɬ taɬ]), Liánshān Jítíán 連山吉田 Yuè (娣翁蒙 [dɔɫ oŋɬ moŋɬ])

NE Guǎngxī: Hèzhōu Guǐlǐng 賀州桂嶺 Yuè (娣翁 [lɔɫ uŋɬ]), Hèzhōu Pùmén 賀州鋪門 Yuè (娣翁 [taɫ oŋɬ]), Zhāopíng 昭平 Yuè (妹翁 [muiɫ oŋɬ])

S Húnán: Jiānghuá Tāoxū 江華濤墟 Tūhuà (屋翁 [nɫ moŋɬ])

(Unrelated?) Hǎinán: Sānyà Yázhōu 三亞崖州 Yuè (翁 [miɫ uŋɬ])

From other publications we also find forms like Níngdé EM 外翁 *ɲieɫ æŋɬ* (external grandpa) ‘maternal grandfather’, Zhōuníng EM 娘翁 *nyæŋɬ æŋɬ* (lady grandpa) ‘maternal grandfather’, Jiàn’ōu NM *æŋɬ æŋɬ* affectionate term for “maternal grandfather”, *tsia⁵ æŋɬ* (Shē grandpa) ‘maternal grandfather’.⁸⁹ We have already established in §1.3 that the ZSM varieties are not Inland Mǐn, so the use of 翁 in Zhōngshān would not be directly related to this use of 翁 in NM. However, the commonality between NM and ZSM is the EM influence.⁹⁰

87 This LACD data point is specifically Pǔchéng Mǐn, not Pǔchéng Wú.

88 From another publication, the following are the 翁 forms in Sinitic western Guǎngdōng: Déqíng Yuè 阿翁 *a^{1-7b} oŋɬ* ‘paternal grandfather’, 翁爹 *oŋɬ taɬ* ‘maternal grandfather’; Fēngkāi Nánfēng Yuè 翁 *oŋɬ* ‘paternal grandfather’, 大翁 *tai⁶ oŋɬ* ‘maternal grandfather’ (Zhan & Cheung 1998:558). In the vicinity there is the Biāo language (Kra-Dai) of Fēngkāi and Huáijí, with words like *a¹ uŋɬ* ‘paternal grandfather’ and *uŋɬ to¹ ~ koŋɬ to¹* ‘maternal grandfather’ (Liang & Zhang:187, 189). While the form *koŋɬ* (公) is obviously Sinitic, it is unclear whether the morphemes *uŋɬ* / *uŋɬ* are native or Sinitic (possibly 翁). In other Kra-Dai languages, one also finds forms like Kam *ʔoŋɬ* ‘paternal grandfather’ (Long 2003:219). Déqíng, Fēngkāi, and Huáijí in western Guǎngdōng are upriver from Zhōngshān, but we are currently not aware of strong ties between Zhōngshān and western Guǎngdōng, so perhaps the use of 翁 in ZSM is unrelated to that in western Guǎngdōng. (Nonetheless, this is an unanswered question.) As for the *t*-morphemes in the words for “maternal grandfather” in Déqíng Yuè *oŋɬ taɬ*, Fēngkāi Nánfēng Yuè *tai⁶ oŋɬ*, Huáijí Yuè *koŋɬ tai³* (Zhan & Cheung 1998:558), these are most probably the Kra-Dai morpheme for “maternal grandfather”, cf. Biāo *to¹*, Kam *ta¹* (Long 2003:219), Proto-Tai **ta^A* (Pittayaporn 2009:336), Pre-Hlai **ta^A*? (Norquest 2007:569). Similar *t*-morphemes for “maternal grandfather” are not uncommon in the Yuè dialects in western Guǎngdōng (Zhan & Cheung 1998:558), northern Guǎngdōng (Zhan & Cheung 1994:554), the Sinitic Patois / *Tūhuà* of Northern Guǎngdōng (e.g. Chang 2000:242, 2004:253; Li & Zhuang 2009:259), and some Yuè and Pínghuà dialects in Guǎngxī (Xie 2007:1398–1399).

89 In Li & Pan (1998), the affectionate term *æŋɬ æŋɬ* ‘maternal grandfather’ is rendered 公公 (:243), but *æŋɬ* is obviously 翁, cf. the zero initial (公 is *koŋɬ*, as in 公公 *koŋɬ koŋɬ* ‘paternal grandfather’ [:214].) The normal word *tsia⁵ æŋɬ* ‘maternal grandfather’ is rendered 畚公 (Shē grandpa) in Li & Pan (1998:62). (The morpheme 畚 ‘Shē’ is in tone 2 in many Southern Sinitic varieties, e.g. Cantonese *sɛ²*, and in Jiàn’ōu NM tone 2 has merged into tone 5.) In the LACD, the Jiàn’ōu NM form is rendered 姐翁 (big.sis grandpa). This etymon of 姐 ‘elder sister’ is less likely to be correct, as 姐 usually has tone 3, and Jiàn’ōu NM is very poor in tone sandhi.

90 There is yet another case of 翁 grandfather’ in the region that we must mention: Vietnamese *ông* 翁 grandfather’ or ‘old man’, which

The second question is whether there are speech varieties where the use of the 翁 morpheme is as wide as it is in the ZSM varieties. The three less-urban NEM varieties in Ningdé and Zhōuníng documented by Akitani (2018) have quite a wide range, albeit not as wide as it is in the ZSM varieties.

Níngdé Hǔpèi 寧德虎垵 EM: 翁 øŋ^1 ‘paternal grandfather’, 外翁 $[\text{ŋi}^1 \text{øŋ}^1]$ (external grandpa) ‘maternal grandfather’, 大翁 $[\text{tu}^1 \text{øŋ}^1]$ (big grandpa) ‘great grandfather’, 舅翁 $\text{ko}^{6-1} \text{øŋ}^1$ (mum.bro grandpa) ‘father’s maternal uncle’, 老翁 $[\text{lau}^1 \text{øŋ}^1]$ (old grandpa) ‘husband’

Zhōuníng Xiáncūn 周寧咸村 EM: (阿) 翁 $(a^0-) \text{øŋ}^1$ ([NAME-] grandpa) ‘paternal grandfather’, 外翁 $\text{ŋi}^{6-1} \text{øŋ}^1$ (external grandpa) ‘maternal grandfather’, 大翁 $\text{tu}^{6-1} \text{øŋ}^1$ (big grandpa) ‘great grandfather’, 舅翁 $\text{ko}^{6-1} \text{øŋ}^1$ (mum.bro grandpa) ‘father’s maternal uncle’, 叔翁 $\text{tɕyuk}^7 \text{øŋ}^1$ (dad.bro grandpa) ‘husband’s paternal uncle’, 迎翁 $\text{ŋi}^{\text{ŋ}2} \text{øŋ}^1$ (welcome grandpa) ‘to welcome deities’, 灶神翁 $[\text{tʃaul} \text{lenl} \text{nøŋ}^1]$ (kitchen deity grandpa) ‘kitchen god’, 包貓餌翁 $[\text{pau}^1 \text{mal} \text{ni}^1 \text{øŋ}^1]$ (wrap cat bait grandpa) ‘tag (game) with the tagger blindfolded’

Níngdé Jiǔdū 寧德九都 EM: 翁 øŋ^1 ‘paternal grandfather’, 外翁 $\text{ŋi}^{6-1} \text{øŋ}^1$ (external grandpa) ‘maternal grandfather’, 大翁 $\text{tu}^{6-1} \text{øŋ}^1$ (big grandpa) ‘great grandfather’, 老翁 $\text{lau}^{6-1} \text{øŋ}^1$ (old grandpa) ‘husband’, 舅翁 $\text{ko}^{6-1} \text{øŋ}^1$ (mum.bro grandpa) ‘father’s maternal uncle’, 請祖翁 $[\text{tsʰaŋ}^1 \text{ŋu}^1 \text{øŋ}^1]$ (invite ancestor grandpa) ‘inviting ancestors’ (end of year religious ceremony), 白老翁 $\text{pa}^2 \text{lau}^{6-1} \text{øŋ}^1$ (white old grandpa) ‘tag (game) with the tagger blindfolded’

Of note here are: a) the basic meaning of 翁 øŋ^1 is “(paternal) grandfather”; and b) how 翁 øŋ^1 has a “deity” meaning, e.g. Zhōuníng Xiáncūn EM 迎翁 $\text{ŋi}^{\text{ŋ}2} \text{øŋ}^1$ (welcome grandpa) ‘to welcome deities’, Níng-

is also used pronominally (Alves 2017:295). Firstly, this word is not new in Vietnamese; it is recorded in the *Dictionarium Annamiticum* (de Rhodes 1651:586) as “oũ: auò : aus” (modern spelling: Vietnamese *ông*, Portuguese *avô*, Latin *avus* ‘grandfather’). Secondly, many Mường varieties borrowed this with a monophthongal pronunciation $[\text{ɔ}:\text{ŋ}]$ (Nguyễn 2005), which is the original or close to the original pronunciation in Vietnamese (unlike the diphthongised pronunciation of something like $[\text{əwŋm}]$, a later development which is now present in nearly all modern Vietnamese dialects). This testifies that the borrowing was not recent, and that the word has existed in Vietnamese for quite some time. Also, *ông* forms only exist in Việt–Mường (plus some recent loans in other Vietic languages), and not in the other branches of Austroasiatic, further diminishing the possibility that this is not a Sinitic loanword in Vietnamese. The (perhaps unanswerable) question is whether 翁 already had the sense of “grandfather” in the source Sinitic language. In about the tenth to thirteenth centuries (roughly between the declaration of independence by the Ngô 吳 Dynasty (938–968), to the Mongol invasions in the second half of the thirteenth century), there were two communities of Sinitic speakers in the Red River Delta. One was the Annamese Middle Chinese community (Phan 2013, 2025; see also Phan & de Sousa 2022, and de Sousa 2020), which was the source of most Sinitic loanwords in Vietnamese. The other was the community of Fujianese / Mǐn migrants (e.g. Whitmore 2022). (Notice that this was also the time period when the majority of Fujianese migrants entered Hainán [Liu 2006:35].) We currently do not know the composition of the Fujianese migrants to the Red River Delta during this time. Nonetheless, given that the Fujianese population in both Zhōngshān (Gao 2018:15–17, 246–248, 283–284, 318–319) and Hainán (Liu 2006:35–39) claim that their ancestors came from various locations in what we now understand as the SM, PXM, and EM areas in Fújiàn, in high likelihood a significant portion of the Fujianese population in the Red River Delta did come from the EM area. We know of one such person in Vietnamese history: Trần Kinh 陳京, the great-great grandfather of Trần Cảnh 陳煚, the founding emperor Thái Tông 太宗 of the Trần 陳 Dynasty (1226–1400) of Đại Việt 大越, arrived in the Red River Delta from Chánglè 長樂 of Fúzhōu (Qidōng Yěyǔ 齊東野語 *juǎn* 卷 19 by Zhōu Mì 周密 [1232–1298]; *Sìkùquǎnshū běn* 四庫全書本). Descendants of the Trần royal house managed to link up their genealogy with that of the Chén 陳 clan at Chánglè (https://www.nkbjx.com/cn_xc_news/news/getInfoToNews?clan_id=172&id=18644; accessed 9 Oct 2024). Chánglè is well within the EM area, not that far from Níngdé. Perhaps the use of 翁 *ông* ‘grandfather’ in Vietnamese has to do with the EM varieties in northeastern Fújiàn, and/or the EM enclave varieties in Zhōngshān midway between Fújiàn and the Red River Delta. This is one line of inquiry worth investigating.

dé Jiǔdū EM 請祖翁 [tsʰaŋ˥ ɲu˥ ɕŋ˥] (invite ancestor grandpa) ‘inviting ancestors’. Longdu EM also has /khūaj ʔéq/ [kʰuaj˥ ʔæ˥ŋ] EG ‘worship spirits’ (with Longdu having unrounded their rounded front vowels).⁹¹

The frequent use of the 翁 morpheme in Longdu EM (ɛŋ˥) and Namlong EM (ɔŋ˥) is most probably inherited from their northeastern Fújiàn ancestors. In Zhōngshān they have extended the use to even more semantic fields. Even if the extended use of the morpheme 翁 is a parallel development in Zhōngshān and northeastern Fújiàn, this usage of 翁 in ZSM is still a NEM trait, and not a SM trait. This has to do with the fact that the basic meaning of 翁 is “grandfather” in the aforementioned NEM varieties, whereas the basic meaning of 翁 is “husband” in all SM varieties that we know of except Samheung SM, e.g. Taiwanese SM 翁 / 𪛗 *ay˥* ‘husband’, Teochew SM 翁 *ay˥* ‘husband’. Teochew SM also uses 翁 -*ay˥* as a suffix indicating male sex on animals nouns, e.g. 雞翁 *koi˥ ay˥* ‘rooster’.⁹² Diànbái SM has a word *le˥* DD ‘husband’ of unclear etymology,⁹³ but 翁 *ay˥* is used in words like 翁婆 *ay˥ pa˥* DD ‘husband and wife’, 翁袋 *ay˥ te˥* DD ‘wife’s father’, 大翁 *tua˥ ay˥* DD ‘taoist priest’. Diànbái SM uses the suffix 翁 -*ay˥* for male fowls and ducks: 雞翁 *koi˥-ay˥* DD ‘little rooster’, 鴨翁 *a˥-ay˥* DD ‘little drake’.⁹⁴

This makes Samheung SM the odd one out. Unlike other SM varieties, Samheung SM uses 翁 *ay˥* to mean “grandfather”. This is not a SM trait. This is an EM trait that Samheung SM copied directly from Longdu 翁 *ɛŋ˥* and/or Namlong EM 翁 *ɔŋ˥*. The wide range of usage of 翁 *ay˥* in Samheung SM is also not related to the other SM varieties. The range of usage of 翁 *ay˥* in Teochew SM and Diànbái SM is already the widest amongst the non-Samheung SM varieties that we know of.

We know of one marginal case of 翁 meaning “grandfather” in a non-Samheung SM variety: Diànbái (Hǎihuà) SM 太翁 [tʰai˥ ɲu˥] ‘great-grandfather’ (Chang 2005:1009) (versus 公 [kɔŋ˥] ‘paternal grandfather’ and 外公 [hua˥ kɔŋ˥] ‘maternal grandfather’).⁹⁵ If this is not an independent development in Diànbái, having a (fossilised) morpheme 翁 *ay˥* meaning “grandfather” may be another trait which links Diànbái Mǐn and ZSM. (The other is the unusual cases of *-k > *-p; see the end of §4.2.4.)

Lastly, the Namlong EM word 月翁 *βet˥ ɔŋ˥* (moon grandpa) ‘moon’ and the Samheung SM word 月 (光) 翁 *gɔi˥ (kui˥) ay˥* (moon [light] grandpa) ‘moon’ are worth mentioning. These are the ordinary words

91 A similar case of calling deities “grandfather” can be found in Guǎngdōng Hakka (and diaspora). In Guǎngdōng Hakka beliefs, the earth deity, which is the most-commonly worshipped deity, is called 伯公 *pak˥ kuy˥* (dad.old.bro grandpa) ‘grandfather’s elder brother’.

92 There are various other male animal suffixes in Teochew–Swatow SM, e.g. Swatow SM 牛𪛗 *gu˥-kou˥* (bovine-male) ‘ox’, 鴨雄 *a˥-heŋ˥* (duck-male) ‘drake’ (Ouyang et al. 2005:103).

93 This morpheme *le˥* ‘husband’ is also an adult male suffix, e.g. *hui˥ a˥ tʰau˥ le˥* DD (remove [_< Cantonese 飛] head bloke) ‘male hairdresser’. This is the equivalent of the Diànbái Hakka suffix 佬 *lo˥*, e.g. 飛頭佬 *fai˥ tʰei˥ lo˥* (remove head bloke) ‘male hairdresser’. Is Diànbái Mǐn *le˥* etymologically 畚 *le˥* ‘Shē people’ / ‘slash and burn farmers’? (While perhaps not directly related, many InM varieties have a *s˥* morpheme meaning “person” (Li 1997:112), e.g. Yǒng’ān CnM 剃頭畚 *tʰe˥ tʰo˥ s˥* (shave head person) ‘hairdresser’. Hakka has a similar-sounding morpheme, e.g. Hong Kong Hakka 儕 *sa˥ ~ ha˥* ‘classifier for people’.) Or is this 爺 *ze˥* ‘sir’ > *le˥* ‘husband’? Or is this a substratum word related to the Jizhào 吉兆 language (Kra-Dai) of Diànbái? (Interestingly, Jizhào has [lou˥ ɲɔŋ˥] ‘husband’ (Li & Wu 2022:13); this looks like Sinitic 老翁 (old husband) with Yuè segments, and Kra-Dai tones Lower BC and Upper A respectively (Jizhào is the same as Ong Be in not having a tone BC distinction), matching the Sinitic tones 4 and 1 of 老 and 翁 respectively.)

94 The large versions are 雞翁頭 *koi˥-a˥-ay˥ tʰau˥* (fowl-male head) ‘big rooster’, 鴨頭 *a˥ tʰau˥* (duck head) ‘drake’. The other animals have different male suffixes: 狗公 *kau˥-kɔŋ˥* ‘dog / stud’, 豬哥 *tu˥-a˥-kɔŋ˥* (swine-big.bro) ‘boar for breeding’.

95 Based on the tone values, Chang (2005)’s Diànbái Mǐn data are from Diànbái Hǎihuà 電白海話. See Table 1 in §4.3 for the tone values. Diànbái Lihua 電白黎話, the variety of Diànbái Mǐn shown in the rest of this article, are rather close to Diànbái Hǎihuà, and they are mutually intelligible (Dai et al. 1994:5).

for “moon” in Namlong EM and Samheung SM respectively. LACD Lexicon map 003 (Cao 2008) maps the anthropomorphic words for “moon” amongst Sinitic varieties. Amongst the surveyed varieties with such words, most have a feminine moon word. The best-known examples in the region are, e.g., Taiwanese SM 月娘 *gueʔ⁸ niuʔ* (moon lady) ‘moon’, Teochew SM 月娘 *gueʔ⁸ niēʔ* (moon lady) ‘moon’. Having a masculine word for “moon” is much rarer. In LACD Lexicon map 003, “Zhōngshān Yuè” is recorded as having a masculine moon word 月公 (moon grandpa).⁹⁶ Amongst Mǐn varieties, 月公 (moon grandpa) exists in Pútían and southwestern Hǎinán (e.g. Sānyà). This is perhaps not purely a coincidence; the masculine moon words are seemingly hinting at a historical migration pathway linking Pútían, Zhōngshān, and Hǎinán. More investigations are needed.

6. Conclusion

The Pearl River Delta is predominantly Yuè-speaking. However, in the middle of the Pearl River Delta, there are the three enclave varieties of Mǐn in Zhōngshān 中山 [ZSM]: Longdu 隆都 (Lóngdū), Namlong 南朗 (Nánlǎng), and Samheung 三鄉 (Sānxiāng). The ZSM varieties are often said to be closely related varieties of Southern Mǐn [SM]. However, this is only partially true. Firstly, without prior exposure, the three ZSM varieties are not mutually intelligible. Secondly, while Samheung is indeed SM, Longdu and Namlong are Eastern Mǐn [EM] genealogically. In §1 we outlined some introductory issues, for instance the Mǐn, Yuè, and Hakka varieties spoken in Zhōngshān, the linguistic interactions amongst them, the Mǐn subgroups, and ZSM’s membership within the Coastal Mǐn subgroup.

Section 2 of this article is largely structured around Akitani (2022a)’s arguments that Longdu is EM (following Bodman [1982]’s conclusion that Namlong and Longdu are both EM). We summarised and reviewed these arguments. We also provided some extra data (§2.1.6) in support of this view. Akitani further argues that Longdu is a member of the Northern subgroup of EM [NEM]. We reviewed some of these arguments in §2.3.1–6. We presented and discussed more data in §2.3.7, this time in relation to the sound changes discussed in another publication, Akitani (2022b); the results further support the view that Longdu is a member of NEM. In §2.5.1 we discussed how Longdu is typologically unlike the better-known EM varieties like Fúzhōu (Hokchew) and Fúqīng (Hokchia). The typological profile of Longdu has caused some linguists to classify Longdu as SM. In §2.5.2, we discussed a few lexical items in Longdu that are probably borrowed from SM.

In §3 we discussed Namlong. In comparison with the amount of research on Longdu, the amount of research on Namlong is minuscule. Nonetheless, based on available data, it is already clear that the historical phonological developments in Namlong are mostly the same as those in Longdu. Except some surface-level differences, e.g. very different tone values, and different loanwords from Yuè, Namlong and Longdu are very closely related to each other, and Namlong is hence also EM genealogically.

In §4 we discussed Samheung. While Samheung is obviously SM, we discussed how Samheung fits in with the various branches of SM. Samheung is primarily a SM variety of the Zhāngzhōu type. Samheung SM also has a few traits which resemble SM of the Guǎngdōng–Hǎinán type.

In §5 we discussed the linguistic interactions amongst the three ZSM varieties. Some lexical similarities are due to them having used the same or very similar strategies when calquing Yuè lexical items. In §2.5.2 and §3.5.2 we have already discussed some SM-like traits in Longdu and Namlong EM respectively. In §5.1

⁹⁶ The Zhōngshān Yuè data point in the LACD is a Kun–Pou (Guǎn–Bǎo) Yuè variety, probably that of Sānjiǎo 三角 in northeastern Zhōngshān. Another instance we could find is 月公 *jyʔ⁸ koyʔ* GR (moon grandpa) in the Yuet Hoi Yuè of Siulam / Xiǎolǎn 小欖 in northwestern Zhōngshān. This form is perhaps also used in other Yuè varieties in Zhōngshān.

we discussed some traits that Samheung SM might have borrowed directly from Longdu and/or Namlong EM. In §5.2 and §5.3 we looked at how two lexical items, “yesterday” and “grandfather”, link Longdu and Namlong EM with the EM varieties in Níngdé 寧德, Zhōuníng 周寧, and Fú’ān 福安 in northeastern Fújiàn. That Samheung SM also shares the use of 翁 ‘grandfather’ strongly suggests that this is an EM trait that entered Samheung SM directly from Longdu and/or Namlong EM. (As far as we know, this use of 翁 ‘grandfather’ is not found in other SM varieties, with the exception of Diànbái SM in western Guǎngdōng having 翁 in the word for ‘great-grandfather’.)

There are many further research questions. For instance, many ZSM people claim that their ancestors came from Pútían in Fújiàn. However, linguistically we see nearly no traits in ZSM that are similar to traits that are unique to Pú–Xiān Mǐn [PXM]. (Similarities that the ZSM varieties have with PXM are basically all traits that PXM shares with either EM or SM.) From what we currently know, the only similarity between ZSM and PXM that is not shared by (most) other EM or SM varieties is having a masculine anthropomorphic word for “moon” (end of §5.3). Perhaps more-detailed comparative studies of ZSM and PXM would reveal some direct links between them.

Another topic of investigation is whether Zhōngshān has a role in the genesis of Western Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán Mǐn [WGHM], given Zhōngshān’s location midway between Eastern and Western Guǎngdōng Mǐn. In §4.2.4 we have already discussed some traits that are shared amongst Samheung SM and WGHM. Do these traits indicate that some ZSM speakers migrated to Western Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán? Were there “back migrants” from Western Guǎngdōng and Hǎinán to Zhōngshān? Are there other rare traits which are shared between WGHM and Samheung SM (or ZSM in general)?

The strange vocalisms in Samheung SM also deserve in-depth investigations. Answering one of the aforementioned questions would help answering some of the other questions asked in this article.

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Appendix

Table A1. Tone values in some Zhōngshān [ZS] languages

	A		B		C		D		
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7S	7L	8
<u>Yuè:</u>									
Cantonese	1	↓	4	↓	↑	↓	1	↓	↓
ZSY GR	1	↓		↓		↑	1		↓
Hafong GR	↓	1		4		↑		↓	
<u>Hakka:</u>									
ZSH GJ	↑	↓		↓		1		↑	1
ZSH GR	↑	↓		↓		1		↓	1
<u>E Mǐn:</u>									
Longdu: (>6)									
AE/EG	1	↑	4		↓ ~ ↓	↓		↓	1
GR	1	↑	4		↓	↓		↓	1
JS/KS	1	↑	4		↓	↓		↓	1
LC/CX2/CSH	1	↑	4		↓	↓		↓	1
ZL	1	↑	4		↓	↓		↓	1
<u>Namlong:</u>									
BMN	↓	↑	↓ ~ ↓		↑ ~ ↓	↓	↓ / ↓	↓ / ↓	
CX	↓	↑	↓		↓	↓	1	↓	
GR	↓	↑	↓		↓	↓	1	↓	
LC/CX2	↓	↑	↓		1	↓	1	↓	
<u>S Mǐn:</u>									
Samheung: (>6)									
BMS	↑	1	4		↓	↓ / ↑	↓		
GR	↑	1	4		↓	↓ / ↑	↓		
LC/CX2/zz	↑	1	4		↓	↓ / ↑	↓	↓	

Notes: i) only non-sandhi tones are shown; ii) only tones used in native morphemes are shown; all ZSM varieties have borrowed Yuè tones that are different from these (see Gao 2002; the analyses here are slightly different from his); iii) tones 7 & 8 in BMN's Namlong EM: before slash are tones of syllables with their plosive coda intact, after slash are tones of syllables with *-ʔ dropped (see §3.4); iv) in Samheung SM: many of the tone *4 morphemes, and some original tone *6 morphemes, have shifted to tone 1 [↑] (see §4.3); v) ZSY is Shekki-proper, Hafong is Samheung Hafong; vi) the abbreviations in small caps are author / publication codes; see the section on data sources below, and also the beginning of §2, §3, and §4.

Data sources that are not referenced in the main text

(Kwok [2018]'s data are from Chang [2005].)

Coastal Mǐn [CsM] > Eastern Mǐn [EM]:

North [NEM]:

Zhōngshān Longdu 中山隆都 (Lóngdū): Akitani (2022a) [AE], Akitani (2022b) [AE2], Chen (1995) [CX2],

Egerod (1956) [EG], Gao (2000) [GR2], Gao (2018) [GR], Kratochvíl & Sio (2018) [KS], Lin & Chen (1996) [LC], Sio (2024) [JS], Zhan & Cheung (1987) [ZL]
 Zhōngshān Namlong 中山南萌 (Nánlǎng): Bodman (1982) [BMN], Chen (1995) [CX2], Lin & Chen (1996) [LC], Chen & Xu (2012) [CX], Gao (2000) [GR2], Gao (2018) [GR]
 Cāngnán Yántíng 蒼南炎亭: Akitani (2022b) < Akitani (2005)
 Fú'ān 福安: Fu'an (1999)
 Fúdǐng 福鼎: Fuding (2003)
 Fúdǐng Báilín 福鼎白琳: Akitani (2022a) < Akitani (2010a)
 Níngdé 寧德: Ningde (1995)
 Níngdé Hùpèi 寧德虎垵: Akitani (2018)
 Níngdé Jiǔdū 寧德九都: Akitani (2018)
 Shòuníng Nányáng 壽寧南陽: Akitani (2022a) < Akitani (2010a)
 Tàishùn Sānkui 泰順三魁: Akitani (2022b) < Akitani (2005)
 Zhèróng 柘榮: Zherong (1995)
 Zhōuníng 周寧: Zhouning (1993)
 Zhōuníng Xiáncūn 周寧咸村: Akitani (2018)
 South [SEM]:
 Fúqīng 福清 (Hokchia): Feng (1993), Ngai SS p.c
 Fúzhōu 福州 (Hokchew): Feng (1998); Akitani (2022a)'s Fúzhōu data are from BZYJ (2003)
 Gǔtián 古田: Gutian (1997)
 Gǔtián Dàqiáo 古田大橋: Akitani (2022a) < Akitani & Chen (2012)
 Matsu 馬祖 (Mǎzǔ): Tu (2006)

Coastal Mǐn [CsM] > Pǔ-Xiān Mǐn [PXM] (Henghua 興化):

Pútian 莆田: Li et al. (2019), <https://hinghwa.cn> 興化語記
 Xiānyóu 仙游: Li (2001a), Li et al. (2019); Akitani (2022a)'s Xiānyóu data are his fieldwork data

Coastal Mǐn [CsM] > Southern Mǐn [SM]:

Quánzhōu-type [QzSM]:
 Huì'ān 惠安: Chen WR (2020)
 Quánzhōu 泉州: Kwok (2018)

Mixed Quánzhōu–Zhāngzhōu:

Taiwanese SM: <https://sutian.moe.edu.tw> (Dictionary of Frequently-Used Taiwanese Taigi 教育部臺灣台語常用詞辭典)
 Xiàmén 廈門 (Amoy): BZYJ (2003)

Zhāngzhōu-type [ZzSM]:

Zhōngshān Samheung 中山三鄉 (Sānxiāng): Bodman (1988) [BMS], Chen (1995) [CX2], Gao (2000) [GR2], Gao (2018) [GR], Lin & Chen (1996) [LC], Zhang (1987) [ZZ]
 Zhāngpíng Yǒngfú 漳平永福: Akitani (2022a) < Zhang (1992)
 Zhāngzhōu 漳州: Kwok (2018)
 Guǎngdōng–Hǎinán [GHSM]:
 Cháoyáng 潮陽: Kwok (2018)
 Chéngghǎi 澄海: Lin (1996)

Diànbái 電白 (Tinpak; Líhuà 黎話 of Xiádòng 霞洞): by default Lin & Chen (1996) [LC]; also Dai et al. (1994) [DD]
 Haihong 海豐 (Hǎifēng): Kwok (2018)
 Jiēyáng 揭陽 (Kityang): Kwok (2018)
 Luichew 雷州 (Léizhōu): by default Kwok (2018); also Lin (2006) [LL], Lin & Chen (1996) [LC]
 Swatow 汕頭 (Shàntóu): Ouyang et al. (2005)
 Teochew 潮州 (Cháo zhōu): BZYJ (2003), <https://www.mogher.com> 潮州母語
 Hǎikǒu 海口 (Hainanese): Kwok (2018)
 Wénchāng 文昌 (Hainanese): Woon (1987)

Inland Mǐn [InM] > Northern Mǐn [NM]:
 Jiàn'ōu 建甌: Li & Pan (1998)

Inland Mǐn [InM] > Western Mǐn [WM] (Shào–Jiāng 邵將 Mǐn):
 Shàowǔ 邵武: Ngai (2021)

Inland Mǐn [InM] > Central Mǐn [CnM]:
 Yǒng'ān 永安: Zhou & Lin (1992)

Hakka / Shē:

Zhōngshān 中山 Hakka [ZSH]: by default Gan (2003) [GJ], also Gao (2018) [GR]
 Diànbái 電白 (Tinpak): Dai et al. (1994)
 Moiyen 梅縣 (Méixiàn): BZYJ (2003)
 Other Hakka varieties: Luo, Lin & Rao (2004)
 Shē varieties: You (2002)

Yuè / Píng huà:

Heungshan 香山 (Xiāngshān):
 Zhōngshān 中山 Yuè [ZSY] / Shekki 石岐 (Shíqí): by default Zhan et al. (2002) [ZH], also Gao (2018) [GR], de Sousa & Kwok heritage knowledge
 Hafong 下方 (Xiàfāng): Gao (2018) [GR]
 Kun–Pou 莞寶 (Guǎn–Bǎo):
 Tungkun 東莞 (Dōngguǎn): Zhan et al. (2002)
 Szeyup 四邑 (Sìyì) (a.k.a. Ngyap 五邑 ([Wǔyì])):
 Toishanese 台山 (Táishān): Zhan et al. (2002)
 Zhōngshān Gǔzhèn 中山古鎮: Gao (2018) [GR]
 Yuet Hoi 粵海 (Yuèhǎi):
 Cantonese: de Sousa & Kwok native knowledge
 Nánhǎi Shātóu 南海沙頭: Zhan & Cheung (1987)
 Shuntak 順德 (Shùndé): Zhan et al. (2002)
 Siulam 小欖 (Xiǎolǎn): Gao (2018) [GR]
 Southern Píng huà 桂南平話:
 Nán níng Wèi zǐ lù 南寧位子錄: de Sousa fieldwork

Data on Macau (Older Macau Cantonese, Macau creole Portuguese, Portuguese) are de Sousa's.

三種中山閩語的系屬問題：回顧及觀察

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位處珠江三角洲的中山市有三種閩語方言島方言：隆都、南萌和三鄉。這些方言島中的閩語常常被描述成大同小異的閩南區方言變體。本文首先回顧前人對這三種方言的系屬所作的討論，接著提出一些自己的看法。基於共同創新，隆都話及南萌話肯定不屬於閩南區，而是屬於閩東區。更準確一點說，應該是閩東區北片的成員。另一方面，三鄉話的確系屬閩南。它和漳州類的閩南區方言接近，同時摻雜了一些潮汕類閩南區方言的特徵。這三種中山閩語方言，除了擁有來自權威粵語（石岐話、廣州話）的龐大表層影響外，亦有自身的存古及創新成份；這使它們的類型面貌與原鄉的閩語有所區別，其中以隆都話及南萌話尤其明顯也就是這個原因，隆都話、南萌話與閩東的聯繫常常被人忽略。

關鍵詞：漢語、中山閩、方言島、比較法、原始閩語

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